

Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation

The Thirty-Third Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1983

Final Report

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 17-23**

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This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

A.A. Regional Forums: See trustee committee and staff reports, pages 40-41.

Regional trustees: See talk by retiring trustee, page 8; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, pages 42-43; new trustees, page 49; brief biographies, page 59.

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The Spirit of Tradition Twelve Guides the 1983 Conference

Opening day



The A.A. archives hold this heartening record of service continuity over 30 years: the Third General Service Conference in session in 1953; Bill W. on the podium.

Members of the 33rd General Service Conference met at the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City, April 17-23, 1983, to participate in a week of demanding schedules, decision-making, and endless sharing. Delegates from the Conference areas of the United States and Canada (Panels 32 and 33), trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, together with many behind-the-scenes workers, experienced a hectic but productive week. The Conference theme, "Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation," guided Conference members along their service path, reminding them of "principles before personalities" and the humbling responsibility of being trusted servants of A.A.

A sharing session on Sunday afternoon served as an icebreaker. The session was opened by Betty Little (G.S.O. staff), Conference coordinator, and chaired by Barney John Malik (Panel 32, Western Ontario), alternate delegate chairperson. Jim Shannon (Grapevine director), Don Callahan (Panel 32, San Diego), Al Hergott (regional trustee, Western Canada), Curtis Monahan (G.S.O. staff), and Kim Patrick (Panel 33, British Columbia/Yukon) shared their feelings of nervousness in anticipation of the week ahead and their gratitude for the privilege of participating in this Conference. Dr. John Norris ("Dr. Jack") also expressed gratitude, for being able to attend his 33rd Conference. The mood was expectant, and many felt like beginners again. Following this sharing session, G.S.O. filmstrips and current TV spots were shown. Regional trustees then held an orientation session for Panel 33 delegates.

On Sunday evening, good food and good fellowship, followed by an open A.A. meeting, dispelled any pre-Conference jitters. In the Grand Ballroom, Conference members and guests enjoyed a tasty dinner and much sober conviviality. Jim McCourt (Panel 32, Alaska) led the A.A. meeting, introducing speakers Stella Lefebvre (Panel 32, Southwestern Quebec), Bill Dick (Panel 32, Idaho), Ann Warner (Grapevine staff), Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff), and David Aronofsky (trustee-at-large/U.S.).

From laughter to tears, to laughter again, these A.A.'s shared their experience, strength, and hope; and by the end of the meeting, Conference members knew the big week had indeed begun.

The 33rd General Service Conference began officially, however, on Monday morning with an opening session in the Terrace Room. Gordon Patrick, General Service Board chairperson, chairing a Conference for the first time, welcomed members and expressed gratitude for following in the footsteps of Dr. Jack and Milton Maxwell. Bob Pearson (G.S.O. general manager) led the roll call, and Jill Johnston (Panel 32, Southern Indiana), delegate chairperson, gave a stimulating welcoming talk. Stan Cameron (trustee-at-large/Canada) delivered an inspiring keynote address. (A condensed version follows.) Conference business started with the General Service Board report, given by Gordon Patrick. Members then settled down to the serious work at hand—a week filled with committee meetings, reports, a workshop, presentations/discussions, and an Ask-It Basket session.

On Thursday evening, a "What's on Your Mind?" sharing session cleared the air on a variety of subjects. Topics arousing concern included: anonymity breaks; misunderstanding of the purpose of A.A. by well-meaning friends of A.A.; the referral of nonalcoholics to A.A.; A.A. members' "prescribing" for other A.A.'s; rotation of nondirector and nontrustee members of General Service Board committees; and requests from persons at A.A. meetings that attendance slips be signed as proof of their presence. During this sharing session, the subject of the 50th A.A. International Convention, in Montreal in 1985, was also raised, and the result was a Conference Floor Action (see page 47).

On Thursday and Friday, Conference committees gave their reports, and each recommendation included was discussed by the full Conference. A.A.'s back home in the areas would be

impressed at the ample time allowed for minority opinions and at the great care given to the exact wording of each Advisory Action. (The complete list appears on pages 47-49.) This year, some issues considered were so complex that the Conference began to run behind schedule, and two less vital agenda items had to be dropped: an Ask-It Basket and a workshop.

The final presentation/discussion, on "Anonymity in Personal Recovery," brought in a measure of serenity, which was confirmed at the close of business sessions in a moving talk by Nell Wing (see page 7).

On Saturday morning, the enthusiasm expressed on the preceding Sunday was still evident, as Conference members and other guests enjoyed a closing brunch and listened to farewell talks by rotating trustees. Weary, but proud to have served, members of the 33rd General Service Conference said their goodbyes with renewed unity and tolerance, and with deepened faith in the Conference process and God's purpose in guiding them to become trusted servants of A.A.

On the first day of the Conference, G.S.O.'s office manager, Tony Osnato, was informed that our Hospitality Room wasn't open. Puzzled, Tony asked the hotel to investigate. It seems that a psychodrama meeting in a nearby room had gotten too dramatic for one participant, who had then been taken to the seclusion of our room to recover.

Keystone

'Salvation from self'

I invite you to consider our 33rd General Service Conference as an opportunity to grow through participation, and I expect that each of us in our own way will keep foremost in our mind that our purpose is to serve God and our fellows.

Perhaps this week, away from hometown A.A., we might accept this Conference as our new group. I invite you to extend to its members the same courtesy, love, dedication, and attention that we do in our groups. This large business meeting of hometown A.A.—U.S. and Canada—will surely have differences of opinion. I would be disappointed if it didn't. However, let us deal with the principles in our Legacies. Let us be cognizant of the right of all to participate, to express ourselves freely; let us accept the decision of our ultimate authority, a loving God as he expresses Himself in our group conscience.

Bill wrote, "Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence." Dr. Bob went on to tell us that "to acquire a spirit of dedicated service is what this Fellowship is all about, and those among us who fail to acquire this spirit . . . may have missed the single most important principle that A.A. has to give." Only through regular attention to A.A. principles am I granted a reprieve to be free of active alcoholism. Freedom from self through service is truly "the language of the heart."

Our Fellowship will endure as a haven for the ugly, the sick, the beautiful, and the recovered—providing that we, as trusted servants, accept the challenge to learn and do God's will, develop the discipline of humility, and set aside the need to be right.

But there appears to be developing within our Society a rigidity, a perceived need for law and order, a determination to enforce the Traditions to the letter, without any elasticity. If that attitude became widespread, the Fellowship could not function.

We have been allowed the privilege to serve A.A., to affect the direction in which this Fellowship travels. Therefore, isn't it important for us to develop an ability to communicate, an atmosphere in which all may labor with the least possible confrontation? "The easier, softer way" appears simple: Set aside the rigidity and need of law, and focus on our primary purpose—carrying our message of hope to the alcoholic who still suffers.

In A.A.'s future, there will doubtless, from time to time, be a need to change. Change must come slowly. It will require considerable debate and discussion, prayer and meditation. It will require dedicated servants who truly appreciate the fine line between resoluteness and self-centered aggression. More important, changes must come about only to serve a genuine need. They will call for more than a majority; they will call for substantial unanimity that only the power of God will grant.

An area of my personal service life that has caused me pain and anxiety has been the rationalization of vigorously pursuing change under the pretext that I have asked for the "courage to change the things I can," without—yes, without the "wisdom to know the difference." At times, we all involve ourselves in foolish things. So I invite you to listen, to think, to ask for direction before pursuing a point that perhaps need not be made or may be divisive. This Fellowship lives and breathes on our ability to rely on and accept one another with our strengths, our weaknesses, our defects of character, our humanness.

Dr. Jack, our longtime nonalcoholic friend, always talks about trusting the process, allowing the process to work. It does work, even when threatened by those who appear foolhardy; but let us remember that often the minority and its right of appeal or petition make the difference between right and wrong.

Watch our nonalcoholic trustees this week; note their desire and willingness to serve; be aware of the sacrifices they continue to make. Past servants of A.A., alcoholic and non, have given us much to be grateful for. It is our duty and responsibility to pick up where they left off. Our founders and oldtimers, alcoholic and nonalcoholic alike, vested in us the authority for giving shape to this Fellowship through the labor of delegates, staff, trustees, and service workers. We must trust our destiny in God, as we do our labor, and rise to our several tasks.

The theme of this Conference is "Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation." When invited to make this presentation, I read back through several *Conference* and *World Service Meeting Reports* and was not surprised to find that the principle of anonymity has had a significant workout. Perhaps you, like me, might wonder about the continuous discussions on the same old topic. Well, as my sponsor once explained to me, the faces of our Fellowship constantly change. So that our history and its principles do not get set aside, we must be repetitive. There will be much discussion here around the Conference theme. For that reason, I determined not to discuss it, except to say that the principle enshrined within our Traditions of anonymity is salvation from self—the assurance, the guarantee, of our continued usefulness to God and our fellows.

Stan Cameron, trustee-at-large/Canada

Welcome

'Honest with myself . . . true to you'

Our theme this year, "Anonymity — Our Spiritual Foundation," could not have been more aptly chosen for the responsibilities that lie before us. In considering decisions this week, I need to keep my motives pure. I must think of our primary purpose as a fellowship, not of mine as an individual. My way is not always the right way; yours may be the best way for *us*. I must be honest with myself so that I can be true to you. I need to speak from my experience for the benefit of unity and not for the benefit of Jill. That may mean practicing restraint when I have something clever to say, but if the thought is not pertinent to our purpose, then it should remain unspoken.

At the same time, it is important for me to share experiences and concerns that do seem pertinent to the issue at hand. It is important for me to give so that I may receive. If I give of myself to you and you give of yourselves to me, then a truly informed group conscience can come about. When there is a choice between a selfish and perhaps self-seeking vote and an unselfish and other-directed vote, then I must get myself out of the way.

When giving the Conference report upon returning to my area, I will carry the message of what happens here this week much more in principle than in personality. If I choose to share how I felt or voted, then that is my choice. But in the *spirit* of anonymity, I don't feel I am free to share how any other person (by name or area) voted or felt.

I welcome you all, not as Jill Johnston, not as your delegate chairperson, but as one alcoholic to another alcoholic. May we all work together this week by practicing A.A. principles in the Conference activities, and by placing principles above personalities.

Jill Johnston (Southern Indiana), delegate chairperson



In the Roosevelt Hotel's Oval Room, G.S.O. personnel took turns staffing the service "desk." On duty here: two department supervisors, John Kirwin (Accounting) and Elizabeth Garcia (Steno/Clerical); from Steno, Elsie Oxman and Adeline Wilmot, who assists the Conference coordinator.

Delegates meeting

New chairperson elected

On Tuesday evening, April 19, Panels 32 and 33 delegates dined

together and then met informally for an evening of presentations, discussion, and a general sharing session. Topics brought up ranged from area practices regarding alternates and C.P.C. committees to 13th-stepping. A contribution was collected to buy candy for the G.S.O. stenographers who helped at the Conference.

Michael Cushman (Southern Florida) was elected as the new delegate chairperson; Dorothy Garvin (Eastern Pennsylvania), as alternate chairperson. Both took office immediately upon the close of the Conference.

Conference sidelights

Spouses of Conference delegates enjoyed an exciting week of varied activities while their partners were immersed in Conference business. A committee of New York A.A.'s and Al-Anons planned a stimulating agenda for the visitors. Monday, April 18: a walking tour in midtown Manhattan; lunch in the Citicorp arcade. Tuesday: a tour of Lincoln Center; lunch at the Allegro Restaurant; coffee and cake at the home of an A.A. member. Wednesday: a walking tour of the historic Wall Street district; a tour of the Federal Reserve Bank; lunch at the World Trade Center. Thursday: a tour of the Metropolitan Museum of Art; lunch at the museum. Friday: a Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan. . . . The following statistics (in years) give a composite sketch of the 1983 Conference delegate: age, from 35 to 74, averaging 51; length of sobriety, from 5 to 30, averaging 12; length of A.A. service activity, from 2 to 30, averaging 10.

Closing talk

Nell remembers past Conferences

Late on Friday afternoon, at the end of the tiring but rewarding week, Conference members were treated to a refreshing closing talk by Nell Wing. Formerly Bill Wilson's secretary, Nell was A.A.'s beloved archivist for almost ten years, retiring in 1982 after more than 35 years of service to the Fellowship. A panorama of A.A. history swept before the Conference as Nell enchanted all with her experiences at these annual meetings in the early years (1950's and 1960's). She remembered Bill as the focal point, "the heartbeat of the Conference. When Bill was at the Conference," she said, "it was a cohesive whole."

Nell delighted the Conference with her personal anecdotes, too. She recalled that in 1951, at the First Conference (held at the Commodore Hotel), she was appointed official "bouncer." Weighing in at a hefty 102 pounds, Nell was supposed to sit at the door and inform would-be crashers that only Conference members could participate. When the first approached—a "big guy"—she lost her nerve. Finally, she mustered enough courage to explain to the local A.A. why he was not allowed to attend, whereupon the "big guy" courteously retreated.

Many other recollections offered by Nell concluded the 33rd General Service Conference on a sparkling and humorous note. Nell's love for A.A. and her dedicated service to the Fellowship inspired gratitude in the hearts of all 1983 Conference members.

Closing brunch

A time of renewal

On Saturday, April 23, members of the 1983 General Service Conference gathered in the Terrace Room for the final time. After they enjoyed brunch, Gordon Patrick introduced Jill Johnston (Southern Indiana), outgoing delegate chairperson. Mike Cushman (Southern Florida), new delegate chairperson, then read "How It Works."

Bob Pearson shared insights about the annual meeting, comparing Conference week to the emergent spring—a time of renewal in our A.A. lives. He expressed thanks to all persons who assisted with the Conference and its publications, including Elizabeth Garcia, Virginia Poole, Adeline Wilmot, Tony Osnato, Elsie Oxman, Janet Graves, Dorothy Graham, and Betty Liddle (Conference coordinator).

Reaffirming rotation as a spiritual principle, Gordon introduced the outgoing trustees, whose farewell talks are excerpted here.

'What more could I ask?'

Stan Cameron, trustee-at-large/Canada, shared memories of his childhood poverty, and then told of one memorable Sunday.

"A guy visited our home, without invitation, and shared with me a story about what it used to be like, what happened, and what it was like now. As a result of that sharing, I found myself at a meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous that night. At another meeting the next day, a guy said, 'If you will do the simple things that A.A. asks you, I will guarantee you three things: that you will never find it necessary to drink again; that you will never have to spend another day in jail; and that you will become happier than you ever thought possible.' I had spent a lifetime, it seems, trying to find a way of never having to take a drink again; I had a deep desire to never go to jail again; and I had spent my whole life trying to find one small degree of happiness. And so I walked with you, and I talked with you, and I listened to you.

"My service story is simple. My sponsor said, 'You'll go to the assembly.' My sponsor said, 'You'll serve as a G.S.R.' But on reflection, I still believe that it starts at the group. If I should have a wish or a prayer this day, it will be that as I leave you, the group will continue to bestow service to God and my fellows upon me as I return and sit among them. For you see, since I came to you, I've never found it necessary to take a drink; I've never had to spend a night in jail; and I've become happier than I ever thought possible. And for a guy like me, that's not a bad deal. What more could I ask?"

'Markings on my own personal journey'

Dick Driscoll, Northeast regional trustee, began his talk by remembering the late LaVelle Clifford, who was elected trustee at the same time he was. Then, he recalled his early A.A. days.

"I've had only one sponsor, as I use the term — because he meant so much to me. Many other people during my A.A. life have provided me with sponsorship-type help, but Gene liter-

ally saved my life. He decided I ought to be a G.S.R., and I got into service that way. Coming on the board was just a logical extension of where he was trying to lead me. The legacy he left me was never to forget from whence I came.

"Serving on the board of trustees has been another journey, a labor of love, something I'll treasure for the rest of my life. In this program, I learned to live, and I learned how to love. It began with Gene, and it hasn't ended here, I'm sure, because it's just another stop — markings on my own personal journey. When I return to my own group, I will be doing that which I feel I can do best, what Gene taught me how to do — make myself available when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help.

"This Conference, like the others that I've attended, will leave its mark on me. I've had the privilege of seeing the whole A.A. structure open up before me, coming alive in A.A.W.S., coming alive in the committee system, coming alive as each Conference achieves its own identity. On this, the last day, everybody is here in a spirit of fellowship and a little bit of nostalgia. But saying goodbye is not my thing. So I'll just say, 'May the good Lord bless and keep you until we meet again.'"

A second chance

John Ryall, general service trustee, delivered a warm and humorous talk, remembering his beginnings in A.A. — having no place else to go—when he was given a second chance to live. Earlier in Conference week, he had outlined his growth in service as part of a lively presentation (page 23). Expressing gratitude to those with whom he has served, John affirmed his belief in the rotation principle and the return to service at the group level.

**Estimates of Groups and Members—
Spring 1983**

	Groups	Members
United States	26,608	518,790
Canada	3,948	66,344
Overseas	20,669 ¹	412,418 ¹
Treatment facilities	1,030 ²	25,750 ²
Correctional facilities	1,321 ²	40,951 ²
Lone Members		515
Internationalists		531
	53,576	1,065,299

1 A.A. activity was reported in 108 overseas countries. Among them, 38 supplied no estimates of groups and members; estimates for figures there were obtained by taking an average among 62 countries that did respond (eight others responding—the largest—were excluded).

2 U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Conference Members Discuss Fellowship Concerns From Anonymity to 'Other Drugs'

Presentations

Anonymity—when and why

Following logically upon the Conference theme and keynote talk, the first presentation/discussion took place on Monday morning. Michael Alexander, Class A trustee, introduced the speakers and served as moderator in the discussion.

'Unique in a world of promotion and hustle'

Who among us does not wish to be recognized? Who among us does not wish to be praised for what we do? Who among us wants to admit complete defeat, to reach out to someone else for help—and worse, to have our friends know we are doing it? Those are some of the reasons for anonymity.

Most of my life was characterized by actions designed to bring me praise. I set about systematically trying to please people, to bask in their praise. That phase of my life was unfulfilling and disastrous, for my motive was selfish in the worst sense. It led me to seeking credit whether or not it was due; it led me to trying to escape blame by alibis and lies. It led me to bitterness and disappointment when praise was not commensurate with my expectation. It led me to an ungrateful and alienated way of life. I needed help.

I found Alcoholics Anonymous. It was a relief to know my friends would not find out unless I told them. I found a group ready, willing, and able to accept me as I was. I needed no more pretense, no more image. They did not care who I was. They cared only how I felt. In that group were people who gave service to other alcoholics and sought no recognition or reward. That quality was foreign to me. These people had honesty and humility—also foreign qualities.

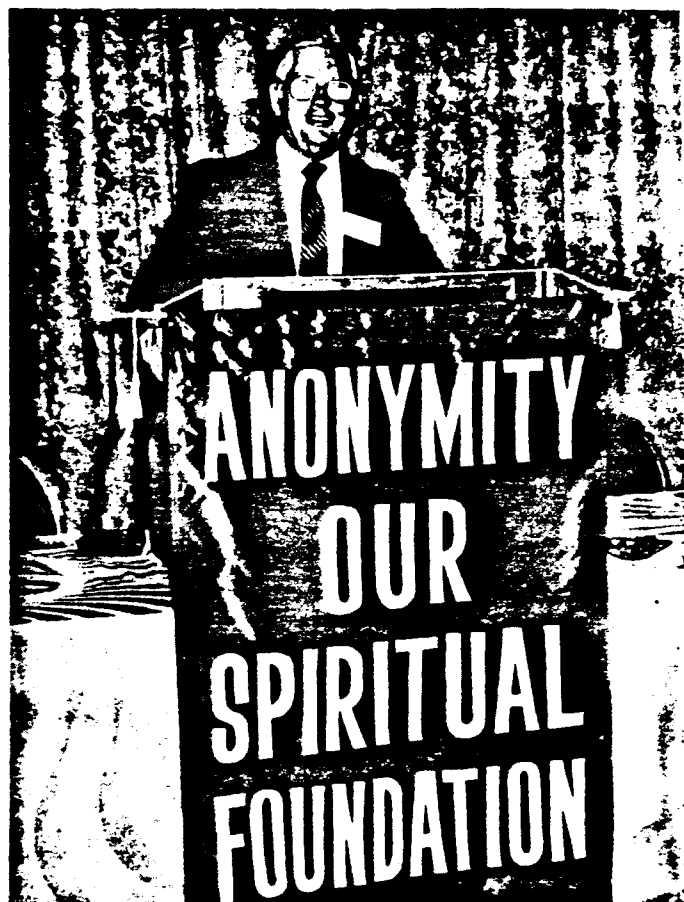
Over time, during recovery, came opportunities for service: on various committees; as G.S.R.; at conferences; in radio and newspaper interviews—and there came my first recognition of the need for anonymity in the public media. If I was identified in those interviews, people with a drinking problem might feel they had to contact me; that could lure me back into seeking praise and recognition. And if the community came to identify me as a spokesman for the Fellowship, what would be the effect if I gave misinformation or, worse, got drunk again? Risks and responsibilities like those I did not need. So anonymity was the practical answer.

People who encounter suffering alcoholics are coming to know about A.A. and think highly of it because we decided not to

Alcoholic or non?

"Dr. Jack" Norris (Class A trustee emeritus) recalled that he appeared many years ago on one of the first TV programs on alcoholism. A.A.'s were photographed from behind, and each one said, "I am an alcoholic, and my name is . . ." When his turn came, Dr. Jack said simply, "I am Dr. John Norris, and I am not an alcoholic. I am chairman of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous."

Next day, one of the doctors in Dr. Jack's office congratulated him on the program, saying, "It was a wonderful show, but I'm worried about you. You're the only one who didn't confess!"



A new hand was at the helm of the annual meeting—Gordon Patrick, elected chairperson of the General Service Board just after the 1982 Conference.

promote ourselves, but rather to quietly get well and quietly help others. Our friends find us unique in a world of promotion and hustle.

(Within our Fellowship, we often overdo anonymity. How many times have we tried to contact a Terry P. or a Mary D.? Pretty hard to do! Perhaps at group level and in communication one to another, we could dispense with anonymity. After all, we are all in this together.)

If, as A.A. members, we can each refuse public prestige and renounce any desire for personal power, we can work in harmony with other members of the group. And group unity is responsible for our sobriety. As the last line of "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" tells us, "We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have."

Phil Cels (Manitoba)

Should A.A. take part in health fairs?

Since I have been sober in A.A., during times of turmoil, unrest, and anxiety, my first thought is to call my sponsor. That was my reaction when I began to prepare this presentation. I have not had any personal experiences with health fairs, but my sponsor was directly involved with a large fair held in Spring-

field, Mass., in 1976 when she was delegate. Her experiences with members of A.A. were, to say the least, interesting.

A community physician contacted her with an invitation for A.A. to have a display booth at a health fair sponsored by the Greater City of Springfield. She brought the message to our Public Information Committee with the intent of simply forming a committee to staff the booth and order literature for distribution. She was met with resounding dissent from the P.I. Committee. They voted against participating in a health fair. They felt this was promotion and also an anonymity break. She was undaunted, because she felt the opposition rose from an uninformed group conscience.

The delegate then prepared her arguments on the two issues for the area committee. On promotion: An A.A. display booth at a health fair, she said, was simply a way of letting people know that A.A. was a recovery program for the disease of alcoholism. On anonymity: Those staffing the display booth were not to give their last names and need not say they were A.A. members. An A.A. concerned about personal anonymity did not *have* to help staff the booth. She commented on our fear of losing our anonymity as sober members of A.A.—when during the acute phase of our illness, we had no concept of the numbers of people who viewed us as hopeless drunks.

The area committee overwhelmingly approved our participation in the health fair. During the enormously successful, three-day event, thousands of people attended, and our booth received its share of attention from the public and health professionals. We tried to have as much literature as possible on display. A list of names and addresses was kept for people requesting additional pamphlets, which A.A. members mailed after the close of the fair. The press and TV, respecting our anonymity Tradition, did not print A.A. members' names in newspapers or photograph members at the display booth. Our participation in the health fair is still being discussed in our area. Many A.A.'s involved in it are still active on our P.I. Committee.

But in researching A.A. members' opinions, I was amazed at the number of people who still feel that health fairs are promotion rather than attraction, and that A.A. members involved in these enterprises are breaking their anonymity. I find these opinions disheartening. A health fair can only *attract* doctors, psychologists, and members of the clergy to learn more about the A.A. program.

It is of utmost importance that we, as sober members of A.A., totally accept that alcoholism is a disease. If we cannot accept this truth, how can we expect the world to accept it? This was a large health fair; associations representing various life-threatening diseases were represented. Heart, diabetes, cancer, tuberculosis associations informed people of early-warning signs and ways to avoid these catastrophic illnesses through changes in life-style. Was that promotion? No, just a means of reducing the mortality rate attributed to these diseases.

Can we do less for the alcoholics? They are suffering a disease that eventually incapacitates the victim and leads to death—a disease that destroys families, fills our prisons and mental institutions, and causes needless slaughter on our highways. How many lives did we save through that health fair? How many families gained insight into the disease affecting their loved ones? In my opinion, if only one person found sobriety, if only one family found peace and sanity, it was well worth the

time spent in preparation and staffing of our display booth.

In the spirit of our Tradition, was our anonymity ever really broken? Our full names or faces were never revealed at the level of press, radio, or TV. By simply staffing the display booth, we were not identifying ourselves as members of A.A. The people staffing the Heart Association booth did not necessarily have heart disease.

I hope we have more invitations to participate in health fairs in our area. It is a great opportunity to help increase public awareness and minimize the stigma attached to alcoholism. It is an opportunity to reach the professionals who have proved in the past to be our best friends.

I am personally very grateful to the Conference for giving me this opportunity to help me bring into focus my own personal views on the vital area of communication at the public level.

Betty Reed (Western Massachusetts)

Love note

While Bill Dick (Panel 32, Idaho) was qualifying at the A.A. meeting on Sunday night, he expressed gratitude to his loyal and loving wife, who had seen him through many dark years of active alcoholism and was now his partner on the journey of sobriety. He told of her habit of writing notes. In fact, she had pinned this note to the suit he was wearing Sunday night:

"Thought I'd follow along and wish you luck tonight with your talk—your H.P. and I are with you. Want you to know you comfort me and complement my life. Because of you—our experiences together—my life is whole. You found A.A., and together through the program, we've found life. I love you and need you.—Beth Marie"

'Examine our motives'

Anonymity—certainly not the kind of thing that once occupied our thoughts on a Monday morning. But what a quaint idea! How antiquated for 1983. Surely now, with A.A. membership in excess of one million and the public acceptance of alcoholism as a disease, we need no longer concern ourselves with the need for anonymity in the public media. And isn't it time that at least some of our hardworking leaders were given the recognition they deserve from the Fellowship? Isn't G.S.O. large enough and flexible enough to handle requests for help if we go public and popularize recovery? Why can't we use advertising's finest techniques to reach those still suffering? Weren't the Traditions of anonymity born out of fear that the Fellowship would collapse if it went public too soon?

Those are legitimate questions, but they and others like them sometimes thinly disguise the rationalizations we are all capable of when it comes to doing good. Fortunately, we can fall back on Tradition Eleven when dealing with the media. In my area, anonymity breaks are the exception rather than the rule. Last year, one newspaper item was brought to my attention, and a follow-up revealed that the paper, a small weekly, had obtained

the A.A. speaker's name from another source and printed it with no harm intended. It has since mended the error of its ways. Larger newspapers and other media are quite aware, through G.S.O., of our Tradition of anonymity and defer to our request to use first names only and no pictures.

Dr. Milton Maxwell, in writing the history of the Washingtonian movement of the 1840's, revealed that one cause of its collapse was the ego-stroking that the movement encouraged. Personalities emerged; a clear-cut primary purpose became diffused into a muddle of worthy causes; and the strength necessary for survival evaporated. Likewise, our archives contain the history of A.A.'s early "public people," including Bill himself, and the subsequent lessons about the need for public anonymity that grew from those early years.

Do those hard-won lessons mean we should *always* remain anonymous? I still hear members say: "I broke my anonymity when I gave his wife my last name and phone number." At a recent small A.A. discussion meeting I attended, there were seven present, five of whom were named John—of those, four gave no last names. In such instances, there is no purpose in hiding our identity. Both cases reveal that remaining too anonymous can cause confusion and a breakdown of communications within A.A. We do instruct by example. To an individual or group member, such examples say: "Don't use your last name ever, or you are breaking your anonymity."

Another facet of monkey-see-monkey-do applies at the media level: "If I go public, it's all right for you to do the same. (Oh, if only other recovered alcoholics could carry the message as well as I do and for the same good reasons!)"

So when is anonymity appropriate? Most certainly, any occasion that might teach others to do likewise in public demands a cautious approach. If a break could result in personal recognition or financial recompense, we might do well to examine our motives and weigh carefully in the balance the benefits. What is wrong with recognition of our accomplishments—public or otherwise? If we get paid or gain access, even indirectly, to better employment or persons of influence, is there really anything wrong with that?

Perhaps not—at least, for many people. But the experience of 48 years has shown that A.A. members who seek public recognition are sometimes driven by forces of self-destruction rather than self-improvement. In that respect, Traditions Eleven and Twelve guard us against a slip from sanity that could take us back to those Monday mornings when the last thought to enter our minds was anonymity.

John Currier (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire)

Advisory Action related to anonymity: 30 (p. 48)

Point of order!

Returning to the Roosevelt Hotel from their visit to G.S.O., Conference members were aghast when the subway train stopped and the motorman shouted, "Empty this train!" Trustee John Ryall solemnly told the delegates they should have asked the motorman to take a "sense of the train" before they obeyed him.

Anonymity—when and why

With the morning session still fresh in their minds, Conference members continued the same topic in a workshop Monday evening. Groups of about ten each gathered in separate rooms; Panel 32 delegates and trustees were the moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.

'Recovery from a spiritual defect'

1 "Do A.A.'s in your area use first and last names at closed meetings? When speaking at open meetings? What does the anonymity Tradition tell us about this practice?"

All workshops reported widely divergent practices within their areas. Some felt that members tended to be more anonymous in smaller communities. All felt it was a matter of personal preference. And it was agreed in most workshops that we could be *too* anonymous inside A.A., making it difficult for the new person to maintain needed contact between meetings.

2 "What is the experience in your area with using full names and/or pictures of A.A. members in A.A. newsletters? In minutes of service meetings? On TV and videotapes? In newspapers and books?"

In almost all areas, full names are used in minutes of service meetings. Most areas do not use pictures *or* last names of A.A. members in institution or central office bulletins. Anonymity breaks do occur in the press, radio, and TV, though this is infrequent. Most felt breaks occurred when A.A. members are uninformed. Some felt we should do more to impress upon the media the essential reasons for our need for anonymity.

3 "Are group officers and members in your area aware of the importance of including first *and* last names in correspondence with G.S.O. and other service entities?"

Almost everyone responded yes to both of these questions, though errors are sometimes made by the uninformed.

4 "How does maintaining our anonymity at the personal level help or hinder us in carrying the message to suffering alcoholics whom we meet outside A.A.?"

Almost all felt that maintaining personal anonymity was a hindrance in helping the suffering alcoholics we meet on the outside, and that it was an individual decision in each situation. One workshop suggested examination of motives. Most felt we should tell our doctor, dentist, clergy member, etc. that we are in A.A.

5 "How does rotation relate to the Twelfth Tradition?"

One workshop reporter summed up what all seemed to be saying: "There are many reasons for rotation other than its relation to the Twelfth Tradition. If it didn't occur, none of us could be here, or perhaps even sober. However, its relation to the Tradition is a concern for the spiritual condition of people in service positions."

6 "Why is anonymity the spiritual foundation of the Fellowship?"

Here are some quotes from workshop reporters:

"Anonymity in the broadest sense is the recovery from a spiritual defect through suppression of self to the requirements of our recovery program."

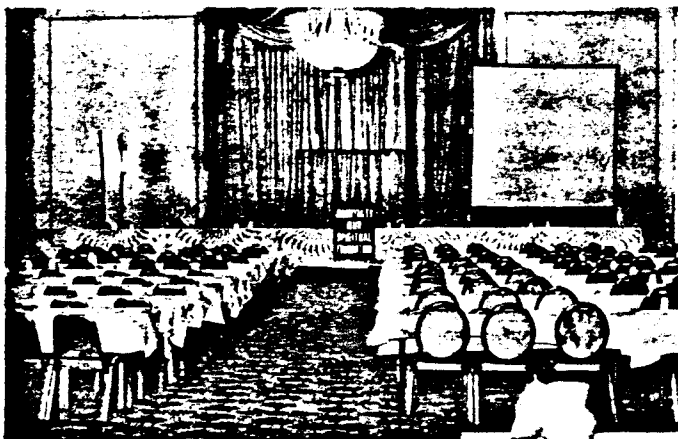
"... It ensures the unity, effectiveness, and welfare of A.A."

"Salvation from ourselves."

"Humility!"

"Spiritual anonymity is greatly misunderstood. Suggest workshop on this at local level. Most felt it is basis for unity at all levels of Fellowship."

Advisory Action related to anonymity: 30 (p. 48)



To show films and filmstrips, a screen was set up in the Terrace Room.

Usefulness of G.S.O. filmstrip

In preparation for this Tuesday-morning session, Conference members watched two G.S.O. filmstrips on Sunday afternoon.

Our filmstrip needs renovating, too!

The background and purpose of these audiovisual aids were outlined by Bob Pearson, general manager of G.S.O. "Welcome to G.S.O.," produced in 1972, took the form of a 40-minute office tour, in which staff members gave detailed information on their assignments. The current filmstrip is "P.O. Box 459," first made available in 1976; it is a faster-paced impression of the services of the General Service Office, 25 minutes long. However, its locale is the old offices that prompted the 1980 Conference to recommend renovation and refurbishing of both G.S.O. and Grapevine quarters; and there have been personnel changes.

In the discussion that followed, Conference members who went to the floor microphones agreed that an up-to-date version was indeed called for. The sense of the meeting was: A new G.S.O. filmstrip should be produced; it should follow about the same format as "P.O. Box 459" and run from 20 to 30 minutes; staff members should appear, but there should not be too many names or too many statistics that might tend to date it.

The A.A. Grapevine

On Tuesday afternoon, Grapevine managing editor Retha Gresham introduced the five panelists. When the presentations ended, she was confronted by a rush to the floor microphones—sign of widespread interest in our magazine.

Designing a 'meeting in print'

When I stood in this spot two years ago, I stated with enthusiasm that I loved my job. Well, today, I want to say it again, only more so—more so because the job has become more interesting and more challenging.

As art editor of the Grapevine, I am chiefly concerned with the Grapevine's art and layout of the magazine. The job is even more *interesting* now because we on the Grapevine staff and Editorial Board are determined to upgrade the quality of the Grapevine month by month. And it is more *challenging* because we are consumed with the effort to bring to the magazine a freshly minted, new look and yet keep that dependability and warmth—a warmth that many A.A.'s, newcomers and oldtimers alike, find so helpful to their sobriety. Quite a tall order!

Two years ago, I stated that I believed most A.A.'s wanted to live happy, productive lives one day at a time. I still believe that. We promised we would make each issue bring to the reader just that kind of hope and security. It's not easy to accomplish these things in a little 5½" × 7½" publication. But we are doing it!

Examples of our work appear on the covers of the March and May 1983 issues. March, with a photograph made by a member of our Fellowship, marks the first time (to our knowledge) that a photo has been used on the cover—opening up a whole new source of material. The method of production is a duotone, i.e., two colors; the second color subtly enhances the emotional effect of a black-and-white photo. May brings another first. Not only does Victor E. make his cover debut, but he also helps call attention to our lead article, "Who Was That Masked Man?"

The design of the inside of the book is studied to achieve maximum interest and, I hope, good taste—thanks in large part to many valuable suggestions by our Editorial Board.

All of this is made possible with the close cooperation of A.A. artists in the area, who are really remarkable in their willingness to operate on a voluntary basis—putting in much time and talent to help give our magazine an interesting and up-to-date appearance.

The almost daily visitors from all over the world who come to our offices are a constant joy to all of us. They make it easier to renew our objective of bringing to the Grapevine a new vitality and force for carrying the message—our reason for existence.

Tom Neary, art editor

Who, what, how, and why?

At a Grapevine Editorial Board meeting, I was describing the Grapevine to a couple of visitors, and I used the familiar phrase "a meeting in print." Much to my surprise, one board member reacted rather testily. "It's a cliché to call the Grapevine a meet-

ing in print," he grouched. "What does that *mean*? I've been to meetings that were so boring they weren't *fit* to print. I think we have an obligation to be interesting!"

His comment was typical of the reactions we, as editors, need and want. The Grapevine can develop and grow along with the Fellowship only if all of us apply to it a quality of thinking that examines every assumption, no matter how self-evident. For example, *do* we have an obligation to be interesting? After all, the Grapevine isn't *People* or *Playboy*. My home group exists to carry the message; it has no obligation to put on interesting meetings. Yet I firmly believe the Grapevine has that obligation. A.A. members have better sense than to read a boring magazine month after month — and if nobody reads the Grapevine, how can it carry the message?

In reality, the floods of material that land in my in-box every day virtually guarantee an abundance of new ideas, insights, and aids for staying sober and working the program. We can skim the cream off the top and keep the quality of the magazine high, and with A.A.'s rapid growth, that situation should only get better in the years to come.

People working at their sobriety — more than a million of them — are the raw materials that combine to make up every issue of the Grapevine. Readers all over the world send in manuscripts (about four times as many as we can use). Every one is read carefully and often discussed at length. We have a true group conscience, with all its varying points of view and built-in disagreements, and we believe that helps keep the Grapevine healthy. When a manuscript appears to cross that invisible line between creatively thought-provoking and harmfully controversial, we take it to the Editorial Board for a wider group conscience. And in the final analysis, the old editorial saw prevails: "When in doubt, leave it out."

In selecting material, we try to achieve as wide a representation as possible among A.A. members. Often, when a manuscript doesn't quite work as a whole, we can pick up the more striking or useful points and publish excerpts as a filler or letter. When that kind of editing, or any other major change, is done, of course we let the writer know.

I'm lucky enough to have in my office bound volumes of every issue of the Grapevine since it began as a newsletter for the New York City groups in June 1944. Occasionally, I take a "browsing break," and read through some of the old issues, and it's fascinating to see how closely the development of the Grapevine has paralleled the growth of A.A. Early issues were full of items from new groups, as well as developments in the alcoholism field in and out of A.A. and even hobby ideas for new members. These old Grapevines always give me a feeling for A.A. when it was young — all the wonder of the miracle, and a little fear, too, when early members thought that their miracle might, literally, "slip" away. There were more articles about slips then, and more drinking stories for purposes of identification. Bill W. supported and encouraged the Grapevine's editors from the very beginning; in the magazine, he hammered out many basic A.A. principles.

Browsing on through the years, I discern a gradual change. As A.A. has matured, and we have gained confidence in ourselves and in our collective sobriety, the Grapevine has published fewer drunkalogs and more articles on living sober and working the Steps.

One of the hardest parts of my job as editor is to turn down a worthwhile manuscript because we have more material than we can cram into 48 pages. (Luckily, I often have the chance to say yes to a later contribution by the same person — what alcoholic ever took no for an answer?) We try in each issue to hold an A.A. meeting that includes all the solid help and all the variety you'd find in a month of typical meetings. Over the past couple of years, the editors, the Editorial Board, and some members of the Corporate Board have been taking a hard look at the magazine, to see whether we could do our job better. Some changes have resulted: more brief, pithy fillers, for example; and on the whole, shorter, easier-to-read articles. Bill W. called the Grapevine a "forum for debate"; in the letters section, especially, readers air a range of views on pressing issues.

Since part of the Grapevine's mandate is to reflect A.A. as it is today, we've published some articles by A.A.'s with a dual addiction, or with other problems that require medication. The combination of protest and praise we received read like a group *business* meeting! As a result, we've taken a break from such articles; but with about 25% of A.A.'s membership dually addicted, we believe we cannot genuinely serve the Fellowship as a whole if we ignore this reality, and we'll continue to deal with the issue when an article seems appropriate and helpful.

"Helpful" is the operative word. The final criterion for a decision on any Grapevine article is: Will it help or harm the Fellowship as a whole? Any Grapevine article carries some part of the A.A. message, whether it shares individual guidelines for working a particular Step or illuminates a current problem. As long as all of you keep the articles coming, the Grapevine will carry the message in the most effective way: from the pen of each writer to the mind and heart of each reader.

Ann Warner, editor

Big Book liberation

Ralph Goers (Panel 33, Southern California) admits to buying his first Big Book at the 33rd General Service Conference. It seems that when Ralph sobered up, his wife was already sober in A.A., and he had been sharing her Big Book all those years.

The Grapevine as a P.I./C.P.C. tool

When I came into A.A., I was lonely and afraid. Being a product of an institution, I already had a Big Book and the "Twelve and Twelve." But I also had a desire for more knowledge of this mysterious program. So I asked if there was anything more that I could take home and study, to learn more about this new way of life I was about to embark on. I was told, "Take home a Grapevine, dummy. You're not smart enough to read the Big Book yet!" That made me mad, but I took it home and read it anyway—and I have been reading it ever since. It wasn't long before I got tired of trying to remember to pick up a Grapevine at meetings, so I subscribed to it—and have done so ever since.

I am not a Grapevine collector. I keep giving them away. If I come in contact with people who want to help alcoholics, I give them Grapevines along with pamphlets. Most will say later that they enjoyed the magazine and will ask questions about one or more articles. A short time ago, I gave one to a young lady

whose father is drinking himself to death. She has expressed gratitude for what she learned from the Grapevine. We may never reach her father, but the Grapevine and other A.A. literature are now helping her understand alcoholism, and she has a little peace of mind.

In 1978, the Conference recommended that P.I., C.P.C., and correctional and treatment facilities committees explore the use of the Grapevine in their endeavors, and that we have Grapevine workshops, especially at the area level. In 1979, it was recommended that GvRs suggest to their groups the purchase of subscriptions for institutions, treatment facilities, and professionals being "sponsored." I think that at times we underestimate the Grapevine's value as a P.I. tool. It has the Preamble to tell us simply what A.A. is and is not; the Twelve Steps, for "how it works"; the Traditions, for "why it works"; and articles to prove that it does work, not only in the past, but right now.

For C.P.C. work, the Grapevine is something we can put in people's hands that is representative of our Fellowship, something that they can take home and read at leisure. We can give them A.A. literature dealing with their specific profession, and then use the Grapevine to help them gain broader understanding of the disease of alcoholism and what A.A. can do for it.

Should we sell our little magazine to hospitals and treatment centers? To doctors, psychiatrists, and counselors, to be passed on to their patients or clients? To the alcohol and drug programs of corporations and companies, to be passed out among their employees? We are obligated to sell the magazine to anyone who wants to buy it. And in fact, several treatment centers are buying subscriptions for patients who complete their programs.

Some A.A.'s say, "Oh, we can't let those people subscribe to our little magazine, because pretty soon they'll try to tell us what to put in it. They'll try to control us and tell us what to do." I think that concern is a bunch of bunk. After all, no one except another drunk seems to be able to tell a drunk anything. Instead of worrying about what these outside people are going to do to our magazine, why don't we think about what our magazine is going to do to them? After all, there are a lot of practicing alcoholics out there, and we know what the alternatives are if they don't find this program.

While we are trying to get people outside the Fellowship to read the Grapevine, we may find that we will educate more people within the Fellowship about what they are missing. We have a terrific tool to work with. It can be used over and over again. It is never out-of-date; no matter how old the issue is, it seems to work today. The only thing that is old is our way of using it. Please don't change the Grapevine—just change our ideas, and come up with new ways of using it. It is the best and broadest piece of hand literature we have. Use it!

*Cork Oberg (Nebraska), chairperson,
Conference Grapevine Committee*

Are we being selfish with the Grapevine?

Every time I find myself in a spot such as this, I wonder what I did wrong. This time I know. Me and my big mouth! A while back, I did some yapping on a subject about which I have strong feelings. There was a certain amount of agreement—and some strong opposition.

What caused this controversy? My belief that we should allow the A.A. Grapevine to be known and available to readers outside the program and membership of Alcoholics Anonymous.

It's my conviction that this belief is in line with A.A. precepts. Because of the great care taken in the phrasing of almost every statement in our basic and historic literature, it is no accident that our Preamble says: "Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety." Significantly, it does not read: "alcoholics only in A.A." Our Twelfth Step says: "tried to carry this message to alcoholics." By design, it does not say where those alcoholics must be. And our Fifth Tradition is: "Each group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." Each word carefully chosen!

None of us have to be told where most still-suffering alcoholics are—outside A.A., of course. These figures are familiar, too: an estimated one million alcoholics inside A.A.; roughly ten million outside the program. For every one person in A.A., feeling each day greater calm and understanding, there are ten others out somewhere, becoming increasingly enmeshed in terror and confusion.

Why do I believe the Grapevine can be of significant help to people outside the program? And why — for this purpose — do I pick the Grapevine over all other A.A. literature? Well (if you'll forgive a personal note), all my adult life I have been active in the communications industry, learning how best to word a suggestion that will lead to action, and how necessary to success it is to speak to a selected audience in a manner and language that will be meaningful to that audience. The Grapevine appears clearly to be the source of A.A. knowledge and experience that will be most acceptable, most understood, and therefore most readily absorbed by men and women outside our meeting rooms and still drinking.

The Grapevine is a collection of firsthand recountings of the thoughts and feelings, the failures and successes of people in A.A. today, some of them in the program only a little while. The Grapevine has a tone of immediacy as it reveals in the simplest language what people in A.A. are doing right now, maybe even this minute, to stay sober, to enjoy being sober, or if not enjoying it, at least preferring it to what was before. The articles are usually brief; the points, quick and easy to grasp. Only rarely is a long attention span required.

It would be selfish of me *not* to urge that through the Grapevine we somehow try to reach out and tell those still drinking what we did in the beginning and what we are doing now. How we would go about putting the Grapevine in their hands is another subject — but there must be many methods (rest assured, I do not propose that we give the magazine away!). Among the possibilities are hospitals, institutions, corporations, service organizations, schools, and universities. We cannot advertise the Grapevine, I know; but we can find ways to make its existence and its capabilities known outside the narrow corridor to which it is presently confined. Not to do so, I feel, is to say to those ten million out there: "Hey, I have something that helps with my sobriety, but I can't even tell you about it, because you're still drinking and *not* a member of A.A."

We are Alcoholics Anonymous. We are not Alcoholics Unknownamous. The achievements of A.A. are no secret. I believe the Grapevine will be warmly welcomed outside the

program, because it presents page after page of irrefutable evidence that every day, for all sorts of people, A. A. efforts work, A. A. hopes are realistic, and A. A. dreams come true — as they can for those millions still out there struggling and losing.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., Grapevine director

Our magazine's past, present, and future

The Grapevine started as a newsletter in June of 1944. The first printing was of 1,200 copies—about 1% of the current production. The total cost of that issue was \$187.10. The printing part cost \$86—current cost per issue is about \$14,000. Postage and delivery cost \$21.72. The cover price in those happy days was 15¢, and if you were a subscriber, it cost 12½¢.

The magazine operated in the red for most of its first 20 years, and was subsidized by advances or "loans" from the General Fund. In 1964, the Grapevine came into the black and was able to pay back those advances, totaling \$13,600, to the General Fund. In 1967, the Grapevine could begin sharing in the support of the fund, contributing \$5,000 that year and a total of \$134,000 over the next several years. Not until the late 1970's did the Grapevine go into the red again, because of a fixed cover price and escalating costs. The magazine became profitable again toward the end of 1982, and so far during 1983, it has continued to operate in the black.

The following numbers provide dramatic proof of the growth of the magazine:

	Circulation	Revenues
1962	38,100	\$149,000
1976	86,000	\$507,000
1982	121,500	\$993,000

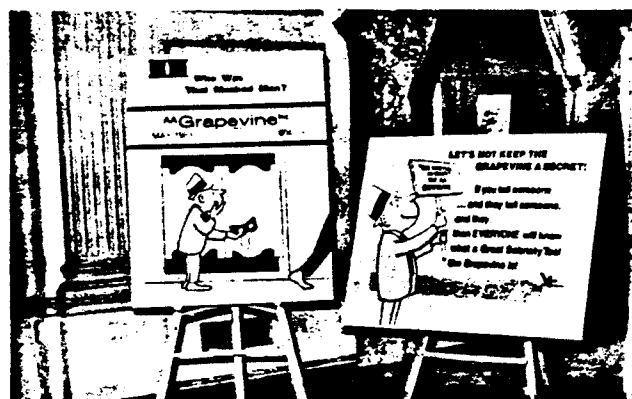
As I mentioned earlier, we are *marginally* profitable at present. In my judgment, the Grapevine Corporate Board would be doing an absolutely superb business job if, at the end of the year, we exactly covered costs. We are not trying to make money on the magazine; but conversely, we are not trying to lose money.

It has been the policy of the Corporate Board to keep the physical quality of the magazine the highest. We have resisted the purchase of cheap paper for inside pages or covers. Needless to say, the Editorial Board and the staff have the same high standards for the editorial content.

In 1949, when Al Steckman became editor, the Grapevine wasn't too well known around the country. There were many months when Al wrote the entire issue by himself, signing each article with a different set of initials and giving a different locality. Today, staff members do not have to write for the Grapevine. Manuscripts come from all over; we receive about 300 per month.

It has always interested me that A.A. members' concerns remain the same over the years. Many early issues treated the current topic of drugs and alcohol in considerable detail. On the subject of treatment centers, I am amused by the fact that A.A.'s used to worry about the lack of them and now seem to worry about the proliferation of them.

The Grapevine helps readers stay sober by bringing them a



Will A.A. service keep Victor E. away from that bar? He's helped the GV on a Conference cover display and a poster for local A.A. gatherings.

meeting in print. I estimate we have some 300,000 *readers*, because it seems to me each copy must be passed along at least twice. The magazine helps our Grapevine representatives stay sober, as it does the staff and the boards. Like everything else in A. A., the Grapevine is for those who want it, not those who need it. We have to keep that in mind when we get concerned internally here about circulation. In the end, we must trust the Higher Power's plan for the Grapevine. There are days when I'd like to go out and buttonhole people and make them subscribers, just as early members roamed the gin mills on Third Avenue looking for recruits. As those early members discovered, that was a mistake, and so is excessive promotion of subscriptions. I think our job is to make the magazine available to all and to make it attractive.

Despite our efforts, not all of our subscribers are always happy. Here's part of a letter to the Grapevine from "one of the two original Boston subscribers to an essential A.A. ingredient, the Grapevine":

"Why, oh why, and by what lottery-like methods do you send out your copies by mail? We have been plugging the paper here in Boston, but our temperamental A. A. clientele is sore because they not only do not get the paper, but the subscriptions are not acknowledged. If I were waiting for something of no importance, such as *Fortune* or the *New York Times*, I wouldn't give a hoot. But please, oh please, send us our Grapevine." That letter was received at the Grapevine in November of 1944. I take some consolation from that; we have not created all the problems of recent years out of thin air.

We are sensitive to specific problems of delivery, and we also must look ahead to the future. I believe that Grapevine subscriptions will continue to increase and that we must improve our method of delivery. To that end, the Grapevine is in the process of setting up its own subscription fulfillment service using new terminals, but utilizing the space in G.S.O.'s computer. By the end of 1983, we hope to be operational.

Our aim for the future is to produce your magazine at the lowest possible cost and with the highest possible quality and get it to our subscribers on time. The support of the delegates in this endeavor is essential. We would like to thank you for your past help and enlist you in our future plans.

Don Daly, chairperson, Grapevine Corporate Board

Advisory Actions related to the Grapevine: pp. 47-48

World Service Meeting

After lunch on Wednesday, U.S./Canada Conference members returned to the Terrace Room—to be reminded that they now represent just the oldtimer in a whole worldwide group of A.A. service structures.

'Free to give, to share, to love'

The Seventh World Service Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous took place in San Juan del Rio, Mexico, October 14-17, 1982. There were 37 delegates from 25 countries meeting at the beautiful La Mansion Hotel, a perfect setting.

Simultaneous (Spanish/English) translation available for the first time, during the general sessions, proved to be of great benefit to the eight delegates from Central and South American countries who spoke no English, and to most of us who spoke little, if any, Spanish. Of course, as in all A.A. get-togethers, the language of the heart transcended all barriers.

Proceedings began on Thursday afternoon with registration and a reception similar to our Sunday-afternoon Conference session. This was followed by a "red ball" meeting led by one of the delegates from South Africa. After a hearty dinner, the welcome and the opening prayer were given by the nonalcoholic chairperson of the A.A. General Service Board of Mexico. They were followed by a roll call and a reading of the statement of purpose; finally, the delegate from Finland gave an inspiring keynote address. In many ways, it seemed as though I was present at a U.S./Canada General Service Conference.

The ensuing days were filled with committee meetings, reports, service highlights, workshops, presentations, and workshop report-backs, interspersed with coffee breaks, dinners, and sharing sessions. At the closing session on Monday morning, second-term delegates had the opportunity to express spontaneously how the experience had enhanced not only their own personal lives, but their roles as trusted servants. A *Final Report of the Seventh World Service Meeting* is available to all A.A. members.

We have found that as we sponsor person-to-person, so can we sponsor country-to-country. We have seen that A.A. transplants very well! The seed sown first in North America now flourishes in South America, Africa, Australia, New Zealand, Asia, the British Isles, and Europe. Perhaps one day we will penetrate the Iron Curtain.

In 1967, Bill sought a way to share with A.A. groups and members around the world the experience of the evolution of A.A. service in North America. Thus, the concept of the Meetings was born. It was my privilege to participate in the most recent as a delegate representing the U.S./Canada Conference Section.

A few of the suggestions of the Seventh World Service Meeting follow:

- It was suggested that the theme for the Eighth World Service Meeting be built around "The World Service Meeting Takes Its Inventory."

- A few countries were experiencing a problem with the recently combined "The A.A. Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts for World Service," as many countries now have their

own service manuals. Delegates requested that A.A.W.S. again publish "Twelve Concepts" separately. [See page 34.]

- The Meeting expressed satisfaction with the simultaneous-translation facilities and recommended that similar services be provided at the Eighth Meeting.

- It was recommended that, while the W.S.M. should continue to be the main forum for exchange of A.A. service experience worldwide, zonal or regional service meetings continue to be held in alternate years as an important means of communication among countries in the same zone or region.

- After considerable discussion on problems concerning A.A. Conference-approved literature, the consensus of the Literature/Publishing Committee was that countries selling only A.A. Conference-approved literature were experiencing little or no difficulties, but countries selling more non-Conference-approved literature were having problems. The committee suggested informing A.A.'s that Conference-approved literature reflects the view of A.A. as a whole, whereas non-Conference-approved literature often represents the thinking of one person, and not the collective A.A. group conscience.

- In regard to carrying the A.A. message and alcoholism prevention, it was the sense of the Working With Others Committee meeting that alcoholism prevention is not within the scope of A.A. We have no experience in preventing alcoholism, but we can share experience about recovery from alcoholism. We can bring to the public an awareness of where alcoholics can receive help.

There were workshops on "Communication Between Countries," "Women in A.A.," "Public Information," and "The Twelve Concepts." The last proved to be especially rewarding for all participants.

Perhaps, the spirit of the Meeting is best exemplified by the final agenda item: the Serenity Prayer offered in all of the languages represented. The delegates from Trinidad/Tobago then surprised everyone by singing a song used to close A.A. meetings in their country. The five days we spent together are described in detail in the *Final Report*, but the spirit, the feeling, the joy, the love, and the essence of that Meeting are in the hearts of those of us who shared the common experience. We were then, and are now, part of a process, a process that creates a group conscience. Truly, Bill's vision is steadily unfolding.

Through such worldwide sharing, countries with developing service structures benefit greatly from the experience of more established structures, as the following story indicates. In 1951, Ann Macfarlane, a G.S.O. staff member for years, responded to a call for help from an alcoholic in Argentina. Within a few months, there was a little A.A. group there. With much sharing of experience between G.S.O. and the group as the years passed, Argentine A.A. grew and flourished. Finally, a G.S.O. was opened. In 1981, in Buenos Aires, A.A. in Argentina hosted the Second Spanish-American Service Meeting. Argentina had been sponsoring Uruguay, and as a result, A.A.'s in Uruguay sent two delegates to that zonal meeting.

A board was formed in Uruguay, and last year Uruguay requested admission to the Seventh World Service Meeting. One of its two delegates came to New York City at the conclusion of the W.S.M., and he was invited to attend a meeting of the trustees'

International Committee. One of the members of that committee is Ann Macfarlane. The A.A. member from Uruguay was introduced to the former G.S.O. staff member—their hands clasped—and so the circle was complete.

A World Service Meeting doesn't just happen. Two years' preparation is necessary. All W.S.M. delegates were impressed by the time, effort, experience, and love freely shared by the staff of the Mexican G.S.O., by staff members from our own G.S.O., and by two of our G.S.O. secretarial employees (both of whom speak fluent Spanish).

As I was flying back to the U.S. after being in Mexico for one week—no TV, no newspaper, no telephone interruptions—just being totally free to give, to share, to love, and in return to receive so much love and experience—a feeling of total wholeness engulfed me. And it was all made possible as the result of one drunk talking to another.

David Aronofsky, W.S.M. delegate (U.S./Canada)



The member, the group, and their monies

After the last trustee election was over, on Wednesday afternoon, the Conference still sounded like a large-scale group business meeting, tackling the unavoidable topic of money. Natalie Schwanke, Pacific U.S. regional trustee, introduced presenters and moderated an ample sharing of area views and practices on the support of A.A. service.

'Informing our total membership'

"Support the support system" should be the theme of every A.A. member today, because of the rapid growth of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada. Lack of support puts more dependence on the literature fund, getting further away from self-support, because twenty-some percent¹ is purchased by outside agencies, and that could become a problem if we keep depending on this type of support to pass along our guidelines to new groups and whoever might ask for them.

I think we should be so proud of A.A. that we would do this ourselves, and any outside agency that might ask for our literature to pass along to other alcoholics should get it at cost, because they are doing us a favor. So I don't think we should make a profit off these agencies.

Most members do not know what services G.S.O. offers, or what they cost. I think each area should let all groups know that the services we have requested from G.S.O. cost \$62² per group per year. But this is not bad, when we consider that \$7² per member per year would take care of all these services that we've requested—plus we could have free literature. That's cheap considering the help we've received.

We could let the groups take care of the local support system, which is equally important to our program if we are going to have a full cycle of service. This may vary from metropolitan groups to rural groups. Sometimes, the district may be the most important link between group and G.S.O.

I don't think we should get so involved with percentages that we let some part of our support system suffer. I think we should put more emphasis on informing our total membership of the support system's needs.

At a lot of groups, you never see a *Box 4-5-9* or anything else from G.S.O. If we could get groups interested in purchasing *Box 4-5-9* for all their members, this would help, providing we keep them informed of services that are available to each group and individual member.

Billy Moore (Kentucky)

Using data not available until Conference time—breakdown of 1982 literature sales, 1983 estimates of groups and members in the U.S. and Canada (p. 8), and the 1983 budget (p. 53)—G.S.O. arrives at the following current figures:

- 1 Literature sold to non-A.A. buyers: 14.8%
- 2 Approximate cost of group services: per group, \$72.74; per member, \$3.80

How Tradition Seven aids personal recovery

Bill wrote in "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed" that "where the proper use of money ends—and its misuse begins—is the point in 'spiritual space' we are all seeking." The misuse of money in A.A. can and does take many forms, as this particular alcoholic has discovered.

When I came into A.A., it was a relief to discover "there are no dues or fees for A.A. membership," for, as most of us find when we're new and sometimes when we're not so new, money was in short supply. As I continued attending meetings, it seemed to me that those members who had been around for a while and were staying sober were also putting a dollar in the basket, and so, wanting what they had and needing approval, I began to put my dollar in the basket regularly. A dollar in the basket meant I belonged.

After two or three years, I was elected to serve for the first (and only) time as treasurer for a hospital committee. In those days, I practiced only one basic A.A. principle devoutly—"Easy Does It"; and my interpretation of that slogan was quite different from what A.A. intended. I rarely gave a treasurer's report; I was rarely asked to give one. Envelopes containing contributions from our meeting were scattered throughout the house, often not opened, counted, or deposited for months. Coffee bills went unpaid. The hospital supplied the coffee, and we were to pay them regularly. I'm thankful today that they were so tolerant; if they had not been, we would have lost our meeting. There was no rotation of officers, even though there were new people periodically added to the committee, so I served for well over

two years. We were the perfect example of what an A.A. group or committee should not do.

An A.A. friend finally took charge and began making some changes. I was removed as treasurer, and he demanded that the books be turned over. In my area, not too many sober members are removed from their jobs. My ego was badly bruised, but I reluctantly attempted to put things right and straighten out the books before turning them over.

I then withdrew, told myself they'd be sorry (whoever "they" were), vowed *never* to return to A.A., and came dangerously close to picking up a drink.

That experience, with its painful consequences, left a lasting impression on me—and began my real recovery in A.A. I had been made aware of Tradition Seven and its implication of personal responsibility. From that point on, learning to be responsible became primary in my recovery.

The Tradition tells me I do not have to repeat those mistakes. Our co-founders and early members, as a result of dealing with *real* money problems, have told me what I can and cannot do if I wish to stay sober and preserve my inheritance. Their wisdom and foresight have given me a path to follow; all I have to do is be willing and humble enough to follow it.

Bill wrote that "the use of money in A.A. is a matter of the gravest importance." I understand why today. When there is misuse, it can not only jeopardize the individual member's sobriety, but badly affect the group or even the entire area, and when that happens, our spiritual foundation is weakened.

I know today that when I walked into my first meeting—and every meeting since—it was there because A.A. members like me had been responsible and kept the doors open through their contributions—not only to insure their own sobriety, but to carry the message to me. It was through individual contributions that the groups were able to make literature available to me, and it was through individual contributions that the groups were able to provide a central office and someone to be on the other end of the telephone when I made that desperate call for help.

My responsibility, like my fellow members', is to contribute what I can when I can—my fair share, which today would be more like two dollars in the basket—to be well-informed, and to inform others whenever possible and necessary, so that misuse of A.A. money is kept to a minimum. I can do this today because I am responsible. And because I'm responsible, I'm more giving of myself, my time, and my money. I have grown a little closer to that "point in spiritual space."

Peggy Screptock (Northwestern Ohio/Southeastern Michigan)

Spiritual nourishment

Cathie Jeltsch (Panel 33, Southeastern New York) and a group of other early-bird delegates began each Conference day by trekking to the nearby Mustard Seed Group for an A.A. meeting. Undaunted by foul weather—snow flurries, rain, and unseasonable cold—these enthusiasts had a hearty appetite for an "A.A. breakfast."

A question of responsibility

I received my loving invitation to address this Conference on the topic "Should the A.A. Groups Pay the Expenses of Their G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s to Attend Area Service Functions?" My first reaction was: "Why waste time discussing the obvious? Certainly, it is the groups' responsibility to pay the way of their elected trusted servants."

From statements I heard at the Conference last year, I realized that this is a problem in some areas, for several reasons: (1) Our membership is not informed in this type of responsibility; (2) our servants are being appointed instead of elected; (3) we may have some bleeding deacons who want to run A.A. their way, and set themselves up as the ultimate authority in their group or district.

Years ago, our co-founders recognized the necessity of self-support for our Fellowship. Members in all areas of A.A. service work, and in particular the G.S.R., have the greatest responsibility to assure the future of this Fellowship. The G.S.R. hears the spoken, or often unspoken, conscience of the group; votes at assembly meetings to elect future servants of A.A.; serves as the direct link between A.A. worldwide and the group; and is the spokesman for the group.

If the group is responsible, and wants a G.S.R. responsible in all duties of the office—not just a name for the records—then that group pays the expenses for its elected trusted servant. It is unfair to new members or any members not to give them the privilege of participation: in electing the G.S.R.; in service to the group by helping the G.S.R. perform the duties required; and in listening when that G.S.R. has something to report to the whole group.

But suppose we have a dictator in our group, who tells us which member to elect as G.S.R., or appoints a G.S.R. because *that* person can afford the costs and the group doesn't have to pay. Then, we have no group conscience, no group participation, no trusted servant of our own choice.

Our Fellowship has certain principles that have held us together for many years and have allowed us to grow and mature. The first one I think of is that all those who have drinking problems can come to A.A. It does not matter what color they are, how much money they have, or where they have been. We include them. The principle of inclusion and not exclusion allowed me into this Fellowship, as it has allowed each of us to be a member. That principle should prevail throughout the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service.

In our area, we believe that elected trusted servants should never have to be out-of-pocket for the expenses to do the jobs that we have asked them to do for us.

Groups pay the expenses of their G.S.R.'s for attending district meetings. The G.S.R. returns to the group, makes a report, and receives his or her expenses.

The *district* pays the expenses of its D.C.M.'s local work in the district—telephone calls, letters, and travel. Each group contributes to the district fund established by the G.S.R.'s and the D.C.M.

The *area* assembly has three meetings a year, attended by

G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s. Each group pays its G.S.R.'s way; but the area assembly now pays the expenses of the D.C.M.'s—and those of the area chairperson, secretary, treasurer, alternate delegate, and delegate. To raise this money, each member contributes a penny a day to the area assembly.

Our area has a strong conviction that an A.A. servant should not have to worry about money or the lack of money on his or her part to be able to do the job. Each year, my assembly gives me \$800 for expenses I incur for communications, this Conference, and phone calls. But when I travel to give my report, then the district I am visiting picks up the tab.

In Saskatchewan, we feel it is our responsibility to elect the best person for the job. The best G.S.R. may not be the one who can afford it, but we find the most active groups in service are those that can afford the best service workers.

A.A. people allowed me to come to A.A., get sober through the acceptance and use of the Twelve Steps, become a G.S.R., then D.C.M., area secretary, chairperson, and now delegate. Through all those service jobs, they said, "We'll pay your expenses, but hold you responsible to fulfill your obligations."

Garnet Wipf (Saskatchewan)

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 12, 13, 14 (p. 47), 33 (p. 49)

A.A. and drug addicts

Various aspects of a problem causing deep concern among A.A. groups were considered in this Wednesday-evening session. William Flynn, M.D., Class A trustee, served as moderator.

'A.A. has but one primary purpose'

In various forms, this topic has been in existence ever since the gift of sobriety and A.A. came into being. From time to time, groups, areas, regions, and Conferences have wrestled with the problem of protecting this Society.

It is totally repugnant to this member to imagine or believe that somewhere there exists some entity whose avowed purpose is to infiltrate, invade, and destroy the program of Alcoholics Anonymous. Should destruction ever occur, it will be far more subtle. The God-given principles upon which this Fellowship is founded neither incite nor invite attack from outside influences.

However, we sometimes fail to make it abundantly clear just what A.A. is and is not—and well-meaning nonalcoholics, in their efforts to help themselves, enter A.A. closed meetings. Our duty is clear and concise, wholly contained in our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. The responsibility to preserve and protect this way of life for alcoholics presently here and those yet to come is ours and ours alone. If the history of organizations obliterated by their deviation from their avowed purposes is any criterion, then we in A.A. need only keep faith in our principles and concepts to avoid a like fate for this Fellowship.

In Tennessee, I hear the cry that our groups are being taken over

by individuals who have problems other than alcohol. I hear also that the person addicted only to drugs is coming to closed A.A. meetings and dominating them with drug stories, to the total exclusion of alcoholism. A.A. is never punitive in its relationships with anyone. We are better served when we treat these unfortunates with love and understanding, directing them to other organizations that can serve *their* needs.

It is my firm conviction that we must always adhere to our primary purpose. When individuals beset by problems other than alcohol—and more particularly, pure drug addicts—turn to us for aid, our responsibility is to inform them in a loving manner that the program of A.A. deals only with the problem of alcoholism. At the same time, in the spirit of A.A. cooperation, let us always remember that the ability of those other societies to assist such people is based upon their uniqueness in *their* field, just as ours is in assisting alcoholics. The exclusivity of A.A.'s purpose was not designed to afford us prestige among God's creatures, but only to grant us the opportunity to stay sober and help other alcoholics to obtain sobriety.

The sober alcoholic of today will be the trusted servant of tomorrow, and I pray that tomorrow's trusted servant will, through understanding and service in our Fellowship, maintain that which we now have. Let us be ever mindful that A.A. has but one primary purpose. If we are to remain God's instruments through which His grace flows to alcoholics, may we ever keep this program inviolate!

Buford Lewallen (Tennessee)

Pre-Conference sharing

Assembled in the fifth-floor conference room for the 4-6-8 Meeting of A.A. on Friday, April 16, were a variety of A.A.'s—G.S.O. staff members, early-bird delegates and trustees, who had already arrived for the Conference, and other, "regular" A.A.'s. In a wonderful, pitch-type sharing session, one person after another expressed gratitude for sobriety and for the privilege of being part of the 33rd General Service Conference. The love and sharing helped launch the Conference week ahead, and the clear commitment to service was a powerful attraction for newer members.

Are we helping the dually addicted?

Considering the panic this subject is causing in California, we could title it "The Alcoholic Versus the Drug Addict" or "Us Against Them." Different opinions are being expressed there on how we should deal with this "problem." Some feel we should just not let "them" in; better to lose a few dope fiends (who may or may not be alcoholic) than to jeopardize the program that saved our lives. Either such newcomers decide to be at least partly alcoholic, or they don't stay; and they should be willing to make this decision within their first two or three meetings. Other members I have spoken to feel that A.A. has come of age and should open its doors to all chemically dependent people whether they drink or not.

I don't fit into either category. A middle group feels that the

job of deciding who is a member belongs to the individual and God. There seems to be a great deal of anger in my area when discussing drug addicts and A.A., and that kind of anger is usually generated by fear.

I would like to share with you one dually addicted A.A. member's experience and—because I can't help myself—opinion. It is my opinion that a dual addict is just an alcoholic who had chemical problems other than alcohol. I grew up in the 1960's—hippies, peace marches, the Beatles, drugs in general, gurus, and finding yourself were in. I was *not*. Being completely inadequate in all areas was almost my natural state. Then I found alcohol—and became an intellectual, glamorous, witty, 14-year-old alcoholic. From the first drink (which I never forgot), I knew that I had found the answer to all of life's problems. I just had to figure out how to drink enough to maintain superiority without getting arrested or killed.

When I was 15, someone turned me on to pot. I was having trouble staying awake, so someone gave me whites—I could drink all night and still be standing! Someone asked if I was ready for a spiritual experience, and I tried my first hit of acid (LSD). Heroin was suggested—I was available. In my mind, drinking and drugs were inseparable, a way of life. From the time I was 15, I exhibited all the classic signs of an alcoholic: blackouts, inability to predict my behavior, inability to have just one drink. But I didn't know that. It was not cool to be a lush, and God knows, we had to be *cool*. Some of my friends died being cool.

A statement of policy making the rounds in A.A. groups today was printed in *Box 4-5-9* recently. It reads in part: "These newcomers are truly welcome here as members of our Fellowship, provided their primary addiction is to alcohol—something they alone can decide. We ask only that when discussing their problems, they confine themselves to those related to their alcoholism." With my attitude and inability to accept my alcoholism, I might have found it impossible to stay in A.A. if that statement had been used when I was new.

If I was told to do something, I just couldn't do it; if I was told *not* to do something, it was absolutely essential that I do it. If I had been told when I was new that I couldn't talk about drugs in meetings, I would have had to talk about them all the time. If A.A.'s had reacted as hostilely as some do today, I would have said, "Later," and Mid-Southern California would have a different delegate! I was *incapable* of telling you my problems in the beginning—primary or otherwise. I didn't trust anyone; I felt alone and isolated.

I will continue to thank God that I came into an A.A. group spiritually fit enough that its members did not find it necessary to censor my conversation or actions in order to protect themselves. I did talk about drugs, and I used a lot of four-letter words to do it! My group allowed me the dignity to choose to change these things and the freedom to do it when I *could*, and not when *they* thought I *should*. I had finally found a place where—weird as I was—I was accepted and encouraged to stay. I was given love and understanding beyond my comprehension. When I got really wild, one of the oldtimers (a past delegate) would take me aside after the meeting and explain to me the damage I was doing, or could do, and suggest alternatives.

In turn, I came to feel very protective of A.A. and of my

group. I developed a real desire to be a contributing member. Feeling different or having an edge on other A.A.'s did not appeal to me, so I do not refer to myself as an alcoholic-addict, for the very reason I mentioned in the beginning: I truly feel that I am an alcoholic who had problems with other chemicals. If I participate in our program of recovery by practicing its spiritual principles in my life, it just doesn't occur to me to stick needles in my arm or smoke those funny cigarettes. I have found a great freedom in being one among many. I do, however, understand the need to identify—that's why I believe A.A. talks should never be censored. When I am asked to speak at an A.A. meeting, I share my experience with drugs as part of my story—because it *is* part of my story, just as children, five marriages, prison, and sleeping in parks are parts of someone else's story. I wouldn't think of telling you not to share all of you with me.

My group seems to have no trouble sticking to our single purpose, which is to carry the message to still-suffering alcoholics, however damaged and confused they are in the beginning. It is very hard for me to believe that a few hundred misplaced druggies could destroy A.A. It is very easy for me to believe that the blind anger brought by fear could. I'm talking about the kind of fear that makes us take sides against each other and requires sick minds to make rational decisions like "Is your primary addiction to alcohol?"—the kind of fear that caused early A.A.'s to list membership requirements to protect their groups from "them." There is a fine line between upholding our singleness-of-purpose Tradition and limiting or restricting our membership. The day A.A. appears to be rejecting people who may be alcoholic, we will begin to die. What good will it do us if, while we are defending our "rights," A.A. is destroyed? Can any of us survive without it?

Dyanne Gilliam, Mid-Southern California



Attractive new arrangements drew attention to the display of A.A. publications, which were often cited in discussions of Conference topics.

"The great principle of identifying"

A.A. is a fellowship of people whose only membership requirement is a desire to stop drinking and whose sole purpose is to stay sober and to carry this message to alcoholics. Nothing is said in our literature about taking, smoking, or shooting up. In fact, the "Twelve and Twelve" and the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" stress that A.A. cannot be all things to

all people and survive as a group; and if we do not survive as a group, we cannot survive as individuals. That tells us explicitly who we are and what we can and cannot do as an A.A. group. What we can (and should) do as individuals is another matter.

We live in a drug-oriented society. Newspapers, TV, and radio advertise all kinds of nostrums. While many people can use them without serious trouble, others become addicted to barbiturates, amphetamines, or hard narcotics. These addicts with no history of alcoholism are showing up at closed A.A. meetings. Many have been referred to us by doctors, city and county treatment centers, hospitals, correctional agencies, and courts. Often, they have read about A.A. in the newspaper, or some columnist has advised them to seek help in A.A. It is difficult for those well-meaning advisers to understand that A.A. has the answer only for alcoholism, and that, although we have no desire to be exclusive or selfish, we cannot help all of those who are chemically dependent.

So what should we do? Should we be rude to them, tell them to get out, that we don't care for them unless they are "pure alcoholics"? I think not. Bill said in the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" that while A.A. is limited in what it can do, the A.A. member as an individual is practically limitless in what he or she can do.

One young man with whom I was working had a bad "pill" problem as well as alcoholism, and he also got into hard drugs. He always identified himself as an alcoholic and pill addict, vehemently said that one drug was the same as another, brought drug addicts to closed A.A. meetings, and was quite a problem for the A.A. groups he attended. But he stayed around long enough to get sober. With the help of his home group and a good sponsor, he was able to distinguish between his alcoholism and his drug problem. He is now a member of Narcotics Anonymous and does a good job in working with those who have histories of both alcoholism and drug abuse. This is the great principle of identifying with a fellow sufferer.

In Georgia, I have talked with the N.A. state representative, counterpart of our area delegate, and have found these talks very beneficial. There are 87 N.A. groups in Atlanta. Other large cities, such as Savannah, Columbus, Macon, and Augusta, have several N.A. groups; and most of the mid-sized cities, such as Gainesville, Rome, and Albany, have at least one N.A. group. Besides these groups, there is an N.A. contact in every section of the state, so that an addict would not have far to go to an N.A. meeting. I have found that N.A. members are very cooperative with A.A. and do not want to seek affiliation with us. We believe that our procedure of referring the dually addicted person or the person with only a drug problem to N.A. works best for all of us.

We also talk to doctors, counselors, and others interested in alcoholism and drug addiction and share with them what A.A. can and cannot do. Our pamphlets "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" and "Problems Other Than Alcohol" can be very useful to health professionals.

Often, there is a request for an A.A. member to make a talk at a hospital or a treatment center. Some of these meetings are for staff members only; others, for patients. The call usually comes to a central office, which should select the A.A. member with care—one who is knowledgeable about the Steps and

Traditions and will give a good impression of the Fellowship. The A.A. with an alcohol and drug problem can be very helpful. Also, high schools, colleges, and military bases are having an enormous problem with alcohol and drugs. Often, an A.A. member will explain what A.A. can and cannot do. I know of many instances where people have come to A.A. because of this sharing.

Our Twelfth Step tells us to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic. But our sincere desire to help may cause us to lead people without a drinking problem to believe that they can find recovery in A.A. That would be a tragedy. It is much better to show them where they can get the help they so desperately need.

John Langston (Georgia)

'Bridge the gap between the two worlds'

The issue of drug addicts and A.A., certainly not new to our Fellowship, does seem to be increasing and causing concern to A.A. members and groups all over. That is clearly indicated in letters and phone calls to G.S.O., A.A. newsletter articles around the country, local conferences and assemblies, and Regional Forums.

In the late 1940's and throughout the 1950's, Bill answered many letters expressing the same dilemma and questions we are faced with today. In 1951, Bill received a letter sharing the experiences of a couple:

"My wife and I have been addicted to drugs for 34 years, and have never been able to master a cure until our last discharge from the Federal Narcotic Farm at Lexington, Ky. This has been accomplished only through A.A. teachings. A.A. was brought in to us twice a week by wonderful people. We were told when discharged to contact A.A. immediately, and to attend as many meetings as possible each week, which we have done. We want and need this program—we are just hungry for it. Because there is no N.A. in or around our home, should we continue with A.A., or take the chance of deviating by not attending the A.A. meetings here?"

Bill responded by saying: "I am delighted to hear of your release from narcotic addiction. It has always been a fond hope that one day many drug users would find the same answers we A.A.'s have. By all means, I would continue to attend A.A. meetings. I'm sure the group would have no objections so far as open meetings are concerned. Maybe you could dig up a few other addicts, later forming a narcotic group of your own. If the A.A.'s understand you are coming with such a design in mind, they would not object at all. But they might."

During the mid-1950's, this issue became an emotionally charged one for a few people, not at all like the numbers today. Bill, in replying to some of these letters, wrote:

"I feel glad that drug addicts seem free to go to open A.A. meetings. But I doubt if it be wise to encourage them to think that they can actually become A.A. members. This would have the effect of pointing the whole A.A. movement at drug addiction as well as at alcohol. True, we often deal with drug addiction in a left-handed way by warning against sedatives and narcotics. We also have many members who, like yourself,

were both alcoholics and addicts and therefore qualified for A.A. membership on the ground of their alcoholism.

"In some spots, we've even had violent opposition to drug addicts' attending A.A. open meetings. Of course, that is nonsense—an open meeting means that anybody can come. At least, it does in most places. But if you try to push it further and claim A.A. membership for straight addicts, then I'm rather afraid of unnecessary difficulties. The real hope in this situation lies in what you are doing. Those who are alcoholics and addicts both can bridge the gap between the two worlds." Toward this end, Bill's letter noted one means: starting their own groups that would not be called A.A. groups.

In 1958, Bill wrote an article for the Grapevine entitled "Problems Other Than Alcohol," setting forth the principles shared in his correspondence previously—principles that are contained within our Traditions and will ensure the survival of A.A. The principles have been reaffirmed by numerous Conferences in regard to drug addicts and A.A.: in 1964, 1969, 1970, 1972, and 1973. In 1974, the Conference recommended that Bill's article be prepared in standard pamphlet form; in 1979, that it receive Conference approval.

The letters we receive today are a little different from those that Bill answered, or perhaps the difference is that we're receiving so many. For example, a letter received this year from an A.A. who is also a professional in the alcoholism field stated:

"We treat alcohol addicts and addicts to other drugs together in our detox unit; introduce them to A.A. meetings; have A.A. volunteers talk to and with them; and urge them to attend A.A. outside, after discharge or rehab. It is awfully deflating to these people to go compliantly to an A.A. meeting, as instructed by their counselors and physicians, and be told by an A.A. 'officer' or other member that they do not belong and must leave. There must be some less cruel way to handle this dilemma. Up here, most meetings are open. Elsewhere, the opposite is true, and people are made to feel they have to go out and drink long enough to develop a 'problem,' if they are to get help from A.A."

As you can see, there is still confusion and misunderstanding about A.A.'s traditional policy regarding A.A. membership of nonalcoholic addicts. We have our work cut out for us in correcting misinformation on who and what we are and what we can and cannot do. As our literature states, A.A. cannot be all things to all people. The reason that A.A. has been so successful in dealing with alcoholics is our singleness of purpose. One of our past trustees said, "A.A.'s single-mindedness is the strength of humility, because A.A. limits what it is demanding of itself and its associates. From this comes its real success in this limited target."

Helen Turnquest, G.S.O. staff

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 19, 20 (p. 48), 34 (p. 49)

Jim Shannon (Grapevine director) visited G.S.O. several days before the Conference. He was carrying a radio, complete with earphones, which he had just bought from a street vendor. "It's for the Conference," he said, with a twinkle in his eye.

How is the A.A. member's voice heard at the General Service Conference?

On Thursday, when the Conference began shaping recommendations that would express our collective group conscience, the late-afternoon presentation/discussion helped define the responsibility involved. The moderator was Ken Dunphy, Eastern Canada regional trustee.

G.S.R.'s work on a two-way avenue

One day at a time, I have been in the service structure since 1973. As alternate G.S.R., alternate D.C.M., and D.C.M., I communicated group opinions on Conference matters, a lot of other matters, and even some "don't matters." I hope some of it reached the ears of those on the Conference floor and helped them draw better conclusions to the problems at hand.

There are two avenues of communication: from the Conference to the groups and from the groups to the Conference. To properly serve as a conduit both ways, the G.S.R. obviously must: (1) be well informed as to Conference matters; (2) efficiently inform the group as to Conference matters; and (3) obtain the group's conscience on these matters and honestly convey it to the delegate.

Only if all important information is absorbed and passed along to the group and its input is obtained can the G.S.R. properly inform the delegate. Otherwise, the delegate is likely to be given the G.S.R.'s opinions, not those of the group. Since G.S.R.'s cannot attend the Conference as delegates, how are they kept informed? Well, there are a number of ways: Conference agendas; Box 4-5-9 (including the Early Bird edition); minutes of area committee meetings, assemblies, and district meetings; and direct communication from the delegate.

The G.S.R. must read that material when received. If necessary, some items may be discussed with the delegate. The material should then be made available to the group for individual reading. Of course, not all group members will read it, so the G.S.R. should inform the group about items of special interest. That is the only way to elicit any response from the group; discussions that follow will enable the G.S.R. to gain insight into the group's collective opinion. If the discussion is spirited and the G.S.R. is unable to determine just what that opinion really is, the members may be asked to define their opinions in writing. Most important, the G.S.R. must suppress the urge to present the delegate with his or her own opinion passed off as the group's opinion. That requires an honest and conscious effort on the part of the G.S.R.—who is, in effect, the group's conscience.

It all sounds easy, but it is not! G.S.R.'s must take their duties very seriously. Unfortunately, we all sometimes have feet of clay. What it boils down to is that the G.S.R. must keep abreast of important matters: attend district and area meetings regularly; be aware of correspondence from G.S.O. received and shared by the delegate; and be prepared to pass it along to the group and to discuss the issues.

Wherever the process starts or ends, we must all remember that Recovery is the first order of business for us alcoholics. Unity and Service follow. The communication and discussion of issues are not everyday group activities unless an issue irritates

someone or causes resentment. Then, the discussion can get hot and heavy—and the delegate usually hears about it!

John Goetschel (Northern Illinois)

Pre-Conference assemblies need group action

As an elected trusted servant in A.A., I have learned that we all have one general purpose in common, no matter what title we hold, what responsibility we take on, or what other members expect. That common purpose is stated in Step Twelve and Tradition Five: We carry a message. As a delegate, my message is one of service, carrying the group conscience from my area to the Conference to share with other areas, and carrying the collective group conscience from here back to the groups in Arizona.

A pre-Conference assembly is one way of knowing what the group conscience is in our area. We do several things to arrive at the most complete group conscience possible. In late January, we have a weekend sharing session and area assembly, where Conference topics are discussed, based on the tentative agenda, proposed workshops, and Conference theme. Our panels or committees meet and discuss available information. In late February or early March, questionnaires are mailed to all listed D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s or other group contacts. They are also distributed at monthly service meetings or district meetings. The alternate delegate and I try to attend those meetings and hear firsthand the needs, suggestions, and problems of the groups.

In early April, just prior to the Conference meeting, the area holds a one-day assembly, called a "group conscience assembly." There, specific agenda concerns are discussed, and a sense of the meeting is taken. Usually, the actual agenda items then known are those pertaining to the particular Conference committee that the delegate is assigned to. These pre-Conference assemblies can be very helpful to the delegate, but they are dependent upon preassembly information and G.S.R. attendance. The assembly itself cannot be an accurate count of group conscience if G.S.R.'s attend with no information on previous discussions at the group level, or if the group has no representative in attendance.

All the methods at a delegate's disposal to learn the group conscience can be only as effective as group interest is in service. I and past delegates I've talked to have felt that we carry our area's conscience to the best of our ability. And yet, these two years, I've often thought the results could have been better. If our area consists of over 500 groups and 25% of the questionnaires are returned or 25% of the groups are represented at an assembly, then 75% of the groups have no voice or vote in matters that may directly concern them in the future.

Each of the ways a delegate has of acquiring group conscience is important. If pre-Conference assemblies help do this, then they are not only important, but vital. Without group conscience, one of the links in the chain of communication is broken. I wish each and every group in our area was concerned enough with their Fellowship to let their concerns and suggestions be known and shared with all the groups from other areas. That hasn't happened yet. We have not had 100% service participation. Communication carries our message, and some groups simply cheat themselves by not sharing in service communication. For now, the groups that care do carry the message the

best they can, by reading the available information, taking a group conscience, and sending an informed representative to area assemblies, which, in turn, send an informed delegate to the General Service Conference.

I'm proud of the groups in Arizona and their growth in service. I am also very grateful for our pre-Conference assemblies and any other means available to enable me to arrive at an informed group conscience. It is not necessary that they or I get our way, but it is necessary to know they care enough to keep the message of A.A. flowing. If a pre-Conference assembly is a sharing of members' experience, strength, and hope, what could be more important?

Mary E. DeFer (Arizona)

'It works just fine!'

How have I made my voice heard as an A.A. member, as a G.S.R., and as a D.C.M.? I made it heard loud, louder, and louder still. How have I heard the voice of A.A. as a delegate, a Grapevine director, and a general service trustee? At times, very, very reluctantly—it is much easier to give advice than to receive it.

I became a G.S.R. and a D.C.M. because my sponsor had held those positions before me. I had no idea what this "bunch in New York" were up to, but I was surprised and delighted to find that as an A.A. member, I did have a voice in their decisions. When my sponsor was G.S.R., he came to our group's business meeting with the preliminary Conference agenda, and carefully explained that the Conference was also a group of delegates elected by the areas. I nodded sagely and smiled. Now it was that bunch in New York plus that bunch of big shots from out there.

The G.S.R. explained, in depth, the pros and cons of each topic on the Conference agenda. After group discussion, a consensus was arrived at. The force that we know exists in all A.A. rooms was working. I went home from that meeting with a warm feeling. The Westbury Group of A.A. had spoken. Let the world listen!

One year later, my sponsor was elected D.C.M. I could differentiate between a district and a region, and was assured that this gave me the qualifications to be a G.S.R. I was delighted, for I felt that now I could tell the group how to instruct the delegate. After all, that's what leaders were supposed to do. My sponsor referred me to Tradition Two, saying something about our leaders' being trusted servants, not senators. Showed how much I'd grown and how confused he still was—that Tradition obviously referred to people with no leadership background or qualities. My attitude changed quickly at my first assembly. Glimmerings of responsibility appeared—my group had entrusted me with the responsibility of being a cog in the wheel of A.A.'s group conscience.

I succeeded my sponsor as D.C.M. At assembly and committee meetings, I discovered that New York City had a legitimate grievance—no one living within 75 miles of the city could be elected a regional trustee. This caused a momentary setback in my growth. At the top of my lungs, at assemblies and committee meetings, I bellowed the following: "Taxation without representation!"; "Fifty-Four Forty or Fight!" and



In the midst of the Conference committee rooms was the workroom, where typed minutes were turned out in short order. A detail of procedure absorbs Elsie Oxman, Rosa Blanco, Elizabeth Garcia, and Margie Janicek.

finally, "Charge!" Who were this bunch in New York, these big shots, to take away the city's "inalienable right"? My plan of action was simple: Let us storm the barricades!

Of course, wiser heads prevailed. We simply instructed the delegate to ask the Conference to look into the situation. I reported that "sellout" to my sponsor, and his words of wisdom to me were: "Make a lot of meetings every week, and then cut down to seven after you dry out." In spite of all of my forecasts of doom, the next year's Conference repealed the 75-mile limit. Bill's answer to the question "How does A.A. work?"—"It works just fine"—was slowly beginning to penetrate this opinionated mind.

My election as delegate clearly shows that no fellowship, even a God-given one such as A.A., is perfect. I had no wish to become a delegate, but not because of any humility. As a delegate, I would have to make decisions. Making decisions would mean that some people would disagree. Ergo, those people would not like me, and I had enjoyed being well liked.

As a delegate, I sent a questionnaire to each group to ascertain their feelings about matters to be discussed at the Conference, and I left a space for suggestions. To my horror, groups filled in suggestions—a lot of groups—an overwhelming majority! The number one suggestion was to ask Conference approval of "the 24-hour book." At that time, I felt that any piece of non-Conference-approved literature was the work of the devil; as delegate, I should be dealing with more important matters, such as carrying the A.A. message to Russia and China. But I did have a serious problem: If I was to be a servant and not a senator, I would have to listen.

Desperately looking for a way out, I followed the precedent set by the 75-mile-limit affair: I placed the matter of Conference approval of the book on the agenda of the pre-Conference assembly. There, I spoke strongly against taking this action. After listening to my magnificent oratory, the assembly voted overwhelmingly to ask for Conference approval of "the 24-hour

book." "How does A.A. work?" "It works just fine."

I asked that this matter be placed on the agenda of the Conference Literature Committee. It was, and another glimmer of growth appeared: While I knew I was representing all of A.A. at the Conference, I also knew that I must do my best in presenting my area's request. The committee and the Conference recommended not granting approval at that time. Then, I presented the reasons for my area's request. So it was aired before the entire Conference.

As a Grapevine director, I have had no problem in hearing members' voices. The Grapevine Corporate Board reviews their letters: "Do away with the gray pages"; "Increase the gray pages"; "Make the articles longer"; "Shorten the articles"; "Run more articles of historical import"; "Make the magazine more avant-garde"; "The magazine is too serious—let's have more cartoons and jokes"; "Alcohol is no laughing matter"; "If the Grapevine is having financial problems, why not take on advertising?" Whatever the view, the majority of the letters do show a warm, loving concern for "our meeting in print."

As a general service trustee, I have tried to be a good listener, to assure that the voice of the individual A.A. member is heard. Every letter sent to the board of trustees is carefully and thoroughly reviewed by the board and lovingly answered by its chairperson.

I thought this presentation would document my significant contributions to the A.A. service structure, comparable to Richard Rodgers or Cole Porter doing "And then I wrote . . ." As it turns out, I have been nothing more than what my group made me when they elected me G.S.R. many 24 hours ago, namely, a small cog in the wheel of A.A.'s group conscience.

Now, I'll speak simply as a Conference member. I have been privileged to see Conferences struggle with many diverse issues, reverse decisions of the General Service Board and previous Conferences, painstakingly consider minority views. I have to feel that if Bill is listening to us today and hearing the question "How is the voice of the A.A. member heard at the General Service Conference?" he's smiling and saying, "It's heard just fine!"

John Ryall, general service trustee

Anonymity in personal recovery

Returning to the Conference theme, the final presentation/discussion also emphasized our primary purpose. Joe Kraus, Southeast U.S. regional trustee, introduced four speakers who—like all their fellow delegates—see themselves first and foremost as alcoholics grateful to be sober in A.A.

'The rock on which I build my life'

My sobriety is dependent upon my spiritual condition — it always has been. The Twelve Steps allow us to construct a spiritual foundation upon which we can begin our climb from the depths of despair. Construction begins with the act of reaching out for help — usually in desperation — with no faith, just a desire to get out of the muck that is active alcoholism. For the first time in my life, I really wanted to climb completely

out of myself, physically and mentally, and that desire opened the way to recovery. I began to be aware of my defects of character, and to actually gain sufficient humility to start forcing these human failings aside.

I am convinced that the degree of awareness of my shortcomings can be equated to the state of my sobriety. Humility gives me the opportunity to learn how to cope with living—to build a spiritual foundation. It gives me an open mind, necessary for any growth, and allows me to become anonymous. It follows, then, that the strongest condition for my sobriety, the rock on which I build my life, is personal anonymity. Anonymity—in the spiritual sense—must be in the foreground daily. I cannot allow my personality to overshadow my program.

In the April 1951 Grapevine, an article by H. S. of Great Neck, N.Y., on “Anonymity” strikes me as being particularly applicable today. It reads, in part:

“A.A. is already too big and too securely grounded to be materially influenced by the words or actions of *any* individual, in or out of the public limelight. It is the *spirit* of anonymity which is involved—not the *fact* of anonymity. If one A.A. takes his pen in hand or gives his story to a ghost writer or a reporter—or if another bares his soul and his name over Station DRIP—A.A.’s public relations have not been mortally wounded.

“But a potentially dangerous precedent *has* been established, one that could destroy us if followed to a logical conclusion. . . . The ‘bleeding hearts’ among us could go to town—each, mind you, under the honest delusion of ‘doing good.’ The only defense A.A. has against such a possibility is the group conscience, the sheer weight of A.A. opinion—not an edict from on high. Without this conscience, A.A. could easily be turned into a three-ring circus of competitive egos—each trying to do the *most* good, by getting the *most* publicity and therefore reaching the *most* people. Let’s not kid ourselves. It could happen. In fact, that is precisely what did happen to the Washingtonians more than a hundred years ago. . . .

“When we put our personal gratitude on public display, when we peddle humility, we cheapen not only those noble emotions but A.A. itself. Our collective dignity is perhaps our greatest single asset in public relations.”

Personal recovery depends upon spiritual principles both within the individual and within the structure of A.A. as well. The chapter on Tradition One clearly states that if we deviate too far, the penalty is sure and swift: We sicken and die.

Bill W. wrote in the January 1955 Grapevine: “To gain enough humility and self-respect to stay alive at all, we had to give up what had been our dearest possessions—our ambition and our illegitimate pride.” So, as a real alcoholic, my continued sobriety today is the result of my *gratitude* for those who showed me the way, my *humility*, which obliterates my pride, and my *spiritual anonymity*, which removes the ever-present egotistical personality from my path. All of those conditions must be present to create a *spiritual being* worthy of sobriety.

Anonymity—the spiritual foundation of our Fellowship—is, to me, the final guarantee that my life has the opportunity to be spiritually progressive in A.A.

Derral G. Campbell (Northern Interior California)

‘Respect the anonymity of others’

I was not a very anonymous drunk. When people in my hometown noticed me walking around sober, they certainly knew that something or someone had brought about a miracle. I can truthfully say that I am no more anonymous in A.A.

I have been active in service almost from the beginning. My sponsors were very strong on service. They took me with them on a Twelfth Step call when I was in the program but a few short weeks, just to give me an idea of how to talk to a new prospect. I learned a lot on that first Twelfth Step call. Most important, I learned that you don’t win them all, because the young man we called on that day is still drinking, and that was some 13 years ago. I attend A.A. meetings in prisons, hospitals, jails, detox units, jail and court programs, and substance-abuse programs; and I believe these are all important ways to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

I think it is important for me to remember that I can do as I please about my own personal anonymity, but I certainly must respect the anonymity of others who wish to stay anonymous, for I believe that is their God-given right. I have always respected our Eleventh Tradition at the level of press, radio, TV, and films. Anonymity is the greatest protection our Society can ever have, and “the spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice.”

Ronald Bush (Western Michigan)

‘Focus on the *spirit* of anonymity’

Tradition Twelve is the rock upon which we have built our Society. If it is not substantially secure, we surely face significant danger. Our greatest danger lies within each of us.

It is the comfort of anonymity that eases fear and allows newcomers freedom to join us. Newly recovered alcoholics are still very close to past guilts and mistakes. Losing their anonymity in the beginning can be traumatic both personally and professionally. Fairly early in my sobriety, while in a restaurant with people not in our Fellowship, I met a dear friend from A.A. I was free to greet him and introduce him by his first and last names, because I trusted him with my anonymity and he trusted me with his.

In some areas, last names are as common as first names in group meetings. No one thinks anything of it, because it does not violate our Traditions and it is not at a public event. We know and believe in the confidentiality of our group meetings. In other areas, such as mine, great care has been taken through the years not to reveal last names in meetings. It stems from the fact that we have no right to break another’s anonymity, and it helps reduce our desire for personal distinction within A.A. But have you ever tried to visit someone in the hospital when you did not know the person’s last name? The guarding of anonymity can become obsessive and is a contagious habit. Our Traditions do not include the tradition of habit.

Anonymity must be guarded at the general public level, but that does not mean I may not break my anonymity in meetings or among people outside of A.A. It is essential to focus on the *spirit* of our Traditions. When I place “principles before personalities,” I may break my anonymity with members of the public on a private level.

So, in our perspective on anonymity, we travel through fear to acceptance and finally to service. Here is where I feel the danger may lie. Among those of us who have been sober some time and now have a real feeling of self-esteem, a problem may exist. It seems a self-esteem based on fact; there is some substance to our achievements. We know, however, that our usefulness is a gift. Were we granted sobriety and a new life to revel in our achievements? Are we not just a part of a great whole, all working for the same Boss? Do we consider enough by what Power we have been able to achieve? An early member used to say, "Count yourself. You're not so many."

The "Twelve and Twelve" says: "Our growth made it plain that we couldn't be a secret society, but it was equally plain that we couldn't be a vaudeville circuit, either. The charting of a safe path between these extremes took a long time." With a membership of over a million, the danger of a "secret society" has passed, but the danger of a "vaudeville circuit" has not. We are so large, we now have a "public" within our Fellowship, and it contains many new and uninformed members. How great is our need to be entertained? Do we look to certain people as "Mr. or Ms. A.A."? And if we do, what does that new and uninformed member do? When speakers are selected, what qualities are desired? Are their stories different from most, more exciting? Are they humorous? Will their names draw a lot of people so expenses will be met and some money made for the area or district? And finally, what is the quality of their sobriety? Do they have a real, honest message? It may be time to look at our priorities.

And what about the personal needs of "Mr. or Ms. A.A."? Where is *their* chance for further growth? Can they share with other A.A.'s the struggles that occur from time to time in later sobriety? Or do they feel they should remain ideal examples of achieved peace and serenity?

Self-esteem, a product of living within the Twelve Steps, grows with sobriety. As we succeed more often than we fail, as the quality of our sobriety improves, so will our self-esteem. But self-esteem is the bedfellow of inflated ego. We may be living with bad company. Through self-honesty, we need to stand guard at our mental door and achieve a kind of humility.

Our Twelfth Tradition (long form) asks us "actually to practice a genuine humility . . . to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us." So, feeling this all-encompassing desire for love and service founded in gratitude, "we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members." It is the act of doing good without getting found out.

Let us, then, focus on the *spirit* of anonymity rather than just the letter of the Tradition, and in doing so, ask our Higher Power to keep us safe from ourselves.

Diana Salnave (Oregon)

Anonymity stresses our equality

What is the purpose of anonymity in A.A.? Why is it often referred to as the greatest single protection the Fellowship has to assure its continued existence and growth? If we look at the history of A.A., from its beginning in 1935 until now, it is clear that anonymity serves two different yet equally vital functions: (1) At the personal level, anonymity provides protection for

all members from identification as alcoholics, a safeguard often of special importance to newcomers; (2) at the level of press, radio, TV, and films, anonymity stresses the equality of all members in the Fellowship by putting the brake on those who might otherwise exploit their A.A. affiliation to achieve recognition, power, or personal gain.

From its earliest days, A.A. has promised personal anonymity to all who attend its meetings. When I first came to A.A., I didn't want anybody to know that I was going to A.A. meetings. About the first month, a fellow came up and asked, "Percy, what's your last name?" I was petrified. Didn't he know we were supposed to be anonymous? I didn't know what to do! Much later, I had my anonymity broken in a large group of people. This woman said loud and clear, "Meet Percy, my A.A. friend." I didn't like it a bit, but I thought, "God bless us all, at least I'm sober today. Maybe someday I can try to help some of her 'normal' friends."

I am not one bit anonymous today except as it is called for in our Eleventh Tradition: at the press, radio, and TV level. But you can be sure that I will guard *your* anonymity at all costs, and never break it for any reason whatsoever.

I let people know that I am willing and available to try to help the still-suffering alcoholic; my doctor, my boss, my clergyman, my lawyer, and the staffs of alcohol and drug treatment centers all know that I am a recovering alcoholic, a grateful member of A.A. for seven and a half years. We sober members of A.A. are carrying the message to the public that alcoholism is no longer a dirty word but a treatable illness the world over. Through service on institutions committees at district and area level, as well as on our P.I. Committee, I let people know that A.A. is available to any and all who want it.

Those experiences have been "real humility at work" in my life; "moved by the spirit of anonymity," at the selfsame time, I try to give up my "natural desires for personal distinction" or any human aspirations in the name of A.A. Trying to be dedicated, trusted servants, both among fellow alcoholics and before the general public, we recognize anonymity as "a protective mantle which covers our whole Society," so that we as sober members "may grow and work in unity." Experience teaches us "that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have."

"We . . . fully realize that 100% personal anonymity" at the public level "is just as vital to the life of A.A. as 100% sobriety is to the life of each and every member." May each of us guard it well.

Percy Moore (Mississippi)

Advisory Action related to foregoing topic: 30 (p. 48)

Anonymously

After participating in a difficult trustee election, Dave Leonard (Panel 32, New Mexico) returned to his seat to find the following note on the table in front of him: "I am not in service to be loved by everybody but to learn to love everybody."

Alabama/Northwestern Florida: Our quarterly assemblies are attended by G.S.R.'s from 148 groups (88% of all groups registered) and large numbers of other interested A.A.'s. The Convention Committee is coordinating plans for our annual convention, monitoring the 1983 convention in Mobile, and making plans for 1984 in Pensacola and 1985 in Huntsville. Letters are being mailed to Birmingham district groups to enlist A.A.'s to correspond with incarcerated A.A.'s or prospective members. If the project works well, it will be implemented at the area level. Most of our 20 districts report regular district meetings open to the A.A. community.—*Sally F. Roy*

Arkansas: The area assembly meets quarterly in Little Rock; but for the past three years, workshops coordinated by the alternate delegate have been conducted in towns around the state. Recent area activity includes revision in the area structure and establishment of an Archives Committee. We have 12 districts. In January, each D.C.M. was mailed a list of workshops and presentations scheduled for the 1983 General Service Conference; D.C.M.'s will hold meetings using this material. We are most concerned about: (1) types of meetings, (2) group membership, (3) use of the Serenity Prayer and the Lord's Prayer at meetings.—*Elsie Murphy*

British Columbia/Yukon: All D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s receive minutes of quarterly meetings and the assembly. Districts hold sharing sessions, and some D.C.M.'s hold monthly meetings with G.S.R.'s. Most hospitals have A.A. meetings, but we have problems with institutions—personality conflicts and lack of sponsors. P.I. has grown in all districts, and we now have a meeting for deaf alcoholics. Our *Grass Roots Newsletter* has enhanced communication and interest in the archives. We are looking for a permanent location for the archives.—*Kim Patrick*

California (Northern Coastal): Of our 18 districts, 17 hold regular monthly meetings, where G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, D.C.M. chairpersons, and their alternates sit down with an area officer and discuss group, district, area, and Conference business. Many districts now hold Traditions, Concepts, and "A.A. Service Manual" study sessions as part of their monthly meetings. Nearly every district holds a quarterly, semiannual, or annual Service Day, with panel discussions and workshops. We actively encourage electing alternates at all levels, "sponsoring" these new people, and including them in all our service activities, thereby ensuring future service leadership.—*Bill Moore*

California (Southern): We are attempting to make general service more attractive by creating more tangible activity for G.S.R.'s: setting up registration, P.I., and C.P.C. committees, with each G.S.R. and D.C.M. assigned to one. Less than half of our groups are currently registered with G.S.O., and this project alone will be a large undertaking. We suffer from inertia in reorganizing the use of D.C.M. chairpersons. Dividing each committee into subcommittees by zones may stimulate the thinking of our service people. Besides, with 17 zones we'll have 51 committees, and a lot of people will have jobs.—*Ralph Goers*

Colorado: The area committee will try to make our area more aware of service. Our first goal is to make A.A.'s more familiar with the Twelve Concepts. Next, we will try to have a GvR in every group. We will also engage institutions groups in area service—encourage them to participate in assemblies even though they cannot attend. ("The A.A. Service Manual" notes the possibility of proxy votes, and it has also been suggested

that an "outside" G.S.R. be elected.) Finally, the problem of anonymity will be tackled (no small task). Enthusiasm has been expressed by committee members for these goals.—*Bill Factor*

Connecticut: Our area committee is responsible for all service functions; we have no intergroup. We have nine districts, each with three D.C.M.'s and three alternates, and over 900 meetings (most are groups). D.C.M.'s and alternates devote full efforts to their districts and subdistricts, producing greater service involvement. But we continue to have difficulty in getting A.A.'s to undertake and keep commitments to service. Group financial support of our area committee is outstanding. Our Correction/Treatment Facility Committee is reinstating a pen-pal program.—*Joe Rhoads*

No hospitality needed

Preparation for the annual April meeting brought the usual flood of mail to the desk of Betty Liddle, Conference coordinator. But the following communication, from Mel Ditty (Panel 33, Western Missouri), was distinctly unusual.

"I made a mistake. In haste, I mailed the form to you for the Conference Hospitality Committee to expect my spouse at their reception. I put my name on it, to add to the problem. I've been married so many times; I'm afraid to go out on a blind date. However, currently I'm legally divorced from them all."

District of Columbia: Our area includes Washington, D.C., and large portions of Maryland and northern Virginia counties. Only half of our 350-plus groups are in the city. Of our 32 districts, one is Hispanic. We have monthly committee meetings, which include workshops for D.C.M.'s, G.S.R.'s, and anyone interested in service, and quarterly assembly meetings. We have just held our tenth annual mini-conference, the Hispanic district meeting simultaneously for the second year. We present A.A.'s Professional Exhibit at the many conventions of national organizations held here. In 1982, we co-sponsored the First Northern Virginia Service Conference. We are now preparing for the 13th Northeast Regional Convention, in October 1983.—*Chad Leyshon*

Florida (Northern): Since 1972, our area has seen great improvement in growth, interest, and cooperation: from only 30 members attending a one-day quarterly assembly to over 300 attending a service weekend in January 1983. The "temporary sponsor" program is gaining momentum; more groups are convinced that "bridging the gap" for newcomers "back on the street" is a vital support system. We have made exceptional progress in schools—giving talks to students and working with counselors and teachers on preventive education programs. Primary concern is for continuing communication to generate interest on all levels of the service structure.—*Evelyn Sale*

Florida (Southern): Our quarterly committee meetings and assemblies have evolved into a service weekend, consisting of committee meetings and workshops on Saturday, and a business meeting and/or assembly on Sunday. In 1982, our Grapevine Committee elected to take as guidelines the structure used by the Southern Minnesota Area. We also have a new committee, Housing and Transportation, which provides information and coordinates transportation and lodging for people who would not otherwise be able to attend our quarterlies. As lines of com-

munication continue to expand, understanding among districts grows.—*Michael Cushman*

Hawaii: Our 1983 assembly will try to adjust our geographical division into districts to suit changing population distribution. The Island of Hawaii recently split, with Hilo as District 7 and Kona as District 8. Committee meetings are planned on each of the neighbor islands, beginning in August 1983 with Maui. On Oahu, assemblies will rotate among four districts. We have established a committee to research and record past advisory actions, and we have assigned the archives to the alternate delegate. Learning group conscience through the G.S.R.'s continues to be a problem, but we are making progress.—*Jack Hoffman*

Illinois (Chicago): We are encouraging greater participation in our Regional Delegates/Past Delegates Conference. The area committee will pay all expenses incurred in attending that conference by the alternate delegate and the two immediately past delegates. We have begun to deal actively with the growing problem of nonalcoholic addicts' attending closed A.A. meetings. A letter signed by our P.I., Hospital and Institutions, and Service Committees was sent to G.S.R.'s and group secretaries reminding groups of our Third Tradition. Another letter was sent to hospitals with treatment programs, along with the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol." The letter requests hospitals to respect A.A.'s Traditions and suggests that encouraging or directing nonalcoholic addicts to A.A. may delay their recovery. Hospitals are reminded that A.A.'s primary purpose is to help alcoholics.—*Michael G. Shelly*

Illinois (Southern): Our assembly consists of 11 districts encompassing the southern two-thirds of the state. We hold quarterly meetings and an area spring conference. We cooperate with other areas in holding an annual All-State Conference. Our Treatment Center Committee is coordinating districts for Twelfth Step work for alcoholics being released from treatment centers. Some C.P.C. work is being done at the intergroup level. We are growing rapidly and have serious concerns about problems other than alcohol and the need for stressing our Traditions in the groups.—*John Paul Jones*

Indiana (Northern): Since redistricting, attendance and participation at state committee meetings have increased. Only four groups have not elected G.S.R.'s. Meetings continue to be successful at our state prison in Michigan City and at the state vocational rehab center in Westville. The majority of groups have adopted the 60-30-10 Plan, which provides consistent financial support. We are concerned now with the adoption of: (1) a budget for financing committees with limited funds, and (2) a general service structure.—*Herb Brautzsck*

Iowa: Our growth is fantastic—groups are forming in small towns and hamlets. With growth, there are mistakes and problems; but, thanks to our past delegates, districts are well set up and flexible. We have three state meetings, spring and fall conferences, statewide workshops, and many statewide anniversaries. Unity is the key in our endeavor to keep A.A. in Iowa growing.—*John McKenna*

Louisiana: Our area assembly meets four weekends a year. In July, we hold our annual state convention in Baton Rouge. Attendance at assemblies is increasing, and because of rapid growth in metropolitan areas, we have redistricted twice in the past ten years. We place strong emphasis on each D.C.M.'s

carrying the service message to the district. Our assemblies have D.C.M. workshops, and we help defray part of their expenses. Our problems include lack of coordination on our H. & I. and P.I. Committees statewide, but this is not true at the local level. We publish a monthly bulletin, a valuable communication tool.—*Ben G. Headrick*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area consists of 1,100 groups, 26 districts, and four central or intergroup offices. In 1982, activity included: (1) attracting G.S.R.'s through contact with groups by D.C.M.'s, service seminars, and orientation meetings; (2) increasing communication among groups, districts, and the area by means of cluster meetings (comprising four to ten districts), encouraging election of D.C.M.'s on a ratio of one per ten groups, and publication of a quarterly newsletter; (3) encouraging participation in carrying the message through the Conference committees; and (4) taking an area committee inventory. Group financial support of area activities continues to be generous.—*Frank Gay*

Michigan (Central): Instead of holding quarterly assembly meetings, we have intra-area meetings hosted by a different city each month. The delegate meets with committee members, and G.S.R.'s have a service workshop. We also have many intergroups and unity councils that deal with local problems; most have P.I., C.P.C., and institutions committees, and some have monthly workshops. At our quarterly statewide meetings, delegates from the three areas report on area activities, and there are service committees and reports. Redistricting has just been completed—a big job! We recently organized a statewide workshop on service involving all three delegate areas.—*Lloyd Hosner*

Michigan (Southeastern): We have about 300 groups divided into 24 districts, nine of which have D.C.M.'s. Some district activities are: a monthly workshop/study meeting; a lending library; efforts to save the oldest group in Detroit; a bimonthly interdistrict workshop; a literature bank; placement of the Big Book and Grapevines in all local junior and senior high school libraries; and taking meetings to shut-ins. There are 12 active area committees and two central offices. In March, we hold an annual rally; and in September 1983, we will host the 31st Michigan State Conference in Detroit.—*Peggy Smith*

Minnesota (Southern): We now have 150 to 200 attending our assemblies. We hold four assemblies a year (primarily business meetings), usually in conjunction with a roundup or conference. In 1983, one assembly will be an all-day meeting separate from the conference. We have initiated a three-day service conference in January, which has been well received. The most effective committees are those working with treatment centers and P.I. We have been trying to register more groups and attract them into our service network. We have 65 districts and/or zones, but only about 20% of the groups send G.S.R.'s to service functions.—*Donald J. Bruner*

Missouri (Eastern): We have nine active service committees; our C.P.C. Committee has representatives in most of our 18 districts; and we now have a monthly C.P.C. newsletter. In March 1982, the area assembly divided the Institutions Committee into Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities Committees. We now have a meeting in the Missouri State Prison at Jefferson City. Also, we have a liaison committee member between the area assembly and St. Louis Central Services. In January 1982, we decided to become fully self-sup-

porting, and we have achieved this. We do not have an area committee but hold quarterly meetings of D.C.M.'s, committee chairpersons, and area officers.—*Phil Dennis*

Missouri (Western): Our area has quarterly two-day meetings, and most of our 16 districts meet monthly. The Convention Committee was restructured and includes G.S.R.'s from all groups on its subcommittees. The Grapevine network is being enlarged. We are now trying to publish an area service manual. Our main problem is lack of group support, but regular meetings on the Twelve Traditions are slowly overcoming this. Sponsoring newcomers into service work as well as into sobriety is growing.—*Mel Ditty*

Nevada: Our P.I. chairperson in southern Nevada has radio tapes out to 16 stations and videotapes at four TV stations. We have two speakers each month at D.U.I. classes, ads in two papers, monthly speakers at a military base, and a speaking program at high schools and junior highs. The P.I. Committee also sets up display booths at conventions in Las Vegas. One C.P.C. committee is hosting its fourth workshop this spring, and other C.P.C. workshops are planned for our area this year. We are redistricting up from our present 12 districts to accommodate the growth in our area.—*Manny Banks*

New Jersey (Northern): Over 600 groups and 30 districts make up our area, where more A.A.'s are interested in service work. Our area committee meets monthly, and our assembly meets quarterly. Our first big event in 1983 was a service weekend of workshops and meetings where we studied our budget and made decisions about starting new C.P.C. and P.I. projects. We also made plans for the Northeast Regional Forum to be held in Somerset in June 1983 and our state convention in September 1983. We are hoping for increased opportunities for A.A.'s in our area to become more involved at the grass-roots level.—*John Sharkey*

New York (Central): With 11 assemblies a year, our area has strong, continuing contacts between committee members and G.S.R.'s concerned with both rehabilitation and correctional institutions work. We have a large number of maximum, medium, and minimum correctional institutions. Our continuing problem is to help the released inmate find his or her way into the sober community at home. We have just published a list of interim sponsors, distributed to "outside" and "inside" sponsors, program directors, and our six district institutions representatives. (Names and phone numbers are not given out until the week before release.) The system works well and does not interfere with efforts of outside sponsors to match sober A.A.'s with inmates in the same home area.—*Ralph Van Keuren*

Howard Johnson's never had it so good! The restaurant, located on 42nd Street, just a few blocks from the Roosevelt, stayed open past its usual closing hour every night just to accommodate the sweet-toothed and talkative gang from the Conference.

New York (Southeastern): To further the growing interest in service beyond the group level, the delegate and the area chairperson took service meetings into 53 groups, using our filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" as their main "speaker." At our bi-monthly assemblies, we have workshops on the Traditions, the Concepts, and all areas of service, and another to orient new G.S.R.'s. Our area, with over 1,100 groups, crosses ten county

lines. Counties hold their own mini-assemblies and sponsor annual Share-a-Days (one-day conventions), in which the area committee participates. Communications between the committee and the seven intergroups or answering services are kept open by liaisons' attendance at service meetings and by reports at the assembly.—*Cathie Jeltsch*

North Carolina/Bermuda: Young people's groups meet throughout the area. Our state Grapevine chairperson is working through D.C.M.'s and district GvRs to promote a GvR for every group. For G.S.R.'s, we have district workshops moderated by past delegates and past D.C.M.'s. Our new intergroups are actively carrying out A.A. guidelines. Our concerns are: unity of intergroup and district P.I.; young people with dual addictions; A.A.'s claiming no home group; need for a higher percentage of Grapevine subscribers; and qualified A.A.'s prevented from serving by G.S.R.'s who refuse to rotate after two years.—*Jack E. Byars*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: We have about 220 groups, in 16 districts. Our geographical structure makes travel both difficult and expensive, so we have one area assembly a year, rotating the site — two years in Nova Scotia, one in Newfoundland. Area officers also meet with D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s at spring provincial roundups. Though redistricting has been beneficial, attendance at assemblies drops considerably if G.S.R.'s have to travel outside their province. The GvR program is successful, and the alternate delegate (who is also area Grapevine chairperson) is encouraging district GvRs. We are trying to establish an archives in each province. We now have our first woman area officer.—*Robie Chipman*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): We have suffered from resignations, illness, and deaths of officers; and attendance, communication, and group registration have deteriorated. Our officers lack firm and extensive service experience but are action-oriented, willing, and dedicated. We plan to maximize attendance at assemblies by acquiring a more inviting meeting hall, creating more jobs, and encouraging workshops by D.C.M.'s. After the formation of strong, central P.I., C.P.C., and correctional facilities committees, we may encourage each district to form mini-committees. We hope these activities and future redistricting will increase group participation.—*Julius Wilson*

Ohio (Northeastern): Our area consists of 530 groups divided into 38 districts. We have 20 D.C.M.'s, but less than 20 attend assembly meetings. Average attendance at assemblies is 80 to 85. Districts hold monthly meetings and study "The A.A. Service Manual," the Twelve Concepts, and the Twelve Traditions. Information about general service has improved, as well as area unity. The central and intergroup office offers cooperation and support. Our greatest highlight in 1983 is our eighth mini-conference, in March, modeled after this Conference.—*Ted Hayes*

Oklahoma: We have eight districts, with six committee people per district. The committee people are assigned individual groups—about seven groups per committee person. Each district has a quarterly meeting, and all district committee people make up the area committee. Our annual budget runs around \$20,000, supported by group contributions. We plan to establish a C.P.C. committee by the end of 1983. Monthly service meetings are held in Oklahoma City and Tulsa and are well attended, strengthening our service structure. The area "Policy and Procedure Manual" is being revised.—*C. B. Key*

Ontario (Eastern): Our area committee was established in 1977; we'd had a delegate but no committee for many years. In 1980, a Study Analysis Committee concluded that A.A.'s should be more informed about the fundamentals of A.A. and the service structure. Therefore, we have been conducting workshops and roundups. Only a few dedicated A.A.'s stay in service. The turnover of G.S.R.'s is a big problem, but we hope our education program will help resolve it. Ottawa and Toronto have big, powerful intergroups. We have been pursuing a policy of cooperation and mutual participation to overcome the mutual distrust and antipathy between intergroups and general service. —*Tommy Hills*

Ontario (Northeastern): Recently, our second intergroup was formed, and we have been experiencing growing pains centering on communication between intergroup service people and general service people. The problems: "Who does what?"; mutual trust; money (self-support); and cooperation. We have area workshops twice a year, and most districts hold monthly workshops. Three years ago, our area began the process of becoming self-supporting, and this endeavor is proceeding well. Two districts could be redistricted, because of the number of groups in one case, and geography in the other. We are preparing to form an archives committee. —*Conrad Cooley*

Ontario (Northwestern): We have seven districts, covering 250,000 square miles. Spring and fall assemblies are centrally located, with some D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s traveling 378 miles one-way to attend. D.C.M.'s are paid mileage to the assembly by the area secretary-treasurer, and G.S.R.'s are supported by their groups. We elected a full area committee, with a C.P.C. chairperson and a woman as alternate delegate. We have a strong service structure but should have more workshops for district needs and problems. Use of the Regular Contribution Plan is increasing, as are Step-commitment meetings. There is concern for sponsorship in recovery and service and for the vital role of the alternate. —*Ray Lavergne*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Our area has 575 groups with 29 districts, 29 D.C.M.'s, and 27 alternate D.C.M.'s. All districts hold monthly meetings with G.S.R.'s. One district holds quarterly service workshops, and most districts conduct annual workshops. Our quarterly area committee meetings draw 95% attendance. We hold four mini-assemblies per year—no single event has done more to promote unity and interest in general service and the Conference structure. —*Dorothy Garvin*

Pennsylvania (Western): We have two district committee meetings a year and two all-day service sessions, including workshops, panels, and films. In the south, some redistricting has improved our service structure. Also, we have formed an Archives Committee. Some groups are experiencing problems because of a lack of active home-group members. Many A.A.'s do not understand the importance of belonging to a home group. We have been encouraging people to join groups and get active, and are beginning to see results. —*Carol King*

Quebec (Northeastern): We have 285 groups (most are French-speaking) in 18 districts well structured with P.I. and Twelfth Step committees. We have four area committee meetings, one three-day convention, and two area assemblies per year. During the last two years, most districts held "schools" for G.S.R.'s. Communication among groups, districts, and the area is very important in developing an area consciousness. We are trying to provide the most service possible. —*Gabriel LaPointe*

Quebec (Southeastern): Our area consists of 16 districts with 220 groups. The area assembly has a quarterly business meeting, where D.C.M.'s give reports. We also have a general assembly for all G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s in November, when elections are held. Traveling expenses to area activities are paid by each district. Since 1982, the area has agreed to pay half the traveling expenses to far-off districts, and in so doing, we have better representation. We also have organized group bus travel. Many districts are happy to participate, and we have increased representation at our area committee meeting. —*Rosaire Vanesse*

Texas (Northeastern): At our 1982 spring assembly, a service structure for the area was approved, with a two-year moratorium to let members get acquainted with it. We now have a monthly area newsletter. At our 1982 fall assembly, area chairpersons for P.I./C.P.C., treatment facilities, and correctional facilities were appointed by our area chairperson; we hope that will improve communication and cooperation between our area service structure and local committees. We are holding more workshop-type area meetings in outlying sections. To reduce expenses, we are obtaining state and Federal tax exemptions. A few districts are inactive, and we are working to improve their service participation. —*Brian Camp*

Texas (Southeastern): Our area is divided into nine districts, three of which are divided into zones. Allowing districts to zone themselves (with area assembly approval) has been a more workable solution than redistricting the entire area. Three districts are holding monthly studies of "The A.A. Service Manual." We have felt the need for an "Area Policy and Procedures Manual," and the final draft will be submitted to the assembly for approval by mid-1983. Our P.I. Committee was formed in January 1983, and our C.P.C. and Correctional Facilities Committees should be operational before the end of 1983. We are developing a strong service structure and recognize the need for continued growth. —*Bud Smith*

Utah: We are changing from biannual to quarterly assemblies. At first, that seemed difficult, but our fears proved unfounded. Another current objective is to distribute functions better throughout the year and include an assembly in each function. With G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s, as well as other A.A.'s interested in service, sharing on panels that use Conference agenda items as topics, the service assembly in February will help the delegate prepare for the Conference. Having an assembly soon after the Conference will aid the delegate's communication to A.A. members. —*Bryce Peacock*

Virginia: We are in the process of programming our new computer, an acquisition made possible by discontinuing free registration at our state conventions and finding our area treasury with a sudden surplus. Our recently approved budget of over \$16,000 leaves us hopeful that the 25 active D.C.M.'s will use their increased annual expense allowance of \$200 to carry the message more effectively. We have been stressing workshops and G.S.R. input at our assemblies, and attendance is improving steadily. To better utilize time at our assemblies and committee meetings, we have recently suggested that committee reports be published in our area newsletter. —*Myron A. Gowan*

Washington: Our area is divided into 28 districts; district committee meetings are held quarterly in small towns. Several districts plan to subdivide, using several alternate D.C.M.'s, and we are anxious to see the outcome. Area committees are

funded through area contributions, with monies in excess of \$3,000 being sent directly to G.S.O. We are scheduling a sharing session, as outlined in "The A.A. Service Manual," as part of our district committee meetings. Our area has a growing awareness of the need to become more knowledgeable about our service structure.—*Jan Polek*

West Virginia: Our area is divided into 12 districts, with 133 groups; 23 new groups were listed in the last quarter of 1982. Our state assembly is held twice a year and rotates throughout the districts, allowing participation by more A.A.'s in different parts of the state. Also, districts have become more active in A.A. state affairs and more conscious of A.A. structure. We promote service work by holding district workshops. In August 1982, we hosted the Southeastern Convention in Charleston.

Local Matters Lead

Areas

Q How many areas have alternate delegates serving as a separate area office as described in "The A.A. Service Manual"?

A By a show of hands, the Conference members indicated that all areas have alternate delegates as a separate area office.

Q Of these areas, how many defray the expenses of the alternate delegate and the delegate to attend the same area service meeting?

A By a show of hands, it was noted that approximately half do and half do not.

Q How many areas have the area chairperson also serving as the alternate delegate?

A By a show of hands, ten members indicated their areas do; but most indicated they do not have the area chairperson also serving as the alternate delegate.

Q How many areas have the delegate eligible for election serving as the area chairperson?

A Approximately 20 Conference members indicated by a show of hands that their areas have the delegate eligible for election serving as the area chairperson.

Q What advice would you give to Panel 33 delegates to avoid delegate burnout?

A After some sharing, it was the sense of the meeting that burnout is a result of boredom and if you stay involved, you cannot become bored.

Q What system is best or is used in replacing or covering for area secretary/treasurers in the event they are disabled? Are alternates elected in any areas?

A Approximately one-fourth of the members noted by a show of hands that they do elect alternate secretary/treasurers, while three-quarters do not follow that practice. The delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania shared that they elect an alternate area officer who fills in for the secretary/treasurer or chairperson, if necessary.

Our archivist is compiling material so we may better understand our A.A. history. We are growing, and our aim is better communication with one another.—*Pete Ellis*

Wisconsin (Southern): We have 22 districts, over 450 groups, and one active central office. We have regularly scheduled assembly meetings, pre-Conference meetings, and spring and fall conferences. Grapevine subscriptions and literature sales have increased. Our Treatment Facilities Committee has come alive, and we intend that each district have an active representative. To date, 50% of the districts have chairpersons, with many groups taking active roles at treatment centers. The Correctional Facilities Committee has developed a network whereby districts are contacted when released inmates are returning there.—*Robert Baetz*



Cooperation with the professional community

Q How many areas have active C.P.C. committees?

A By a show of hands, it was noted that approximately 60% of those responding do have an active C.P.C. committee, while 20% do not.

Q In how many areas do C.P.C. committees come under the umbrella of general service? How many under intergroup? How many under both?

A A show of hands indicated that approximately three-quarters of the areas responding have C.P.C. committees that come under the umbrella of general service; 20%, under the intergroup; and 35%, under both general service and the intergroup.

General Service Board

Q According to Concept Seven, the trustees have veto power over Conference actions. Have the trustees ever used this right to veto?

A Never. While all Conference recommendations do go to the board, no recommendation has ever been vetoed. (Sometimes, however, the wording of a recommendation has been changed for purposes of clarification.)

General Service Conference

Q If there are less than 130 members who decide to vote, is the two-thirds majority applicable to those who vote?

A The Conference Charter states, "A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of all the Conference members registered." There are 130 registered members at this Conference; therefore, two-thirds is 87.

General Service Office

Q How many achievement awards has G.S.O. accepted in behalf of A.A.?

A The General Service Office does not accept any awards—Alcoholics Anonymous accepts awards. The awards that A.A. does receive are generally considered not "achievement" awards but rather "humanitarian" awards. The most recent award received by A.A. was The President's Volunteer Action Award, accepted by Bill Flynn in Washington last week [on April 13]. Other awards A.A. has received in the past are: (1) the Poverello Medal; (2) the Lasker Award, 1951; (3) the Franciscan Award, 1967; and (4) the American Industrial Health Conference Award of Merit, 1972.

Grapevine

Q Why doesn't the Grapevine print a two-year calendar, since the panels cover two years, as do the service terms for G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s?

A This, of course, would be possible if it is the will of the Conference. However, any two-year calendar would result in an overlapping of many people, since delegates are elected in alternate years.

Q Why didn't they raise the prices of the Grapevine material gradually instead of all at once (e.g., one item from 25¢ to \$1.75)?

A The Grapevine was instructed to do so by a 1982 Conference action. The aim was to price all special items so that each would be self-supporting. (The Grapevine has no single item priced at \$1.75; the question may have referred to the Preamble or the Serenity Prayer, raised from 25¢ to \$1.50 per copy.)

Q Can the Grapevine change the price of the Grapevine without the approval of the Conference? (The price of the Canadian subscription was increased.)

A A change in the price of the Grapevine does not require Conference approval. However, the Conference generally endorses such changes. It was noted that, technically, the change in the Canadian price of the Grapevine was not a price increase, but rather an increase to cover the cost of mailing services, which are \$1.50 per year more in Canada.

Group matters

Q My area has a mixture of metropolitan and rural groups. In nearly all cases, rural groups have loyal members but remain rigidly autonomous and parochial. City groups, in contrast, have many at meetings, but few as members. What have others done successfully to break this pattern, and what benefits have resulted?

A There was a great deal of sharing, both on how to get mem-

bers in metropolitan areas to find home groups and on how to get rural groups involved in the A.A. service structure.

Regarding members in metropolitan areas, it was suggested that beginners meetings are excellent for stressing the importance of finding a good home group, as is interim sponsorship. One group in New York City has a group member book; all those wishing to become members of the group are invited to sign it.

Many suggestions were also made regarding how to get rural areas involved in the service structure. Among them were: holding local assemblies; rotating assembly sites to include rural areas; providing "sponsorship" for rural areas; and holding sponsorship workshops.

One member said his area G.S.R.'s draw up an agenda of visits to groups, and each group is given a copy, so that groups can get to know one another better. Another delegate said she has sent out to rural areas "Let's get acquainted" letters, which have resulted in workshops and speaking invitations. Still another delegate noted that one-fourth to one-third of the districts in his area are assigned to the alternate delegate.

Q Is it a practice in other areas for a group to pay for the gas when a member is asked to speak there and must drive a considerable distance to reach it? (Is this practice wrong?)

A By a show of hands, 15 members indicated that groups in their areas do pay for the gasoline, while 15 members indicated that those in their areas do not.

Miscellaneous

Q Would it be wrong for a golf league, a bowling team, or a band to identify themselves as A.A. members, using the A.A. symbol?

A A majority of those present indicated by a show of hands that this practice would be wrong and in violation of Tradition Eleven.

Overseas

Q Does A.A. overseas follow our Guidelines and Traditions, or do they sometimes stray from such? If so, give examples.

A The correspondence that is received at the General Service Office from groups and members overseas, more often than not, requests sharing on how we do things in the U.S. and Canada, and the correspondence indicates a strong interest in learning what does and does not succeed here. This would seem to indicate that our overseas members are trying very hard to follow the Guidelines and Traditions as practiced in the U.S. and Canada.

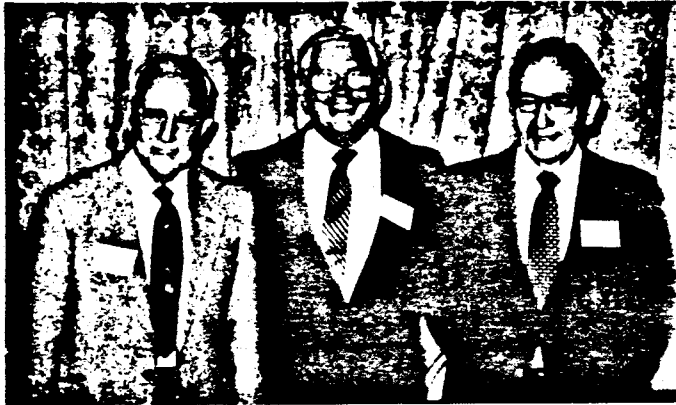
My time is your time

On Thursday morning, Gordon Patrick took a minute of Conference time to announce his acquisition of a stopwatch that ran slow for speakers from below the Mason-Dixon line—so the two-minute limit for speakers at the floor microphones would not result in geographic favoritism. . . . After giving one of Panel 33's Reports on Area Service Highlights, Bud Smith of Southeastern Texas said that was the fastest he'd talked in 50 years.

Reports From the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

G.S.B. and
G.S.O. reports

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.



Today's board chairperson, Gordon Patrick (center), hailed the support given by his predecessors, John Norris (left) and Milton Maxwell.

General Service Board

Big Book figures symbolize 'amazing' growth

Trustees' report: This is my first report to you as chairperson. During almost eight years on the General Service Board, I have had the unique privilege of serving under the leadership of both Dr. Jack Norris and Dr. Milton Maxwell. Dr. Jack first became associated with A.A. in the 1940's and became a trustee, at Bill's invitation, in 1950. (He has missed only two board meetings in 33 years and has attended every single Conference!) Milton started studying A.A. in 1940 and has been on the board since 1971. Together, they have a depth of experience with A.A. that is beyond price. How grateful we are they *still* attend the quarterly board meetings and the Conference in an emeritus capacity, so we may draw on their wisdom. And we do!

It has been a tremendous year for me—and, I think, for A.A. as well. New records have been set: number of new groups formed; rate of growth of the Fellowship; amount of A.A. literature sold; group contributions to G.S.O.; and the vigorous spread of A.A. overseas. The service structure is most certainly stronger than it has ever been—and this is reflected in the high level of experience and competence of the delegates coming to this Conference.

In 1982, over 4,000 new groups were listed at G.S.O. (only a portion of the new groups actually formed, many of which are not listed in our directories). That's an average of about 20 new groups every working day! If we deduct the 1,500 groups deleted or deactivated during the year, that leaves a gain of about 2,500 groups—about 9%—to a new high of over 30,500 regular groups in the U.S. and Canada, over 51,000 worldwide. And membership is booming in existing groups, as well.

We published and distributed over 7,000,000 pieces of A.A. literature last year, including more than 480,000 copies of the

Big Book and 400,000 other hardcover books. And in January 1983, we sold as many Big Books as in the *entire* year of 1970! Last summer, we shipped out the three millionth copy of the Big Book. It took us 35 years to sell the first million; five years, to sell the second; three and a half years, the third; and if increases continue at the present rate, we will sell the four millionth Big Book just a year and a half from now. Because these milestones are going by so rapidly, we no longer mark the occasion with any fanfare or presentations to public figures.

A heartening increase has also been experienced in both the numbers and the amount of group contributions to support group services and other work at G.S.O. Contributions in 1982 exceeded those of 1981 by 12.5%, reaching a new high of \$1,760,200. Unfortunately, even that generous figure fell short of the cost of group services by \$302,200, but if we Conference members can simply get more noncontributing groups to observe Tradition Seven, those services would soon be fully self-supported.

Expansion, construction, and refurbishing of G.S.O. and Grapevine quarters, begun in 1980, were completed last year. The entire cost was paid from income from literature sales, plus monies transferred from the Reserve Fund; none was paid for from group contributions. The expense of this work caused G.S.O. to show a deficit for 1982 (as in 1981). If these nonrecurring expenses are removed, the office finished the year in the black. Visiting A.A.'s have been enthusiastic about the refurbished offices. The initial reaction of visitors from the outside world is almost invariably surprise that Alcoholics Anonymous offices are so clean, pleasant, and attractive. Obviously, negative stereotypes of A.A. still abound.

An amazing phenomenon is the spread and growth of A.A. overseas. Mexico, where the 1982 World Service Meeting was held, has over 4,500 A.A. groups with an estimated membership of 100,000, a large, bustling national service office, a board, and a conference of its own. That kind of development is mirrored to various extents in all 23 countries represented at the biennial Meeting. Although the A.A.'s in those countries attempt valiantly to make the Meeting self-supporting, your G.S. Board underwrites a deficit. At this Meeting, the sharing between more-developed A.A. structures and newer ones is of enormous benefit to the latter.

Last year also saw the completion of an A.A. overseas membership survey, identical to those in the U.S. and Canada. Completed survey forms from Great Britain, France, Belgium, Finland, Brazil, and New Zealand were sent to our G.S.O. From the data compiled there, John Bragg analyzed the results. Most findings correlated closely with U.S./Canada figures, but some striking national differences emerged: The proportion of women members ranged from 35% in one European country to 6% in a South American nation; that of people 30 or younger, from 15% to 8%.

I continue to be enthusiastic about Regional Forums. Each one I attend—and I participated in all four held in the last year—I think is the best yet! Fourteen other trustees took part in these Forums.

A trustee-director pointed out that the bylaws of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board are inconsistent with its prac-

tices regarding the terms that general service trustees and GV staff serve as directors. The General Service Board has voted to qualify all current Grapevine directors and to make the necessary change in wording of the bylaws. This board will also study rotation policies affecting Grapevine directors and report the results to the 1984 Conference.

The three regular board weekends (in July, October, and January) have been very full and exhausting. Board committees meet on Saturday and Sunday; the Sunday-afternoon General Sharing Session has been changed in format and is lively and productive.

I am sometimes asked what I feel A.A.'s biggest current problem is, and I have to reply: drug addicts' attending closed meetings. At Regional Forums and other service conferences, I hear substantial agreement that A.A. is for alcoholics, not for those with other problems; and I have heard much useful sharing on ways that groups handle the problem. Dr. Jack Norris, in his report at the 1978 Conference, said almost exactly the same thing!

After meeting with a number of outstanding candidates, the board brings before you its choice of a new nonalcoholic trustee to fill the vacancy created by the resignation of Dr. Milton Maxwell. She is Dr. Joan K. Jackson, a highly respected sociologist, an educator and researcher, who has had a close association with A.A. over most of her distinguished career and is a great admirer and friend of the Fellowship. She has attended open A.A. meetings regularly for many years and has been a frequent speaker at A.A. gatherings.

Finally, on February 18, we lost our dear friend Mac Cheater, past delegate (Panel 12) and past trustee (1975-1979). In his warmth and good humor, his tireless and selfless Twelfth Step work, his leadership and humility, his extraordinary contributions in service and his deep spirituality, Mac exemplified the very finest qualities of membership in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Gordon M. Patrick, chairperson

A.A. World Services, Inc.

Our board 'sponsors' new translations

Directors' report: This board met 12 times during 1982. The following significant items are noted.

- We reviewed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee the 1982 budget.
- We authorized the transfer of \$423,252 to the General Service Board General Fund to cover 1981 G.S.O. operating deficits. With no surplus cash, no money was transferred to the Reserve Fund.
- We approved the request of Japan A.A.'s for \$9,000 to assist with the second printing of the Big Book, the inventory to remain A.A.W.S. property until this total amount has been repaid; approved Japan's request for \$7,000 to assist in printing 2,000 copies of the "Twelve and Twelve." (Japan has been conscientious in discharging its obligations.)

- We received \$9,000—from actual book sales—promised by Italy as payment toward our financial assistance in publishing the Big Book in Italian. (Badly advised decisions caused a bad financial situation there.) We will receive payments on the \$17,000 inventory as more books are sold.

- Some delegates at the Seventh World Service Meeting expressed concern that we have combined "Twelve Concepts" and "The A.A. Service Manual," and asked that we resume publishing the Concepts separately, as some countries have their own service manuals. We agreed to keep a small inventory on hand, at \$1.50 per copy.

- After discussion and thought by this board and by the trustees, we accepted Lois Wilson's proposal that the 1963 royalty agreement between Bill Wilson and the board be amended to permit her to bequeath part of her royalties to a foundation for at least ten years after her death or until 1997, whichever is later, and also a part to her nephew.

- We wrote Father Martin re his film on the Twelve Steps, noting that the credit line in the film and the promotional material implied that A.A.W.S. had given him permission to make the film, as opposed to permission to use the Steps in it. Fr. Martin informed us that a trailer with the required wording will be added to all prints, and all mentions of A.A. will be omitted from any promotion.

- We approved the following prices: \$25 for the "Twelve and Twelve" on cassette tapes; 15¢ for "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession"; \$20 for the Norwegian Big Book; \$50 for leasing tapes of "A.A.—An Inside View"; \$8.50 for the Spanish "Markings on the Journey"; 20¢ each for Spanish Wallet Cards; \$2.50 for "The A.A. Service Manual" in Spanish, with a copy to be sent gratis to new G.S.R.'s and to each Spanish-speaking group. We repriced Discount Package #2 at \$26 to include "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," and approved a new dust jacket in blue for that book.

- We granted 77 requests to reprint and ten to tape our literature; denied five to reprint and one to tape; tabled one. (List available on request.)

Dick Driscoll, chairperson

Archives

Visitors can hold A.A. history in their hands

Trustees' committee: Since last year's Conference, two more scrapbooks of early newspaper clippings on A.A. have been completed. The series now covers 1939 through 1961. These 19" x 19", attractively bound volumes contain Fellowship history as seen by the media. The clippings have been deacidified and encapsulated in mylar to preserve them.

We acknowledged a number of gifts from members: a ninth printing of the first edition of the Big Book in mint condition, along with early pamphlets; from California, original correspondence with Bill Wilson and other G.S.O. personnel, memos from local service people, and financial reports; out-of-print Oxford Group texts used by A.A.'s before the Big Book was published; a tape of the 1960 Vermont Convention, at

which Bill, Lois, and Helen Winn spoke. Dorothy Seiberling, daughter of Henrietta, the woman who introduced Bill to Dr. Bob in Akron in 1935, sent some pictures of her mother.

It was decided not to issue a set of International Convention photographs for use by archival centers. We haven't the rights to the pictures, since they were taken by independent agents.

We considered adding to "Markings on the Journey" slides of the texts of talks by Sister Ignatia, Dr. Bob, and others, since these are often difficult to hear. It was felt that this would increase the cost and length (now 38 minutes) of the filmstrip, and would ask viewers to contend with vast amounts of text. Instead, it was suggested that we enclose with each print a brief memo suggesting ways to enhance hearing. Copies of the talks would be provided if needed locally.

Al Hergott, chairperson

Staff report: After living the last few years "out of boxes," the Archives Department has settled comfortably into a four-room suite adjoining the Grapevine on the fifth floor of 468. Pictures and other artifacts are again on view for the many A.A.'s who visit each year.

Much of the activity after unpacking went into softening the trauma of Nell Wing's retirement after almost 36 years at G.S.O. A teacher by training and temperament, Nell held seminars for Ron, Kathy, and me to smooth the transition as much as possible. Ron Brenne joined us as assistant archivist in April; Kathy Scheidel came aboard in December as research assistant.

Growth in local archival centers has been reflected in more area histories, higher circulation for our newsletter, *Markings: Your Archives Interchange*, and burgeoning correspondence on historical matters from members.

Many scholars used the archives as source material for manuscripts on A.A. In the winter, the new *Saturday Evening Post* ran the old Jack Alexander article that put A.A. in the consciousness of the country back in 1941. That captures the mood of our collection, for our past contains our present and future. In looking through the scrapbooks, we encounter the same problems we hear in our own groups today. And the high sense of adventure that surrounded Alcoholics Anonymous in 1941 remains undiminished in 1983. The miracle goes on.

Frank Mauser, archivist

Canadian constitutional

Oblivious of the wet, chilly weather, Garnet Wipf (Panel 12, Saskatchewan) walked from the Roosevelt Hotel to G.S.O. (about 13 city blocks) without benefit of hat or coat.

Conference

How to help new delegates arrive prepared

Trustees' committee: We reviewed suggested 1983 Conference themes and recommended to the Conference Agenda

Committee (which makes the final selection) that the theme be "Anonymity — Our Spiritual Foundation."

Evaluations of results of the post-Conference sharing session and the Conference questionnaire were reviewed, and we made several recommendations:

- That delegates be informed of the Southwest Regional Delegates' and Past Delegates' custom of holding an orientation meeting for new delegates, in which they review the past year's Conference Manual and answer questions from delegates preparing to go to their first Conference.
- That we announce the availability of copies of Area Service Highlights at the beginning of the Conference.
- That Victor E. badges be sent to all delegates before they come to the Conference, to be worn in the hotel lobby as an aid to meeting one another before the Conference.
- That staff members send rosters of corresponding trustee committees to Conference committee members with the highlights of the July meeting. Further, that they advise Conference committee members that rosters of *all* trustees' committees are available upon request.
- That the procedure for advising delegates re Conference committees' agendas be reviewed at the October meeting. (This was done, and no change was recommended.)
- That the time schedule on the Stepping Stones visits be reviewed, and that delegates be informed of it prior to making their travel arrangements.
- That the method of determining a two-thirds majority and the number constituting a two-thirds majority be announced at the beginning of the Conference.

The committee also discussed the tradition of sending some trustees and staff members to the opening dinner of the Al-Anon Conference. It was agreed that, if possible, we should continue this practice; however, if Al-Anon again uses a conference center outside New York City, we may reconsider.

Topics submitted for 1983 Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or Ask-It Basket session. A list of Conference members to participate in the various sessions was reviewed and accepted.

Dick Driscoll, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator serves as the focal point for all Conference members and all those on area general service committees. We now have on our mailing list: 811 past delegates, 93 area committee chairpersons and alternates, 84 area secretaries — recording and corresponding, 77 area secretary/treasurers, 2,146 D.C.M.'s and alternates.

We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings. Circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, they are helpful to all of us—an excellent way to stay in touch with A.A. activities in the U.S. and Canada.

Delegates and other A.A.'s in the service structure are encour-

aged to send Conference agenda suggestions, which are passed on to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval, then shared with everyone via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary agenda mailed to delegates in January.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting items for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee.
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning and coordination of the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M.'s.
- 7 Coordinating the annual G.S.R. Day at G.S.O.

In November 1982, we held our first Open House—or G.S.R. Day—since 1980. A total of 750-800 visitors attended, coming from Washington, D.C., Maryland, Delaware, Pennsylvania, New Jersey, Massachusetts, Rhode Island, Connecticut, and New York. This year, we guided them through our newly renovated offices in a continuous walk-through. Prominent signs identified the various supporting departments and sections. Lunch was catered by the Southeast New York Area Committee at the Norman Thomas High School cafeteria (across Park Avenue from the office), and we put on a program in the school auditorium, describing staff functions and answering questions from 1:00 to 3:00 p.m. The new format was judged a big improvement from both visitors' and staff's viewpoint, and the experience proved invaluable to all concerned.

Betty Liddle

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Approaches to law and education fields

Trustees' committee: The principal topic at our 1982 meetings was the relationship between A.A. and the legal system. Discussions underscored the increasing use of A.A. by the legal profession for help with court problems. Examples of appropriate and inappropriate uses of A.A. were discussed; suggestions for improving communication were aired.

We appointed a subcommittee, chaired by an attorney, to explore this problem and the literature directed to the legal profession. Literature already available — "If You Are a Professional," Information Sheet on A.A., and A.A. Guidelines on Cooperating With Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs—appears to be adequate. Communication and distribution of

this material are the difficulty. The subcommittee is continuing its work, and we hope the Conference C.P.C. Committee will also consider the matter and add suggestions.

Another recurring topic of interest was *About A.A.* There were comments on the readability, direction, and readership of this bulletin. A questionnaire was developed to give us a clear picture of the readers and the kind of information they seek. Preliminary results indicate that the bulletin is used for many purposes, not only by professionals seeking to learn about A.A., but by members seeking answers to group problems and even topics for group discussion. The overall results of this questionnaire are being analyzed, and we plan to discuss the conclusions.

We have also considered the advisability of paying attention to A.A.'s relationship with the educational profession. It has been emphasized that we are not educators about alcoholism or its treatment—but very specifically about A.A. Existing literature is being reviewed by a committee member who is an educator, to see whether it covers current needs in that field.

We are eager to make the valuable C.P.C. Workbook available in Spanish and French for C.P.C. committees desiring it—in fact, we are encouraging its use in as wide a manner as possible.

The increasing visibility of A.A. and the influx of people from all referral sources—courts, clinics, physicians, treatment facilities, schools—place increasing importance on effective C.P.C. committees in every area. Again, Conference committee suggestions will be most helpful.

William Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: We have six Professional Exhibits, sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1982, our exhibit was shown at 25 meetings and resulted in over 2,000 requests for additional information. These exhibits, staffed by C.P.C. or P.I. committees in the areas concerned, have been a successful tool in carrying the message to the professional public. They also help increase the *About A.A.* mailing list, now over 12,000.

The C.P.C. staff member sometimes attends annual meetings of national organizations dealing with alcoholism, and serves as a representative of A.A. in a liaison capacity on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism. A.A. is also asked to conduct workshops at such annual meetings as the National Council on Alcoholism Forum; last year, our workshop was "A.A. as a Community Resource."

Some other meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated in are: Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University; Seventh Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.; First National Conference on Alcoholism and the Family; National Conference of Alcohol and Drug Problems Association, Washington, D.C.; Continuing Education Course for Physicians on Alcoholism and Drug Misuse, New York, N.Y.; visit to Hazelden and Johnson Institute, Minneapolis, Minn.

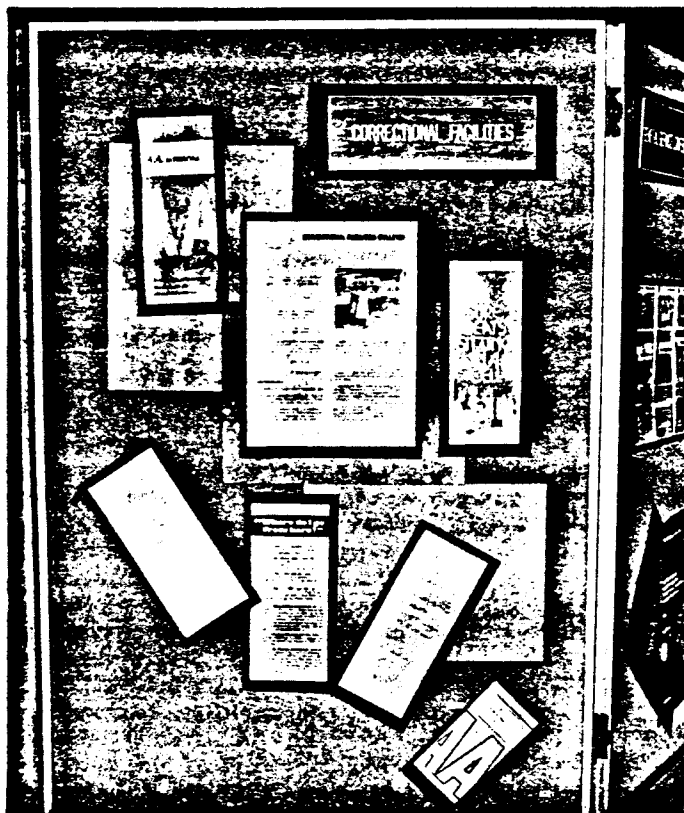
C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year; over 230 are now listed at G.S.O. New committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature

and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members. They also receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* and *About A.A.*

As recommended by the 1982 Conference, the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" was published.

C.P.C. work remains as important today as years ago when Bill W. remarked that "we are glad of any kind of education that accurately informs the public and changes its age-old attitude toward the drunk. More and more, we regard all who labor in the total field of alcoholism as our companions on a march from darkness into light. We see that we can accomplish together what we could never accomplish in separation and in rivalry."

Helen Turnquest



Correctional Facilities

Questionnaire produces ideas for service

Trustees' committee: On October 11, 1982, Clinton T. Duffy died at age 84. He welcomed the very first A.A. group behind bars, in 1944. There are now over 1,300 A.A. groups behind bars!

Some committee projects that have been completed and others in progress follow.

- As recommended by the 1982 Conference, the statement "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials" was added to the pamphlets "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and "Memo to an Inmate."

- The four Institutional Discount Packages of literature for correctional facilities committees have been revised and reduced to two, one for men and one for women; valued at \$13.90, they are sold at \$7. The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate" was printed in Spanish.

- The *Institutions Bulletin* was separated into two bulletins, one for correctional facilities and one for treatment facilities.

- The chairperson sent letters to correctional administrators in 50 states and several provinces regarding the value of holding regular A.A. meetings in prisons and our willingness to cooperate.

- After mailing letters to delegates with forms enclosed requesting more A.A.'s to write inmates, we received close to 100 responses.

- We sent a questionnaire, "A.A.'s Role in Correctional Facilities," to delegates and institutions committee chairpersons. The results were very revealing and will be reported to the Conference committee and in the July *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* for further action. We will also contact correctional facilities committees regarding the results and the suggestions they offer for improving our services. Through the efforts of each and every committee member, tackling different projects and doing a lot of subcommittee work, we were able to produce a thorough questionnaire that will tell us more about ourselves regarding A.A. in correctional facilities.

Jim Estelle, chairperson

Staff report: As of February 23, 1983, there were 1,321 A.A. groups in correctional facilities, and 277 institutions committees serving them.

We list A.A. groups meeting in correctional facilities in G.S.O. records and send each a Group Handbook, the Big Book, and other complimentary literature. They also get our *Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities*, Box 4-5-9 bimonthly, the *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* three times a year, and the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* twice a year.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English, French, and Spanish) are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. The Grapevine gives us back issues, which we pass along to those groups. Guidelines are available for A.A.'s interested in institutions work. A.A. films and filmstrips are lent without charge to correctional facilities groups.

The staff member on this assignment answers all correspondence from inmates and institutions committees. She writes about 500 letters a month; reads newsletters from institutions committees and inside groups; and writes the *Correctional Facilities Bulletin*, gathering the material from inmate and area correspondence. When an inmate is ready to be released, she sends the information to the nearest institutions committee, intergroup office, or group.

We've reached only a small percentage of the prison population, but more A.A.'s are becoming involved with institutions committee work. We have suggested guidelines to send to A.A.'s who are writing to those on the inside, and there are now about 400 A.A.'s willing to write. Ninety-nine percent of the mail received from inmates is from male A.A. members.

Services from G.S.O. only open the door to A.A. recovery. Real recovery for the confined alcoholic depends on local committees and sponsors who reach out the hand of A.A. in love and service — and on the individual's willingness to accept the A.A. way of life.

Susan Daly

Finance

Tradition Seven means more than actual sums

Trustees' committee: December proved to be exciting. At the beginning of the month, contributions were running behind the budget; by the end of the year, we were 2.5% ahead! Group contributions exceeded the 1981 total by \$195,000. Unfortunately, this wonderful support is still coming from only slightly more than one-half of the groups.

After we reviewed G.S.O. publishing operations, it was noted that sales by year end were flat compared with 1981. The net sales increase, after a 6% discount to A.A. groups, was 5.5%. Exclusive of the cost of construction and refurbishing, most variations in expenses were in line with the budget and were caused basically by A.A. growth and to some extent by continuing inflation.

The A.A. Grapevine reported that, compared with budget, expenses were slightly higher than anticipated and magazine income was below expectations, resulting in an operating loss for 1982. Interest earned on the investment of deferred subscription income was transferred from the General Service Board Reserve Fund to partially offset that loss.

Budgets were reviewed in depth, and 1983 budgets were approved. For G.S.O., sales have been budgeted to show an increase of 8%; contributions, 10%. Adjusting for construction and refurbishing expenses, G.S.O. operating expenses are budgeted to show an increase of 8.8% over 1982. For the Grapevine, income is expected to be 11.5% higher than 1982; expenses have been budgeted to reflect a 9% increase, allowing for nonrecurring in-house computerization of the subscription operation.

We realize that the lack of increase in the percentage of groups contributing could have been caused by high unemployment. Of course, we neither want nor expect large contributions from depressed areas. Rather, we are more interested in these and other groups' giving *something* than we are in how much they give. We would then feel that the Seventh Tradition was working for everyone.

If we can look forward to a broader-based financial structure, our concern for the future is greatly diminished.

Frank Smeal, committee chairperson, board treasurer

While riding in an elevator at the Roosevelt, John Sharkey (Panel 33, Northern New Jersey) was asked by a lovely airline stewardess what outfit he was with. When John replied that he was a member of A.A., she retorted, "You're lucky—the bars in this town are lousy, anyway!"

General Sharing Session

Topics: service, session format, drug addicts

Trustees' report: In July, our topic of discussion was "How Do We Keep the Spirit of Service Alive?" Most sharing concentrated on the importance of guiding new members (almost half of those in an average group have less than one year of sobriety) into service by example and support from older members. The older member can step back but not out; there must be a connecting link between old and new. After introducing the newcomer into service at the group level, the older member still has the responsibility to introduce the newcomer to the larger picture of A.A. through literature and the sharing of the oldtimer's service experience.

In October, the topic was "The General Sharing Session Takes Its Inventory." After a discussion on the format and content of these meetings, the consensus was: Small tables, with intimate sharing, are much more conducive to group dynamics; a balance of trustees, directors, Grapevine and G.S.O. staff, and non-trustee/nondirector committee members should be seated at each table; seating arrangements should not be fixed from session to session; the function of "table reporter" should be rotated.

As to the choosing of discussion topics, it was generally felt that the most stimulating are issues rousing controversy within the Fellowship, such as A.A. members' prescribing drugs. Another approach was that each table offer topic suggestions.

In January, the topic was "Problems Other Than Alcohol — Cooperating With Other Self-Help Groups." We cannot be all things to all people and perhaps jeopardize our sobriety, it was agreed; but we can help other self-help organizations by sharing the methods we use in working the Twelve Steps. The principles encompassed in our Steps are universal, not exclusive to A.A.

Perhaps out of the fear that we will lose our effectiveness in reaching other alcoholics, some groups are screening people as they come to our doors—asking whether they are alcoholics. A few groups read statements at the beginning of meetings saying only those who meet certain criteria may speak.

It was felt that more effort might be directed toward sharing with others the fact that the basic "cement" of A.A. is the commonality of experience in drinking. As for people who come to us unable to relate to a drinking experience, they may not benefit by attending A.A. meetings. Maybe a workable way of fulfilling our primary purpose and cooperating with others would be this: A.A. members, *acting as individuals*, might encourage and support the development of fellowships that wish to pattern themselves after A.A. In the same spirit of cooperation, A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., are very liberal in granting reprint permission to self-help groups that wish to use an approach similar to ours.

All in all, it was the consensus that the Fellowship will grow in an adaptive manner if we have patience, thoughtfulness, and simplicity of purpose, and do not overreact to the changing times. Where there is growth, there are growing pains, and the problems we are discussing today will ultimately be resolved at the group level.

John Ryall, chairperson

Group correspondence

Careful planning ensures answers to all mail

Staff report: Because of the heavy work load of some service assignments, a regional correspondence function was developed in 1981. The regional correspondent replies to general group problems and concerns from two of our larger regions, Southeast and Southwest U.S.

During the past year, there was increasing concern within the Fellowship about the number of people with no addiction to alcohol who attend closed meetings, as well as dually addicted members who share little, if any, of their alcohol experience at open and closed discussion meetings. There were letters regarding individual anniversary celebrants who abstained from alcohol, but used other mood-changing substances. One other continuing concern is the sale of non-A.A. literature at A.A. meetings. On the whole, correspondence indicated that most groups are primarily concerned with carrying the A.A. message to the best of their ability.

The staff is divided into units, so that there is full coverage of service assignments at all times. The regional correspondent works closely with staff members in the unit composed of the Loners/Internationalists, Regional Forums/Box 459, and overseas assignments; also frees other staff members who are involved in special projects by assisting them with regional correspondence.

June Russell

Group services coordinator

Delegates approve current directory procedure

Staff report: The primary responsibility of this coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole. She supervises production of all service material, updating of Guidelines and listings, Group Handbooks, literature displays, G.S.R. Kits, and other material. She works closely with the staff coordinator and other staff members on the literature and Conference assignments.

Each month, this coordinator conducts a G.S.O. service meeting, in which the assignment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered. Overall staff activities are also discussed, such as area trips and answering correspondence.

The 1974 Conference recommended that delegates assume responsibility for all directory information in their areas. Preparation for the directories starts in August, when letters go out to all delegates asking when they would like to receive printouts, starting September 1, and whether they want one or two sets. In the future, they will also be asked where they want the printouts sent, if to someone other than the delegate. Delegates are asked to return only printouts with changes. The deadline for information to be included in the directories is January 15.

To improve the directory procedure, delegates were asked questions such as: "Did you like the option of receiving two sets of printouts?"; "How about the letter to your district commit-

tee members — was it helpful to them?"; "Is there enough explanation?" The response from delegates has been positive; two sets of printouts were unanimously requested.

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, a complimentary supply of literature, Box 4-5-9 bimonthly, and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 350 Spanish-speaking groups, and the Group Handbook, the G.S.R. Kit, and Box 4-5-9 are available in those languages.

There are 12 Guidelines. As the need arises, they are revised to keep up with current trends. Material pertaining to services provided by G.S.O. is available on request, for example: lists of A.A. members who wish to exchange tapes or correspond, Loners, Internationalists, armed services groups, deaf groups.

Our service piece containing suggestions for carrying the A.A. message to the hearing-impaired alcoholic is presently being updated. "A Brief Guide to A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," and the Twelve Steps have been "translated" into easier language for the hearing-impaired. A TDD (telecommunication device for the deaf) is now in use at G.S.O. It is an ordinary phone equipped to receive teletyped messages from similar machines. The service coordinator worked with a committee to arrange for the purchase of G.S.O.'s TDD. Its number is 1-212-686-5454.

Literature kits for special purposes are sent either on a complimentary basis or in response to orders. The service coordinator is responsible for keeping literature kits up-to-date and available.

Three 16mm films are available: "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View." The first two are restricted to regular A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference action); the third is available outside A.A. as well. The films rent for \$35 per week but are distributed free to A.A. groups in correctional and treatment facilities. Three filmstrips are listed on the order form: "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" may be purchased at \$6.50 each for group meetings, assemblies, and conventions; "Markings on the Journey," the archives filmstrip, is available in English and Spanish for \$8.50 and may be viewed within A.A.

Beth Kuhlmann

International

Links among A.A. structures now worldwide

Trustees' committee: This committee is a focal point for information about A.A. around the world, especially countries not represented at the World Service Meeting (W.S.M.). We explore ways in which the General Service Board and/or G.S.O. may assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide, with particular attention to countries where there is no A.A. service structure. Two of our members are trustees currently serving as W.S.M. delegates, representing the U.S./Canadian Conference Section at the Seventh Meeting, in 1982.

At the First Spanish-American Service Meeting, in 1979, dele-

gates from several participating countries formed the Latin-American Translation Commission, to encourage their countries to assume some responsibility for making A.A. literature available. The commission has been experiencing difficulties, and after much discussion, we recommended that the matter be referred to the 1982 W.S.M. (The Meeting delegates in turn recommended that this matter be a major agenda topic at the Latin-American Zonal Meeting in Brazil in 1983.)

The committee recommended that we continue to include the names of W.S.M. delegates in the *International A.A. Directory* unless explicitly directed otherwise. We also recommended that we explore the feasibility of incorporating the Questionnaire for Traveling A.A.'s in that directory.

We reviewed and discussed the selected results of the overseas membership survey. It was pointed out that the value of these surveys in each country is that they serve to answer questions about the A.A. population asked both within and outside A.A.

Stan Cameron, chairperson

International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Computer will speed registrations for 1985

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—Al-Anon has elected not to participate in the 1985 A.A. International Convention, as in previous years, but to hold its own separate International Convention, at the same time and location as ours. The Fellowships will work together to iron out details.

The Al-Anon Convention coordinator inquired about the possibility of an Al-Anon speaker's participating at the A.A. Sunday-morning Spiritual Meeting. After consideration, it was the sense of this committee that the two Fellowships hold separate Spiritual Meetings, rather than merging.

At present, A.A. has over 13,300 hotel rooms committed to our 50th A.A. Anniversary International Convention. The Convention Center, located right in Montreal, will more than meet our needs for workshops, panel meetings, dances, registration, and meals. It has a cafeteria that can serve 600, a garden restaurant that can serve 250, and a convention-floor kitchen equipped to serve 5,000. The center also has underground parking and a Metro exit. At the Olympic Park Stadium, a short Metro ride from the center of Montreal, we will hold our Big Meeting, entertainment, and Spiritual Meeting. It is not completely an open-air stadium, but a lot of sky shows overhead. Last summer, during a site visit, the International Planning Committee saw how disruptive rain would be — very! On the positive side, chances are excellent that there will be no rain over the Fourth of July weekend.

We have hired a bilingual convention consultant, Jacques Briere, from Incentech, Inc. He will assist us in negotiating contracts and prices, help us get in touch with reliable merchants and suppliers, and in general provide expertise needed in planning and executing our Convention.

Also, we plan to hire a computer registration service to handle

all of our Convention registrations. That responsibility has been undertaken at G.S.O. for past Conventions; but with the growth in attendance over the years, the task has become unwieldy.

Montreal is beautiful and clean. Public transportation is excellent; Metro cars have rubber wheels; stations are spic and span. And the food? From soup to pastry wagon, *c'est magnifique!*

Regional Forums—Since the last Conference, four regions have hosted Forums: Pacific U.S., in Las Vegas, Nev.; Western Canada, Winnipeg, Man.; Southeast U.S., Nashville, Tenn.; West Central U.S., Sioux Falls, S.D.

The most popular topic discussed during the Ask-It Basket sessions, workshops, and general sharing sessions was problems with drug addicts' coming to closed A.A. meetings. This was closely followed by finances of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, ways to carry the service message, and sponsorship of A.A. members leaving correctional and treatment facilities. Presentations/discussions requested by areas covered such topics as "Overcoming Apathy in Service Work," "The Feasibility of Central Offices' and Intergroups' Becoming a Part of the General Service Structure," and "Cooperation Vs. Affiliation."

During 1982, the committee recommended that the term "mini-forum" no longer be used; that four Regional Forums be scheduled per year, with one additional Forum, if needed for special geographical reasons, available for a bid; and that the acceptance or rejection of such a bid be up to this committee. It was also recommended that requests for Forums and the selection of a host-city contact person should originate at the grass-roots level, and that requests should be referred to the regional trustee by the area delegate after the approval of the area assembly.

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed of Regional Forums, and the following is a schedule for future Forums:

1983

June 3-5	Northeast	Somerset, N.J.
July 1-3	Newfoundland	St. John's, Nfld.
September 30-October 2	East Central	Indianapolis, Ind.
December 2-4	Southwest	Denver, Colo.
1984		
March	Eastern Canada	(tentative)
June	Pacific	(tentative)
July 14-16	Hawaii	(tentative)
September	Western Canada	(tentative)
December	Southeast	(tentative)

John Ryall, chairperson

Staff report:

Regional Forums—They are held at the invitation of the region, and the fourth round is soon to be completed. Plans for Forums are made with the regional trustee, delegates from areas in the region, and the G.S.O. staff coordinator. General Service Board personnel attending have included: trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. Usually, six to eight people representing the board and two staff members attend. The board pays the expenses of all board and staff personnel; expenses of service people in the region are covered by the Conference areas if possible; if not, by the individual members.

The Regional Forum coordinator plans the Forum with the regional trustee and delegates and the general manager of G.S.O.; makes arrangements for the host-city contact (a local liaison) and hotel; arranges travel and hotel rooms for board personnel; is responsible for putting together agendas, formats, etc. at the request of the regional delegates and trustee; handles mailings to the region's delegates (asking for agenda suggestions), G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; and is responsible for display boards of literature and service material. Reports of Regional Forums are sent to all Forum participants, trustees, and current delegates. Any member wishing to attend a Forum may request a registration/reservation form from the Regional Forum coordinator at G.S.O.

Lyla Bonney

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

What's 'the largest A.A. group' existent?

Staff report: It is an exciting day in the Loners-Internationalists office when a Loner writes that a group has been formed and he or she is no longer a Loner. As the name implies, Loners are A.A.'s unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. Loners stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing experience, strength, and hope through letters and tapes. There are 515 Loners, in 87 countries.

LIMs are A.A.'s who are housebound because of a long-term illness or physical disability. We have 56 LIMs participating in the Loners-Internationalists Group.

Seagoing A.A.'s are known as Internationalists, and their number continues to grow. There are more than 500 Internationalists and Port Contacts, with 26 Internationalists groups meeting aboard ships or in ports.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, LIM, or Internationalist. They also receive lists of Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists and the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* — a discussion meeting in print sharing excerpts from letters received at G.S.O.

A growing number of A.A.'s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experiences with Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists. With approximately 2,200 A.A.'s participating in the Loners-Internationalists meeting-by-mail, it might be thought of as the largest A.A. group existing.

A.A.'s sweeping worldwide growth can largely be credited to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the seven seas, who are carrying the A.A. message wherever they may be.

Lois Fisher

Literature

History and Bill W. projects show progress

Trustees' committee: Among matters we have considered

since the 1982 Conference are the following.

- The committee received a progress report on the development of the proposed booklet "A.A.—the First 50 Years."
- We recommended that the Conference Literature Committee consider a proposal for the publication of a gift edition of the Big Book similar to that of "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."
- At the request of the 1982 Conference and with the aid of a subcommittee appointed for the purpose, we developed a draft of a pamphlet for alcoholics who are homosexuals, for consideration by the 1983 Conference.
- The committee received progress reports on the Bill W. manuscript. Another draft of the biography will be available for our consideration in the latter part of 1983, with the expectation that the book will be published in 1984, following Conference approval.
- We received a report from the subcommittee established to review literature and forwarded its recommendations to the Conference committee.
- We appointed a subcommittee to review the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" for possible revision.

Michael Alexander, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of publications and audiovisual material, in coordination with other staff members. This coordinator also works closely with the group services coordinator on all service material.



Booklets, pamphlets, and Box 4-5-9 in Spanish are handled by G.S.O.

We have nine periodical bulletins, with a combined circulation of 90,671, as follows:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9 (English)</i>	47,050	6
<i>Box 4-5-9 (French)¹</i>	2,410	6
<i>Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)</i>	9,645	6
<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>	3,394	6
<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>	3,580	3
<i>Correctional Facilities Bulletin</i>	6,013	3
<i>Quarterly Report</i>	4,636	3 ²
<i>About A.A.</i>	12,243	3
<i>Treatment Facilities Bulletin</i>	1,700	2
	90,671	38

The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising old pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in the preparation of new pamphlets, displays, leaflets, and other service materials, including audiovisual.

There is frequent correspondence with A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about A.A. literature. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, and literature distribution centers to keep them informed of new developments in A.A. literature, periodicals, other publications, and audiovisual materials.

Curtis Monahan

1 All bulletins except *L.I.M.* are translated into French and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Que., in cooperation with this office.

2 *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

Nominating

Groundwork laid for election of five trustees

Trustees' committee: In regard to the election of trustees, the committee reviewed and approved the August letter to delegates and area officers in the Northeast and Southwest Regions and Canada, as well as the written election procedures and résumé forms enclosed with the letter.

We attempted to meet a number of possible Class A trustees prior to a recommendation to the board that Joan Jackson be invited to serve as Class A trustee.

We recommended the nomination of Mary Phelps as a general service trustee conditional upon the board's decision re the legality of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board and appropriate revision of the Grapevine By-Laws.

In the History and Actions of the trustees' Nominating Committee, the outcome of various recommendations made to the Conference Committee on Trustees was not recorded. This may be a general problem with such histories, and it was recommended that G.S.O. staff discuss ways of correcting it.

We recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees review the format of the résumé form for Class B trustees. So that spelling and grammatical errors can be corrected, we



Joan Jackson's election marks a first: a woman as nonalcoholic trustee.

also recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees reconsider a past Conference action recommending that those forms be reproduced exactly as submitted.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1983 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander
W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.

Gordon M. Patrick
Frank Smeal
Kenneth P. Williams, M.D.

Class B

David Aronofsky
John Bragg
O. S. (Buck) Bruner
Donald F. Daly
Albert J. Hergott

Joe F. Kraus
Mary Phelps
Natalie Schwanke
Jacquelyn Solomon
Joan Ullom

(To be selected 4/20/83)

One regional trustee—Northeast U.S.

One regional trustee—Southwest U.S.

One trustee-at-large/Canada

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

Chairperson
First vice-chairperson
Second vice-chairperson
Secretary
Treasurer
Assistant treasurer
Assistant secretary

Gordon M. Patrick
Michael Alexander
W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.
Joe F. Kraus
Frank Smeal
Dennis Manders
Sarah Price (to be replaced
on rotation, 9/83)

The committee recommended that this slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1983 Conference:

John Bragg
William Croke
Thomas Jasper
Joe F. Kraus
Robert Pearson

Sarah Price (to be replaced
on rotation, 9/83)
Shepherd Raimi
Natalie Schwanke
Jacquelyn Solomon

Conditionally upon the board decision re legality of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board and appropriate revision of the Grapevine By-Laws, the committee recommended the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be presented to the 1983 Conference:

David Aronofsky
Donald F. Daly
Kenneth Dunphy
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Retha Gresham

Tom Neary
Mary Phelps
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
James Shannon
Stanley Silverman

The committee rescinded its 1978 action recommending that the election of a trustee-at-large should be scheduled as the first at Conferences. This will allow adequate time for staff and clerical assistants to prepare for such elections.

We reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustee of the Northeast and Southwest Regions and for trustee-at-large/Canada.

John Bragg, chairperson

Overseas, World Service Meeting

'Where there is structure, there is growth'

Staff report:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 31 G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada, in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany (West), Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Uruguay, and Venezuela.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O. U.S./Canada. For such countries, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information. G.S.O. U.S./Canada is grateful for up-to-date information from traveling A.A.'s about A.A. in other countries.

Correspondence from countries where there is no service center or office is answered by the staff member. We work closely with such countries to help them establish A.A. structures. Guidelines for the purpose are available from G.S.O. Correspondence that comes to us in a foreign language is translated, and a response is sent in the same language.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature. A request should come from the board, and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Here are some brief recent highlights about A.A. overseas.

- Permission to print the Big Book was granted by A.A. World Services, Inc., to the Dutch G.S.O.
- A G.S.O. staff member attended the Second European Service Meeting, in Frankfurt, West Germany, in February. First-time participants were Poland (we learned there is more A.A. activity there than we had known about), Denmark (which opened a National Service Office in July 1982), and Malta.

We are seeing beyond any doubt that countries can sponsor countries into service, and that World Service Meetings and interim zonal meetings are extremely effective in contributing to the growth of A.A. worldwide — where there is structure, there is growth.

World Service Meeting—The Seventh W.S.M. was held in October in San Juan del Rio, Mexico. Upon Sixth W.S.M. recommendation, simultaneous translation in Spanish and English was provided for the general sessions. (Delegates from Europe had English as a second language.) The theme was "Carrying the Message." The Meeting was attended by 37 delegates from 27 countries; for the first time, there were delegates from Uruguay, Trinidad/Tobago, and Italy. A *Final Report* on the Meeting is available to A.A. members.¹

Phyllis Masback

¹ Report to the Conference on this Meeting: p. 16

Public Information

Move to place the Big Book in more libraries

Trustees' committee: The following projects have been completed.

- After the 1982 Conference, a press release announcing Gordon Patrick's election as chairperson of the board was sent to major media outlets.
- On October 1, a press release announcing the World Service Meeting was mailed to wire services, major media outlets in ten top markets, and large-circulation dailies in the southwestern U.S.
- The annual anonymity memo to the press was released in December 1982 to major dailies (circulations over 50,000). Copies were sent to public information committees, for smaller, local newspapers.
- A feature story describing A.A. help for the hearing-impaired alcoholic was released to local P.I. committees. We now have ten press feature stories available.

- Two additional TV public service announcements, approved by last year's Conference, became available in August 1982; 57 units have been distributed. G.S.O. contacted the three U.S. networks, which have agreed to place these announcements in public service rotation.

- In February 1983, background material on the Big Book was sent to some 3,500 public librarians in the U.S. and Canada. This mailing included: a 12-page brochure of actual pages from the Big Book—material required by librarians; a cover letter; and an order form in English, French, and Spanish. (Committees occasionally donate Big Books to their local libraries; but often, a copy of our book cannot be found in a public library or even in its catalog. We believe that many librarians would be interested in ordering copies but may be unaware *how* to do so.)

- We recommend that the General Service Board undertake a membership survey in 1983, conducted on a random basis, by area. This is also an agenda item for the Conference P.I. Committee.

- We discussed the possibility of arranging media interviews for the chairperson of the board and other Class A trustees. Local committees might try that when these trustees attend Regional Forums. The suggestion was passed along to the trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums.

The following project is in progress.

- We are glad to report headway with the Spanish translation of our press feature stories and plan to have a complete set available within the next few months.

The following are projects for the future.

- Should this Conference approve a 1983 membership survey, our committee will be revising "The A.A. Member" pamphlet, tabletop display, and poster. Also, we plan to send a press release on survey results to major newspapers and TV/radio news directors.

- We will discuss preparing a new feature story about A.A. help for the Lone Member, of particular interest to smaller publications in remote areas.

Jacquelyn Solomon, chairperson

Staff report: The growth of local A.A. public information committees is remarkable. Within the past five years, the number has more than doubled (232 in 1977, 575 in 1982). We distributed 1,538 Public Information Workbooks. Our correspondence with local committees reveals that health fairs are becoming more and more popular in the U.S. and Canada. In 1982, we supplied literature and displays to 200 health fairs.

Local P.I. committees report receiving many invitations to speak in schools, churches, public meetings, and professional organizations. G.S.O. has P.I. Discount Packages available to help local committees carry the message. Also, two complimentary flyers continue to be valuable P.I. tools: More than 469,000 copies of "A.A. at a Glance" and 431,600 copies of "A Message to Teenagers" were sent to local P.I. committees, alcoholism agencies, and intergroup offices for information at non-A.A. meetings.

We list 429 P.I. contacts and suspect there are many more. P.I. committee members receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* three times yearly, plus service material. Chairpersons and contacts receive copies of the annual anonymity memo to the press and news of any new P.I. material available from G.S.O.

Three people cover P.I. correspondence at G.S.O.—the staff member and two devoted nonalcoholics. In 1982, we answered more than 10,000 written requests for information about A.A. from students, teachers, nurses, doctors, members of the clergy, family members, and the public media—and an incalculable number of phone calls! We processed clippings of close to 6,000 newspaper and magazine stories about A.A. and wrote thank-you notes to publications that ran fine articles about our Fellowship. The June 1982 *Redbook* article "Alcoholism: Suddenly It's a Young Woman's Problem" prompted a flurry of inquiries, as did a number of Ann Landers, Dear Abby, and Dr. Brothers columns throughout the year. Through our clipping service, we also learned of approximately ten anonymity breaks each month and followed up with the delegates.

In 1982, we distributed 149 radio and 275 TV public service announcements through local committees. G.S.O. has placed the P.S.A.'s with the major U.S. TV networks, and cable networks are showing interest. We have cooperated with several major TV stations by meeting with their community-service personnel, producers, and writers. The film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" has served as an excellent research vehicle, to assist media people in preparing background material.

It is exhilarating and humbling to hear, several times daily, that our non-A.A. friends in the media are so willing to cooperate with us in every way possible. And when we hear A.A.'s say that they first learned about our Fellowship, and the possibility of recovery in it, through publications or public service announcements, our gratitude to A.A. and to our non-A.A. friends grows and deepens.

Vincina McCarthy

Staff coordinator

A spiritual task—and businesslike operation

Staff report: One of the important responsibilities of the 11 G.S.O. staff members is to answer correspondence. In 1982, about 20,000 letters were answered. Most staff members have specific assignments, some of which involve the preparation of special service bulletins, and most staff members also correspond with the A.A. groups in a given region of the U.S., Canada, or the rest of the world. The work is divided as follows:

Conference

Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird Box 4-5-9; *Final Conference Report*

Cooperation with the professional community

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.; P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*

Correctional facilities

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Correctional Facilities Bulletin*

Group services coordinator, treatment facilities	Supervision of service materials and Guidelines; secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; <i>Treatment Facilities Bulletin</i>
Literature coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; production and distribution of nine G.S.O. bulletins, including Spanish <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; coordination of French <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; preparation of filmstrips; updating of old pamphlets; preparation of new pamphlets; film preparation and distribution
Loners, Internationalists, LIMs	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
Overseas, World Service Meeting	Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; <i>World Service Meeting Report</i>
Public information	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; <i>P.J.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Regional Forums	Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; editor, <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Staff coordinator	Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Administrations; director, A.A.W.S.; <i>Quarterly Report</i> ; secretary, International Convention; co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Staff meetings are held weekly to keep the staff informed and provide a forum for discussion of problems that need some direction from the group conscience. Another aspect of our work is the invitations received from areas for A.A. get-togethers. On these trips, we are able to learn of local activities, and that information helps us to be a better service office. Additionally, over the past year, we have greeted about 1,500 visitors who have come from around the world to tour the General Service Office.

The staff coordinator looks after staff coverage, makes sure mail is answered without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences, and also serves as the liaison between the staff and other departments.

Sarah Price

Treatment Facilities

References to medication use studied critically

Trustees' committee: After reviewing our subcommittee's report on updating and revising the pamphlet "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse," we decided, because of the inaccuracies in that pamphlet, to recommend to the Conference Literature Committee that it not be distributed and that it no longer be printed or circulated.

The subcommittee is continuing to compile material directed toward the preparation of a brief pamphlet on the question of A.A. members' giving advice regarding prescribed medication. The pamphlet would include a sharing of A.A. experience on the subject. The subcommittee also reviewed Chapter 21, entitled "Avoiding All Chemical Mood-Change," in the booklet "Living Sober" and provided input for the trustees' Literature Committee.

We supported the concept of A.A. groups' providing Grapevine subscriptions to the treatment centers they cooperate with.

On the subject of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*: It was suggested that it appear as a regular agenda item at future meetings; that an announcement about its availability be made in *Box 4-5-9*; that the Grapevine reprint "What A.A. Meetings Taught a Non-A.A. Counselor" be sent with the April 1983 issue. We referred to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities a recommendation that there be a discussion about sending a copy of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* to alcoholism treatment facilities, with a cover letter suggesting they get in touch with local C.P.C., treatment facilities, or institutions committees, A.A. groups, or A.A. individuals.

The committee also suggested that the following item be referred to the Conference committee: What is the best mechanism for referring new alcoholics from treatment centers to the local A.A. community?

Kenneth Williams, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: Carrying the message into treatment centers continues to grow. Service material has been prepared by G.S.O. sharing how some areas cope with the influx of new alcoholics from these centers.

Correspondence from A.A.'s carrying the message into treatment facilities indicates that more regular A.A. groups are being formed that use meeting space in treatment centers but are open to A.A.'s in the community. It was suggested that a group not be named after a treatment facility, since it does imply affiliation.

The one-page flyer "Where Do I Go From Here?," prepared by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities, is still being used in large quantities. It was designed to be given to the patient leaving the facility, to make it clear that A.A. on the "outside" is ready and willing to help. A space is left at the bottom for the inclusion of local A.A. contact information. The flyer is available in quantity at no charge.

G.S.O. provides the following services to those in treatment facilities: correspondence with the staff member on this assignment; a correspondence service (putting outside A.A.'s in touch with confined members through correspondence); for new groups, a Group Handbook and complimentary literature; a discount package of A.A. literature (ordered through the committee or the group); Guidelines for Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees; *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly.

The 1982 General Service Conference approved the publication of a separate bulletin for treatment facilities committees, so the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* is now available twice a year.

Beth Kuhlmann

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

Profitable half year, circulation turnabout

Directors' report: Income for the year increased by \$129,000 as a result of the subscription price increase, effective with the January 1982 issue. However, that increase was \$42,000 less than projected in the budget because of circulation lower than anticipated. The average monthly circulation for 1982 was 121,458; for 1981, 122,952. We wonder whether this flatness results from general economic conditions or resistance to the price increase. The board has concluded that the current price is fair and provides for the Grapevine's future economic health. We approved an adjustment in the price of Canadian subscriptions because of the postage differential.

Expenses for the year increased by 1%. A major factor in the modest size of this increase was the 24% reduction in printing expenses. The good news is that the Grapevine showed a profit for the third and fourth quarters of 1982—the first profitable quarters since 1979. The final, relatively modest net loss of \$27,000 for the year resulted from the declines in circulation and, surprisingly, in the popularity of calendars.



The May Grapevine, distributed at the Conference, presented an illustrated article on A.A. history. Here's how the Dayton (Ohio) Group solved the anonymity problem, for a late 1930's story in the Journal-Herald.

Plans are under way to tie in the Grapevine subscription data base with the G.S.O. computer. This will require an investment of approximately \$75,000 but will enable us to control our own lists in the future. We believe we may have lost subscriptions in the last two years because of problems caused by the company providing that service. The long-range financial result of this investment could be a saving of \$50,000 per year.

The staff's concern about circulation has caused it to turn to the Fellowship for information. The major effort was a reader survey conducted by inserting a card in the March issue. Results will be published. We have known for a long time that a minority of A.A. members read the Grapevine; but the circulation figures don't give the whole story, because the magazine is passed from hand to hand.

An attempt is now being made to find out why some A.A. members do not read the Grapevine. In the February all-groups mailing, there was a survey aimed at nonreaders. The most pertinent question was "If you don't read the Grapevine, why not?"—a question that only an A.A. survey would ask. Those results will be published, too.

A poster has been prepared for use at conferences to express the idea that the Grapevine will grow if readers share what a great sobriety tool it is.

The editorial staff is hard at work with the support of the Editorial Board. Much effort has focused on finding more articles on A.A. history and news. One Editorial Board member will write occasional historical articles; the first appears in the May issue. On the news front, consideration is being given to appointing interested A.A.'s as Grapevine editorial representatives who will inform us of news in their areas. These stories may range from human interest to reports on conventions or unusual service projects. The staff has prepared guidelines for writing Grapevine articles, available on request.

The magazine started 1983 with an artistic bang, with outstanding covers for the first three issues. January's "ticket to the Serenity Theater" brought rave reviews. The February cover featuring a black family was a first for the Grapevine. The March cover used a photographic treatment, another first.

Donald F. Daly, chairperson

Staff report: In January 1982, the Grapevine moved into cramped temporary quarters pending the final renovation and refurbishing of offices. Over the noise and dust, we heard a loud voice from the readership indicating that our computer problems were almost insurmountable. Grapevine personnel spent extra time and effort, and it finally became apparent that we were on top of the situation, but our then-new computer service was not adequate. So we were delighted at the plan for the Grapevine to have its own computer operation, with the responsibility for accuracy in-house. All employees are excited about the possibilities.

We have all been aware of the downward trend in circulation. However, with the help of the GvR network and with responses to our Christmas gift subscription offer, the December circulation was 121,800, showing a turnabout. Results of our two reader surveys will be distributed during Conference week. Early returns promise some interesting information.

The Grapevine staff and other personnel have survived some lean and difficult years, during which work was done without adequate working space, changes in procedures were implemented, and literally thousands of computer problems were resolved. Morale has held fast and steady, with dedication from alcoholics and nonalcoholics alike. Work flow from department to department is good, with top-quality team effort in all areas. We've met past challenges head-on and will meet those presented in the future with the dedication to service the Fellowship deserves.

Retha Gresham, managing editor

The only Panel 32 delegate to accompany Lyla Bonney (G.S.O. staff) on the subway trip to G.S.O. was Doug Riley (Northwestern Texas). Perhaps the others had a greener memory about last year, when Lyla shepherded a group onto the wrong train. As Doug and Lyla headed for the subway stairs in Grand Central Station, they were accosted by one of those shopping-bag ladies with a grudge against the world. Doug was shocked to hear the derelict call Lyla a "drunken animal." It's okay for us sober A.A.'s to call ourselves drunks, but . . . The use of "animal" as a swearword also annoyed the Texan—he's an animal-lover. (P.S.: Lyla and Doug took the right train this time.)

Prudence Marks 1983 Recommendations

Advisory Actions

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the Board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to

the action introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings. (Members and officers of the 1983 committees are listed on page 56.)

Floor Action

It was recommended that:

1 We send an invitation to a friend of A.A. to share with us spiritually on Sunday morning at the 1985 International Convention; and we would like that person to be a member of Al-Anon.

Agenda

It was recommended that:

2 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1984 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

3 The following be considered for the 1984 Conference theme: (a) "Our Primary Purpose"; (b) "The Frontier for A.A.'s Future—The Group"; (c) "Gratitude—The Language of the Heart."

4 The following presentation/discussion topics be considered for the 1984 Conference: (a) "How Does A.A. Respond to a Changing World?" — (1) "Are We Listening to the Newcomer?," (2) "Open-Mindedness," (3) "Working With Third Parties"; (b) "The Informed Group Conscience—My Obligation" — (1) "To Understand the Steps," (2) "To Understand the Traditions," (3) "To Understand the Concepts"; (c) "Sobriety—What Is It?"

5 At next year's Conference, the following structured workshops be considered: (a) "Solutions for Everyday Problems in A.A."; (b) "How Does A.A. Respond to a Changing World?"

6 The Conference Agenda Committee secretary outline the procedure for selecting Conference items and send it to the Agenda Committee members with their February letter.

7 Conference Agenda Committee members wait seven days from the date of the postmark before replying to the Agenda Committee secretary's request for approval of the trustees' Conference Committee recommendations regarding the next year's Conference agenda.

Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

8 The statement that "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc." be included in the pamphlets "A.A. in Your

Community," "If You Are a Professional," and "How A.A. Members Cooperate," the flyer "A.A. at a Glance," and the A.A. Guidelines on Cooperating With Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs.

Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

9 A Correctional Facilities Workbook be developed for carrying the A.A. message into correctional facilities. Also, that this be developed through the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, and that a draft be prepared for the 1984 Conference, using the survey results and other information.

10 A letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service be sent twice a year to delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons, asking for A.A. volunteers to write inmates on an individual basis.

11 "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" be translated into Spanish.

Finance

It was recommended that:

12 An earlier treatment of illustrating the Regular Contribution Plan in cartoon fashion be revised and reissued to supplement the pamphlet titled "Supporting the A.A. Support System," with the 1967 A.A. Grapevine article titled "A.A.'s Tradition of Self-Support," written by Bill, printed on the reverse of the flyer. Further, this flyer is to be produced in the English, Spanish, and French languages and distributed simultaneously.

13 The need to decrease dependence on publishing income and the need for greater participation and increased contributions from the groups to accomplish this goal be simplified conceptually in graphic form.

14 In keeping with our Seventh Tradition at the group, area, and G.S.O. level, the Conference stress the importance and necessity of discussing self-support at area and local workshops.

Presentations related to finance: p. 17

Grapevine

It was recommended that:

15 A trial tape cassette of articles from the Grapevine classic

issues be prepared and made available as a special item, with future taping to be considered by the 1984 Conference.

16 Delegates research the need for the "About Alcoholism" section in their areas, and that the question of the function of and need for this section be brought to the 1984 Conference.

17 All communications to area Grapevine chairpersons also be sent to delegates.

18 Making the Grapevine available to outside agencies be left for area service structures to handle, in the spirit of autonomy.

Presentations on Grapevine: p. 12

Three delegates at the 1983 Conference were spouses of past delegates: Elke Forbes (Panel 32 alternate, Delaware), wife of Fred Forbes (Panel 25); Carol King (Panel 33, Western Pennsylvania), wife of Ken King (Panel 27); and Jan Polek (Panel 33, Washington), wife of Fran Polek (Panel 27).

Literature

It was recommended that:

19 The distribution of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" be continued at this time, until it is revised for consideration by the 1984 Conference.

20 The revision of Chapter 21 of the booklet "Living Sober" be accepted.

21 The following changes be made in the pamphlets (a) "Is A.A. for You?"—substitute the following words—disease for sick, and alcohol for booze; Question #4 should be changed to read, "Have you had to have an eye-opener on awakening?"; (b) "This Is A.A."—page 5, paragraph 1, should be changed to read, "There are a number of self-proclaimed atheists and agnostics among us"; (c) "It Happened to Alice"—should be brought up to date visually; on page 19, the word fun should be put in quotes; (d) "What Happened to Joe"—should be brought up to date visually; (e) "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"—consider changing the wording on page 15, paragraph 3, and page 13, paragraph 2; the wording should be clear in answering the question on page 13, paragraph 2—"Is a special approach needed for present-day newcomers?" (f) The revised manuscript of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet not be approved at this time and be returned for further revision.

22 The word "suggested" in the title of the Twelve Steps not be reinstated.

23 The 1983 draft of the pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be approved for circulation to Conference members, so that the 1984 Conference may make an informed policy decision as to whether or not the Fellowship will publish and distribute a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic.

24 The suggestion that a filmstrip be produced on the functions of central and intergroup offices not be approved; and that the 1982 Conference Advisory Action regarding the suggestion for this filmstrip be reaffirmed.

Presentations on topic related to Advisory Actions 19, 20: p. 19



For each general session, Conference members headed up the steps from the Roosevelt lobby to the Oval Room, then left into the Terrace Room.

Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

25 The 1982 Conference action be amended to read: "All non-trustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. All nontrustee, nondirector members be encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve."

26 The dates for the 1984 Conference be Monday, April 16, through Saturday, April 21, even though this would include certain religious holidays.

27 The Conference Committees on Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter consider, at their 1984 committee meetings, the possibility of combining the functions of these two committees.

Public Information

It was recommended that:

28 A membership survey be undertaken in 1983.

29 The 1983 membership survey be conducted on a random basis, by area.

30 A reference to photographs be added to the Anonymity Card—the third paragraph to read as follows: "Thus, we respectfully ask that no A.A. speaker—or, indeed, any A.A. member—be identified by full name or photograph in published or broadcast reports of our meetings."

31 The trustees' Public Information Committee develop a feature story regarding A. A. 's primary purpose, highlighting the cross section of alcoholics now sober in A. A. and including, if practical, the A. A. Preamble.

32 A. A. W. S. explore the feasibility of translating the sound tracks of existing TV public service announcements into Spanish.

Presentations on topic related to Advisory Action 30: pp. 9, 24
Workshop on topic related to Advisory Action 30: p. 11

Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

33 The reinclusion of the past-experiences portions of "The A. A. Service Manual" pertaining to G. S. R. 's and D. C. M. 's be included on next year's Conference Report and Charter Committee agenda for the purpose of adding personal experience in the area of financial support of G. S. R. 's and D. C. M. 's. The committee felt that the eligibility qualifications of D. C. M. 's were already spelled out in the service manual and, therefore, no additional input is necessary.

Presentation on topic related to Advisory Action 33: p. 18

Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

34 A copy of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* with a cover letter be sent to alcoholism treatment facilities; the cover letter is to suggest the facilities get in touch with Alcoholics Anonymous. Delegates ask their treatment facilities committees or other appropriate committees to compile a mailing list of alcoholism treatment facilities in their areas for the purpose of establishing a G. S. O. mailing list for the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*.

Presentations referring to treatment facilities: pp. 20, 21



Alex Christoforou (left), in 40 years of working at the Roosevelt, has served members of about 25 A. A. General Service Conferences. Charlie Hunt is another Conference veteran, a 25-year employee.

During the regional trustee elections, procedures seemed to be bogged down, and trustee John Bragg called from the podium, "Is there an A. A. parliamentarian in the house?" "Ninety-one of them," replied Bob Pearson.

Trustees

It was recommended that:

35 The following slate of trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1983 [see page 42; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 42; slate of officers approved]; that the following be elected as directors of A. A. World Services, Inc. [see page 43; slate of directors approved]; that the following be elected as directors of The A. A. Grapevine, Inc. [see page 43; slate of directors approved].

36 The General Service Board of trustees cause a study to be made concerning inconsistencies between legal directions and actual practice of rotation in our two corporate boards and committees.

37 The General Service Board of trustees explore the possibility of establishing an internal check-and-balance method that would possibly insure against the inadvertent violation of the spirit of rotation on the corporate boards and committees.

38 An effort be made to rectify contradictions and inconsistencies between "The A. A. Service Manual" and legal charters and corporate by-laws.

The committee, in the A. A. spirit of trust and love, leaves these suggestions and recommendations in the capable hands of the trustees, requesting they report their doings to the 1984 General Service Conference.

39 Date of birth replace age, and that date of sobriety replace length of sobriety on the Class B trustee résumé forms. The committee also recommended striking marital status from Class B résumé forms, in that marital status furnishes no valid bearing on the candidates' qualifications.

40 Résumés for trustee candidates received at the General Service Office be presented to the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees exactly as received, with the exception that spelling and grammatical errors may be corrected by the General Service Office staff preparing résumés for distribution, retaining the original résumés for reference.

New Regional and At-Large Trustees

On Wednesday afternoon, Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: as Northeast U. S. regional trustee, Garrett Taylor; as Southwest U. S. regional trustee, Wayne Parks; as trustee-at-large/Canada, Helen A. Harmon. The three were elected at the April 23 meeting of the board, after the close of the Conference.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1982

	1982	1981
INCOME		
Sales of literature	\$4,682,213	\$4,443,965
Less: Discount to A. A. groups	(199,918)	(191,495)
<u>Net Sales</u>	4,482,295	4,252,470
Less: Cost of printing	(1,666,915)	(1,533,539)
Royalties	(561,832)	(521,878)
<u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>	2,253,548	2,197,053
Contributions — A. A. groups and members	1,760,171	1,564,643
Interest income	9,835	20,442
<u>Total Income</u>	4,023,554	3,782,138
EXPENSES		
Salaries	1,652,512	1,467,392
Pension expense	198,442	185,230
Rent	230,393	168,990
Box 4-5-9	93,911	86,011
A. A. directories	64,465	57,467
Other Service Office printing	167,131	134,594
Shipping and mailing	545,261	483,652
Other office expenses	309,224	337,703
Insurance and payroll taxes	222,227	206,840
Professional services	36,544	34,250
Board, committee, and staff meetings	88,487	77,433
1982 World Service Meeting	35,914	—
Writers' fees	53,252	35,383
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	60,511	59,923
General Service Conference	138,868	115,680
E.D.P. system development, equipment, and maintenance	45,567	46,307
Regional Forums and other expenses	48,514	39,249
Construction expense	226,405	791,238
<u>Total Expense</u>	4,217,628	4,327,342
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR (page 52)	<u>(194,074)</u>	<u>(545,204)</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing — A. A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 561,837	\$ 669,286
General Fund — General Service Board	(755,911)	(1,214,490)
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$2,414,916	\$2,959,335
Transfer to General Fund	(100,000)	(825,000)
Investment income	260,588	280,581
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>2,575,504</u>	<u>2,414,916</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1982

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated

(continued)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Financial statements

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1982

	1982	1981
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales (Schedule 1)	<u>\$ 951,638</u>	<u>\$ 822,600</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$142,603	\$128,710
Printing	168,190	222,524
Mailing — service	91,750	69,523
— postage	96,860	83,597
Other printing costs	19,798	32,432
Calendar costs	21,954	28,803
Occupancy costs	24,643	19,054
Telephone	1,560	1,481
Office supplies and expenses	4,450	4,322
Other editorial expenses	<u>5,141</u>	<u>3,494</u>
Total	576,949	593,940
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	186,165	156,436
Data processing costs	59,711	52,141
Stationery and supplies	3,947	9,566
Occupancy costs	24,643	19,054
Telephone	1,559	1,481
Office expense, including agency fees	10,891	15,555
Selling expense — regular	22,813	33,518
— GvR program	15,427	14,062
Postage	<u>40,280</u>	<u>37,147</u>
Total	365,436	338,960
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,496	5,497
Insurance	17,442	16,069
Legal and accounting	11,565	14,100
Payroll taxes	22,381	18,507
Meetings and conferences	6,624	4,604
Furniture and equipment	150	2,611
Contribution to Retirement Plan	15,156	14,473
Canadian exchange	<u>557</u>	<u>1,028</u>
Total	79,371	76,889
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,021,756</u>	<u>1,009,739</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(70,118)	(187,189)
Interest earned	<u>42,157</u>	<u>50,487</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (page 52)	<u>(27,961)</u>	<u>(136,702)</u>

() denotes red figures

into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1982

	December 31, 1982		December 31, 1981	
OPERATING FUNDS	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 190,571	\$ 73,968	\$ 295,431	\$ 34,028
Savings accounts and certificates	330,210	21,361	208,677	60,696
Short-term cash investment	—	43,092	—	—
Investment (Note C)	—	380,720	—	380,720
Accounts receivable	65,343	10,990	78,220	9,556
Due from Grapevine	6,418	—	7,774	—
Inventories	991,731	83,566	1,079,275	70,548
Prepaid expenses	100,903	73,703	140,111	75,941
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>1,685,176</u>	<u>687,400</u>	<u>1,809,488</u>	<u>631,489</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	338,466	98,898	364,143	102,744
Deferred income	—	720,544	4,561	632,826
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>338,466</u>	<u>819,442</u>	<u>368,704</u>	<u>735,570</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,440,784	(104,081)	1,160,988	32,621
Net income (loss) (pages 50, 51)	(194,074)	(27,961)	(545,204)	(136,702)
Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund	100,000	—	825,000	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,346,710</u>	<u>(132,042)</u>	<u>1,440,784</u>	<u>(104,081)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A. A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,289,697		\$1,383,771	
General Fund — G. S. B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
<u>Total Operating Funds — as above</u>	<u>1,346,710</u>		<u>1,440,784</u>	
Reserve Fund	2,575,504		2,414,916	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>3,922,214</u>		<u>3,855,700</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 17,487		\$ 230,370	
Savings accounts and temporary investments	105		145,216	
Due from (to) A. A. Grapevine	(9,900)		(5,400)	
U. S. Treasury obligations	2,394,885		1,689,999	
Government agency bonds	470,000		679,824	
Accrued interest	83,647		55,627	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers (Note C)	(380,720)		(380,720)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>2,575,504</u>		<u>2,414,916</u>	

() denotes red figures

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$655,911 in 1982 and \$389,490 in 1981 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$380,720 — represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, less \$100,000 withdrawn by the Grapevine during 1981 to restore its depleted working capital.

These financial statements and the foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1983 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$4,856,100. Following a relatively flat year, net sales income is conservatively projected to show an 8% increase over 1982. During 1983, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 500,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 255,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—regular edition, 53,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—pocket edition, 22,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 59,000 "As Bill Sees It," 25,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," and more than 7,000,000 booklets, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$2,328,100—the cost of printing and producing the items sold and the royalties paid on book sales—the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$2,528,000. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$2,538,000.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,866,400, representing an increase of 10% over 1982. Considered in this increase are higher costs related to increased publishing activity and, to some extent, continuing inflationary pressures. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$671,600.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions from groups and A.A. members have been budgeted at \$1,936,100, an increase of 10% over 1982 actual.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$2,222,500. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$145,600. The cost of all service expenses is budgeted to be \$286,400 greater than contribution income. This shortfall will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Less interest earned on cash flow, other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$272,100. Included in this category of expense are such items as the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing fees, the expense of the archives, and the costs of filmstrips and displays. These expenses will be offset by net income from the publishing operation.

Net income for the General Service Office has been budgeted at \$113,100.

1983 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,061,500. This represents an increase of \$109,900 over 1982. The basis of this increase is the result of higher subscription rates and prices.

Total expenses: Including nonrecurring expenses for in-house computerization, expenses are budgeted at \$1,111,200. A net operating deficit in the amount of \$49,700 has been budgeted for 1983.

1983 G.S.O. Budget

Financial statements

The budget for 1983 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Net sales	\$4,856,100*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	2,328,100
Gross profit from sales	2,528,000
Interest income	10,000
Total income	2,538,000

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	671,600
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**Based on the sale of:*

500,000 books	—	"Alcoholics Anonymous"
255,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
53,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
22,000 books	—	"A.A. Comes of Age"
59,000 books	—	"As Bill Sees It"
25,000 books	—	"Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"
	and	
		Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,936,100
---------------	-------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	(286,400)
----------------------------	-----------

****Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$145,600**

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 5,000
----------	----------

TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	(272,100)
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*****Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, archives, filmstrips, etc.**

The publishing activity will contribute \$558,500 toward the budgeted deficits, leaving a net G.S.O. income in the amount of \$113,100.

1983 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$1,061,500
Total costs and expenses	1,111,200
Net income (loss) from operations	<u>(\$ 49,700)</u>

Contributions

1982 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita
1. Ala./N.W. Fla.		233	139	59.7%	\$ 9,959.83	2,634	\$3.78
2. Alsk.		100	50	50.0	3,211.46	1,095	2.93
3. Ariz.		431	214	49.7	18,609.58	7,012	2.65
4. Ark. Calif.		142	90	63.4	4,304.71	2,096	2.05
5. S.		947	460	48.6	50,441.71	28,978	1.74
6. N. Coastal		1,075	745	69.3	83,010.99	25,456	3.26
7. N. Int.		400	203	50.8	16,544.89	8,144	2.03
8. San Diego		356	213	59.8	15,990.96	9,528	1.68
9. Mid-S.		824	472	57.3	39,221.00	23,276	1.69
10. Colo.		388	220	56.7	21,312.09	7,469	2.85
11. Conn.		710	410	57.7	32,389.05	14,704	2.20
12. Del.		90	69	76.7	6,201.43	1,434	4.32
13. D.C. Fla.		280	164	58.6	22,090.96	8,615	2.56
14. N.		271	169	62.4	15,623.10	4,104	3.81
15. S.		727	462	63.5	51,071.96	11,551	4.42
16. Ga.		415	288	69.4	23,608.48	7,138	3.31
17. Haw.		127	94	74.0	7,011.79	2,110	3.32
18. Idaho Ill.		115	62	53.9	3,673.39	1,274	2.88
19. Chicago		576	300	52.1	33,317.10	12,067	2.76
20. N.		616	295	47.9	24,458.53	11,482	2.13
21. S. Ind.		244	119	48.8	9,165.91	3,760	2.44
22. N.		344	172	50.0	14,950.85	4,812	3.11
23. S.		208	125	60.1	12,249.38	3,646	3.36
24. Iowa		436	245	56.2	16,206.95	8,077	2.01
25. Kans.		256	173	67.6	12,719.76	5,125	2.48
26. Ky.		299	168	56.2	21,401.02	4,175	5.13
27. La.		313	178	56.9	15,035.84	4,529	3.32
28. Me.		222	126	56.8	7,788.05	2,881	2.70
29. Md.		441	242	54.9	24,613.46	5,666	4.34
30. Mass.		714	380	53.2	40,333.09	19,256	2.09
31. E. W.		123	61	49.6	4,417.09	2,538	1.74
32. Cent. Mich.		278	163	58.6	24,494.80	5,454	4.49
33. S.E.		283	142	50.2	16,142.51	7,213	2.24
34. W. Minn.		222	124	55.9	12,617.53	4,597	2.74
35. N.		391	204	52.2	13,814.25	6,349	2.18
36. S.		711	370	52.0	31,097.92	21,948	1.42
37. Miss. Mo.		150	86	57.3	4,850.89	1,794	2.70
38. E.		320	208	65.0	18,015.17	5,228	3.45
39. W.		154	90	58.4	8,323.88	2,785	2.99
40. Mont.		202	97	48.0	6,413.65	2,417	2.65
41. Nebr.		455	284	62.4	28,615.13	7,790	3.67
42. Nev.		142	69	48.6	5,439.32	1,614	3.37
43. N.H. N.J.		204	114	55.9	6,941.06	2,663	2.61
44. N.		720	379	52.6	37,995.48	15,609	2.43
45. S.		187	114	61.0	13,807.54	2,842	4.86
46. N.M. N.Y.		144	105	72.9	7,641.44	2,036	3.75
47. Cent.		364	176	48.4	15,775.84	4,906	3.22
48. H./M./B.		296	141	47.6	8,534.77	3,708	2.30
49. S.E.		1,004	540	53.8	66,949.78	25,752	2.60
50. W.		164	88	53.7	6,757.37	2,171	3.11
51. N.C./Ber.		469	295	62.9	20,322.97	6,869	2.96
52. N. Dak. Ohio		124	84	67.7	6,314.61	2,007	3.15
53. Cent. & S.E.		268	105	39.2	6,931.65	3,660	1.89
54. N.E.		555	195	35.1	13,444.79	13,719	.98
55. N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.		142	82	57.7	8,326.33	2,016	4.13
56. S.W. Ohio/ N. Ky.		226	119	52.7	7,692.23	3,566	2.16
57. Okla.		265	213	80.4	19,912.88	3,476	5.73
58. Oreg. Pa.		374	208	55.6	13,196.45	4,933	2.68
59. E.		584	343	58.7	34,542.97	12,281	2.81
60. W.		366	217	59.3	18,044.97	5,211	3.46
61. R.I.		144	86	59.7	7,722.84	2,108	3.66
62. S.C.		161	126	78.3	8,931.57	2,150	4.15

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita
63. S. Dak.		123	72	58.5	5,702.57	2,269	2.51
64. Tenn. Tex.		251	160	63.7	10,751.61	3,644	2.95
65. N.E.		251	146	58.2	19,015.67	6,927	2.75
66. N.W.		159	88	55.3	7,997.56	3,501	2.28
67. S.E.		279	173	62.0	16,406.25	8,489	1.93
68. S.W.		277	167	60.3	16,157.54	4,941	3.27
69. Utah		126	71	56.3	5,158.69	1,859	2.77
70. Vt.		101	53	52.5	4,560.27	1,560	2.92
71. Va.		620	399	64.4	31,865.86	11,749	2.71
72. Wash.		713	420	58.9	41,160.85	12,306	3.34
73. W. Va. Wis.		149	99	66.4	6,470.50	1,514	4.27
74. N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.		420	223	53.1	19,160.21	6,228	3.08
75. S.		426	234	54.9	18,744.15	6,530	2.87
76. Wyo.		79	49	62.0	2,409.09	1,079	2.23
77. P.R.		101	62	61.4	2,928.86	1,320	2.22
78. Alta./N.W.T.		408	171	41.9	17,632.22	5,193	3.40
79. B.C./Yukon		500	257	51.4	23,602.49	7,060	3.34
80. Man.		141	76	53.9	6,532.65	3,183	2.05
81. N.B./P.E.I.		186	115	61.8	6,813.73	2,582	2.64
82. N.S./Nfld./Lab. Ont.		215	112	52.1	6,493.43	2,447	2.65
83. E.		421	195	46.3	21,043.98	9,640	2.18
84. N.E.		152	58	38.2	4,053.91	1,772	2.29
85. N.W.		70	31	44.3	3,159.27	1,134	2.79
86. W. Que.		383	193	50.4	20,830.89	5,959	3.50
87. S.W.		465	400	86.0	12,346.07	12,401	1.00
88. S.E.		215	215	100.0	2,773.81	3,016	.92
89. N.E.		270	270	100.0	4,993.18	5,243	.95
90. N.W.		255	255	100.0	10,906.63	4,227	2.58
91. Sask.		294	189	64.3	10,633.73	3,589	2.96
Total U.S./Canada		30,542	17,628	57.7%	\$1,520,852.67	584,866	\$2.60
Bahamas		7	2	28.6	150.00	124	1.21
V.I. of U.S.		7	3	42.9	539.63	144	3.75
		30,556	17,633	57.7% ^①	\$1,521,542.30 ^②	585,134	\$2.60 ^①
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					49,390.79		
Specials					160,032.43		
Total for U.S. & Canada					\$1,730,965.52		
FOREIGN AND OTHER							
Birds of a Feather					422.00		
Correctional facility groups					171.00		
Foreign					11,754.64		
International Advisory Council for Homosexual Men and Women in A.A.					230.00		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.					9,726.68		
International Lawyers in A.A.					753.20		
Internationalists					541.70		
Internationalists groups					67.00		
Treatment facility groups					4,673.24		
Grand Total					\$1,759,304.98		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1982-1981							
	#Gps. re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita	
U.S. & Canada 1982	30,556	17,633 ^①	57.7% ^①	\$1,521,542.30 ^②	585,134	\$2.60 ^①	
U.S. & Canada 1981	28,074	16,170 ^①	57.6 ^①	\$1,381,824.60 ^②	519,749	\$2.66 ^①	
Increase (Decrease)	2,482	1,463	.1% *	\$139,717.70	65,385	(\$.06)	

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)						
Alberta	363	162	44.6%	\$ 26,647.07	4,748	\$5.61
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	133	79	59.3	5,688.15	1,655	3.44
Newfoundland	72	31	43.0	2,570.90	789	3.26
Nova Scotia	141	80	56.7	6,152.02	1,656	3.71
Prince Edward Island	57	39	68.4	3,697.47	992	3.73
Labrador	2	1	50.0	43.89	34	1.29
British Columbia	532	275	51.6	37,105.63	7,357	5.04
Manitoba	141	76	53.9	8,172.80	3,183	2.57
N.W. Territories	17	1	5.8	150.47	172	.87
Ontario	996	447	44.8	73,948.49	18,286	4.04
Quebec	1,191	1,141	95.8	44,044.99	23,736	1.86
Saskatchewan	294	189	64.2	14,134.43	3,589	3.94
Yukon Territory	9	3	33.3	226.81	147	1.54
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	3,948	2,524 ^①	63.9%	222,583.12	66,344	3.35 ^①
			(converted to U.S. dollars)	177,510.04		2.68
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA (U.S. dollars)	30,556	17,633 ^①	57.7%	\$1,730,965.52	585,134	2.96 ^①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				422.00		
Correctional facility groups				171.00		
Foreign				11,754.64		
International Advisory Council for Homosexual Men and Women in A.A.				230.00		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				9,726.68		
International Lawyers in A.A.				753.20		
Internationalists				541.70		
Internationalists groups				67.00		
Treatment facility groups				4,673.24		
GRAND TOTAL				\$1,759,304.98		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1981-1982 (in U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1982	26,608	15,109	56.8%	\$1,553,455.48	518,790	\$2.99
U.S. 1981	24,293	13,912	57.3	1,383,828.48	455,505	3.04
Increase (Decrease)	2,315	1,197	(.5%)	\$ 169,627.00	63,285	(\$.05)
Canada 1982	3,948	2,524 ^①	63.9% ^①	\$ 177,510.04	66,344	\$2.68 ^①
Canada 1981	3,781	2,258 ^①	59.7 ^①	167,941.56	64,244	2.61 ^①
Increase (Decrease)	167	266	4.2%	\$ 54,641.56	2,100	\$.07
U.S. and Canada 1982	30,556	17,633 ^①	57.7% ^①	1,730,965.52	585,134	\$2.96 ^①
U.S. and Canada 1981	28,074	16,170 ^①	57.6 ^①	1,551,770.04	519,749	2.99 ^①
Increase (Decrease)	2,482	1,463	1%	\$ 179,195.48	65,385	(\$.03)

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by all areas).

U.S.	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	185	109	58.9%	\$ 6,489.20	2,634	\$2.46
Alaska	100	50	50.0	3,831.84	1,095	3.50
Arizona	429	213	49.6	20,913.52	6,975	3.00
Arkansas	141	90	63.8	5,969.16	2,096	2.85
California	3,619	2,087	57.6	237,170.46	96,880	2.45
Colorado	388	220	56.7	27,683.59	7,469	3.71
Connecticut	722	412	57.0	38,211.14	14,967	2.55
Delaware	90	73	81.1	6,281.43	1,434	4.38
District of Columbia	121	66	54.5	10,922.91	4,075	2.68
Florida	1,045	658	62.9	83,577.85	16,239	5.15
Georgia	415	288	69.3	24,313.48	7,138	3.41
Hawaii	127	94	74.0	8,104.05	2,110	3.84
Idaho	146	87	59.5	5,660.75	1,607	3.52
Illinois	1,430	708	49.5	76,185.10	27,184	2.80
Indiana	579	315	54.4	31,624.43	8,800	3.59
Iowa	435	245	56.3	16,991.47	8,077	2.10
Kansas	256	173	67.5	18,026.61	5,125	3.52
Kentucky	279	158	56.6	21,146.90	4,048	5.22
Louisiana	313	178	56.8	15,439.09	4,529	3.41
Maine	215	125	58.1	10,676.06	2,881	3.71
Maryland	593	341	57.5	39,447.30	10,003	3.94
Massachusetts	846	448	52.9	48,539.15	21,962	2.21
Michigan	917	494	53.8	64,966.70	18,963	3.43
Minnesota	1,105	573	51.8	54,487.38	28,233	1.93
Mississippi	150	86	57.3	4,883.89	1,794	2.72
Missouri	473	300	63.4	27,109.24	6,929	3.91
Montana	202	97	48.0	7,845.78	2,417	3.25
Nebraska	454	283	62.3	36,278.77	7,790	4.66
Nevada	131	67	51.1	7,572.32	1,493	5.07
New Hampshire	206	116	56.3	8,002.87	2,721	2.94
New Jersey	906	493	54.4	56,240.12	18,437	3.05
New Mexico	141	104	73.7	8,565.99	2,036	4.21
New York	1,846	953	51.6	106,138.63	36,440	2.91
North Carolina	451	296	65.6	21,315.22	6,922	3.08
North Dakota	124	84	67.7	7,136.53	2,007	3.56
Ohio	1,169	490	41.9	46,911.95	22,643	2.07
Oklahoma	266	214	80.4	22,311.79	3,503	6.37
Oregon	376	210	55.8	16,112.80	4,955	3.25
Pennsylvania	964	569	59.0	59,876.48	17,650	3.39
Rhode Island	139	85	61.1	8,094.84	2,108	3.84
South Carolina	163	128	78.5	9,196.57	2,177	4.22
South Dakota	123	72	58.5	7,560.57	2,269	3.33
Tennessee	251	160	63.7	12,089.94	3,645	3.32
Texas	966	574	59.4	66,129.14	23,464	2.82
Utah	126	71	56.3	5,258.69	1,859	2.83
Vermont	98	50	51.0	3,940.27	1,560	2.53
Virginia	630	409	64.9	34,081.41	12,001	2.84
Washington	666	380	57.0	44,849.31	11,768	3.81
West Virginia	147	97	65.9	7,384.77	1,514	4.88
Wisconsin	731	400	54.7	35,303.77	11,308	3.12
Wyoming	79	49	62.0	2,420.04	1,079	2.24
Commonwealth of P.R.	101	62	61.3	3,494.58	1,320	2.65
Bahama Islands	7	2	28.5	150.00	124	1.21
Virgin Islands of U.S.	7	3	42.8	539.63	144	3.75
Bermuda	19	0	0.0	0.00	184	0
TOTAL for U.S.	26,608	15,109	56.8%	\$1,553,455.48	518,790	\$2.99

1983 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Rolly Brunet, N.W. Que.
²Phil Cels, Man.
¹Gerry Coutu, R.I.
 John Langston, Ga.

Mel Ditty, W. Mo.
 Ralph Goers, S. Calif.
 Tommy Hills, E. Ont.
 Lloyd Hosner, Cent. Mich.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Sarah Gunzinger, Vt.
²Jim McCourt, Alsk.
 Dave McHenry, Wyo.
¹Garnet Wipf, Sask.

Manning Banks, Nev.
 Brian Camp, N.E. Tex.
 Myron Gowans, Va.
 Gabriel LaPointe, N.E. Que.

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Correctional Facilities

²Ron Bush, W. Mich.
¹Derral Campbell, N. Int. Calif.
 Luis Raul Hernandez, P.R.
 Ken Treganowan, Alta.

Dorothy Garvin, E. Pa.
 Jack McKenna, Iowa
 Ralph Van Keuren, Cent. N.Y.
 Julius Wilson, Cent. & S.E. Ohio

Secretary: Susan Daly

Finance

John Heidemann, N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.
¹Clyde Mitchell, S.W. Tex.
³Elke Forbes, Del.
²Peggy Screptock, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.

Jack Hoffman, Haw.
 Cathie Jeltsch, S.E. N.Y.
 Kim Patrick, B.C./Yukon
 Rosaire Vanesse, S.E. Que.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

⁴Agnes Krueger, N.D.
¹Cork Oberg, Nebr.
²Doug Riley, N.W. Tex.
 Frank Rinaldo, Me.

Robie Chipman, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
 Ted Hayes, N.E. Ohio
 Bill Moore, N. Coastal Calif.
 Elsie Murphy, Ark.
 Jan Polek, Wash.

Secretary: Ann Warner

Literature

¹Mary DeFer, Ariz.
 John Goetschel, N. Ill.
²Ralph Huelsman, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
 Robert Talkington, Kans.
 Frank Youell, Md.

Jack Byars, N.C.
 Conrad Cooley, N.E. Ont.
 Frank Gay, E. Mass.
 Bryce Peacock, Utah

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Conference Policy/Admissions

²Don Callahan, San Diego
 Madge Mansfield, S. N.J.
 Percy Moore, Miss.
¹Myron Snow, N.B./P.E.I.

Carol King, W. Pa.
 Joseph Rhoads, Conn.
 Sally Roy, Ala./N.W. Fla.
 Michael Shelly, Chicago

Secretary: Sarah Price

Public Information

Bill Blount, S.C.
²John Currier, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire
¹Tom LeTourneau, N. Minn.
 Diana Salnave, Oreg.

Herb Brauttsch, N. Ind.
 Phil Dennis, E. Mo.
 Chad Leyshon, D.C.
 Evelyn Sale, N. Fla.

Secretary: Vinnie McCarthy

Conference Report and Charter

Jill Johnston, S. Ind.
¹George Lathrop, W. N.Y.
 Mabel Moebeck, S.D.
²Billy Moore, Ky.

Mike Cushman, S. Fla.
 Bill Factor, Colo.
 John Paul Jones, S. Ill.
 John Sharkey, N. N.J.

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Treatment Facilities

Bill Dick, Idaho
 Dyanne Gilliam, Mid-S. Calif.
²Dave Leonard, N.M.
¹Barney John Malik, W. Ont.

Robert Baetz, S. Wis.
 Donald Bruner, S. Minn.
 Ben Headrick, La.
 Peggy Smith, S.E. Mich.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Committee on Trustees

Dick Darling, N.H.
²Stella LeFebvre, S.W. Que.
¹Buford Lewallen, Tenn.
 Betty Reed, W. Mass.
 Ray Vevik, Mont.

Pete Ellis, W. Va.
 C. B. Key, Okla.
 Ray Lavergne, N.W. Ont.
 Bud Smith, Tex.

Secretary: Lois Fisher



Second-floor rooms were set up for all the committee meetings.

New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
 Cooperation With the Professional Community
 Correctional Facilities
 Finance
 Grapevine
 Literature
 Conference Policy/Admissions
 Public Information
 Conference Report and Charter
 Treatment Facilities
 Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Tommy Hills, E. Ont.
 Manning Banks, Nev.
 Dorothy Garvin, E. Pa.
 Jack Hoffman, Haw.
 Bill Moore, N. Coastal Calif.
 Conrad Cooley, N.E. Ont.
 Michael Shelly, Chicago
 Chad Leyshon, D.C.
 John Sharkey, N. N.J.
 Robert Baetz, S. Wis.
 C. B. Key, Okla.

Alternate

Ralph Goers, S. Calif.
 Brian Camp, N.E. Tex.
 Ralph Van Keuren, Cent. N.Y.
 Kim Patrick, B.C./Yukon
 Jan Polek, Wash.
 Bryce Peacock, Utah
 Joseph Rhoads, Conn.
 Evelyn Sale, N. Fla.
 Bill Factor, Colo.
 Donald Bruner, S. Minn.
 Pete Ellis, W. Va.

- 1 Chairperson
- 2 Alternate chairperson
- 3 Alternate delegate
- 4 Served at the Conference in place of Bertram Hilber (see footnote p. 61).

Archives

Albert Hergott, *chairperson*
 Joe Kraus
 Milton Maxwell
 Mary Phelps
 James Shannon
 Joan Ullom
 George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
 Nell Wing, *consultant*
 Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Richard Driscoll, *chairperson*
 David Aronofsky
 Ken Dunphy
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Natalie Schwanke
 Jacquelyn Solomon
 Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
 Stan Cameron
 Jack Hennessy
 Herbert McBride, M.D.
 Corrine Pettey
 Shepherd Raimi
 James Shannon
 Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
 Jack Anderson
 Daniel Fitzgibbon
 Robert Gregush
 Albert Hergott
 Sonny Johnson
 Louis Kraus
 William McDuffie
 Susan Daly, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
 John Bragg
 Donald Daly
 Joe Kraus
 Michael Alexander, *consultant*
 George Dorsey, *consultant*
 Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
 Robert Pearson, *secretary*
 Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
 Michael Alexander
 David Aronofsky
 John Bragg
 Buck Bruner
 Donald Daly
 W. J. Estelle Jr.
 Robert Morse
 John Ryall
 Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
 Dennis Manders, *secretary*

International

Stan Cameron, *chairperson*
 David Aronofsky
 William Flynn, M.D.
 Louis Kraus
 Ann Macfarlane
 Hal Marley
 John Norris, M.D.
 James Shannon
 Isa Stanfiel, *consultant*
 Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

John Ryall, *chairperson*
 Richard Driscoll
 Kenneth Dunphy
 Louis Kraus
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Natalie Schwanke
 Joan Ullom
 Kenneth Williams, M.D.
 Lyla Bonney, *co-secretary*
 Sarah Price, *co-secretary*

Literature

Michael Alexander, *chairperson*
 Kenneth Dunphy
 Albert Hergott
 Mary Phelps
 Natalie Schwanke
 Joan Ullom
 Kenneth Williams, M.D.
 Janet Graves, *consultant*
 Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Nominating

John Bragg, *chairperson*
 Buck Bruner
 Stan Cameron
 Donald Daly
 Richard Driscoll
 W. J. Estelle Jr.
 Joe Kraus
 John Ryall
 Jacquelyn Solomon
 Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Public Information

Jacquelyn Solomon, *chairperson*
 Anne Kaufman
 Heather Allen
 William Dowling
 Robert Durling
 Phil Parker
 Mary Phelps
 Eduardo Ramos
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Desmond Towey
 John Bragg, *consultant*
 Sean Callery, *consultant*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

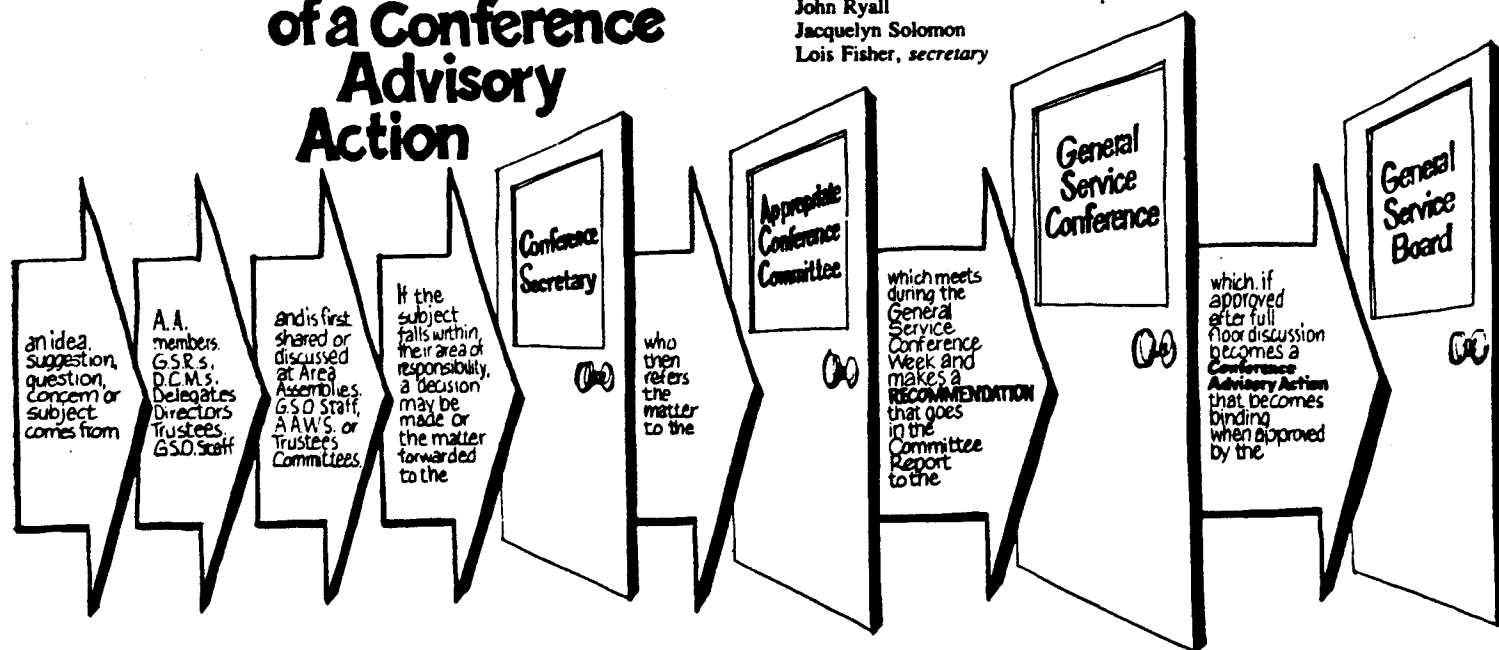
Kenneth Williams, M.D., *chairperson*
 James Barry
 Buck Bruner
 William Flynn, M.D.
 Bill Jason
 Thomas Jasper
 Earl Mullen
 Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

John Ryall, *chairperson*
 Sarah Price, *secretary*
 All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."

...from the A.A. Service Manual, p. 72.

1983 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, became its chairperson in 1982. He is a senior consultant with the management consulting firm of Drake Beam Morin Canada, Inc., and a consultant to the Donwood Institute. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism. A longtime friend of A.A., he considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director and secretary of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is chairperson of the Literature Committee, a member of the Finance Committee, and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana and educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101), joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, he also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and to the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, in Virginia. Bill is chairperson of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee, and a member of the International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525), was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served as consultant and editorial adviser for many local and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. As consultant to the Center of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J., Joan conducted research on A.A.

Frank Smeal (Goldman Sachs & Co., 55 Broad St., New York, NY 10004) began service as treasurer of the General Service Board in April 1979. He is partner and member of the management committee of an investment banking firm, after 30 years with Morgan Guaranty Trust Company, New York. He has degrees from Pennsylvania State University, the Harvard Graduate School of Business Administration, and New

York University Law School. Frank is a trustee and member of the executive committee of the Citizens' Budget Commission and a member and former chairperson of the Government and Federal Agencies Securities Committee of the Public Securities Association. He chairs the Employee Retirement and Finance Committees.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (Neumann Addiction Treatment Center, St. Joseph's Hospital, 12th and Walnut Sts., Reading, PA 19603), joined our board in 1979. Now director of a community-oriented alcoholism treatment program, he has been on the faculties of the Yale and University of Pittsburgh Schools of Medicine and a medical consultant to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program for alcoholics. Ken is chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee and a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

David H. Aronofsky (2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in May 1981. Dave has been chairperson of Dallas Metroplex Intergroup and of the Conference Finance Committee, as a Panel 27 delegate. He has remained active in area service. A doctor of dental surgery, Dave belongs to five professional organizations. He serves on the Conference, Finance, and International Committees.

John K. Bragg (2295 Pinehaven Dr., Schenectady, NY 12309), elected general service trustee in May 1981, is chairperson of the Nominating Committee, a member of the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees, and a consultant on the Public Information Committee. John has his own management consultant firm in the technology and research fields.

O. S. (Buck) Bruner (5161 Windridge Dr., Indianapolis, IN 46226) joined the board as East Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. With a background of intergroup, area, and state service, Buck was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. He is owner of one trucking company, part owner of another, and head of his own insurance agency. Buck serves as a Grapevine director and a member of the Finance, Treatment Facilities, and Nominating Committees.

Stan N. Cameron (P.O. Box 7811, Saskatoon, Sask. S7M 2X4, Canada) became Canadian trustee-at-large in 1979. He was a Panel 26 delegate after service as a G.S.R., intergroup representative, and roundup and public information chairperson. Stan helped set up two A.A. central offices. He is chairperson of a halfway house and member of an occupational alcoholism association. He has had governmental and union experience, and is now president of an industrial-relations consulting firm. He serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board, on the Nominating and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees, as chairperson of the International Committee, and as a U.S./Canada delegate to the World Service Meeting (1980-82).

Donald F. Daly (c/o Brundage Story & Rose, 1 Broadway, New York, NY 10004) was elected as a general service trustee in April 1980, to join the board in August. Don has served groups in Northport (Long Island), N.Y., and in Manhattan in most capacities. On the Grapevine Corporate Board since

1976, he is now its chairperson. Don is an investment counselor, former secretary of the Investment Counsel Association of America. He is a member of the Finance, Employee Retirement, and Nominating Committees.

²**Richard J. Driscoll** (129 Rhinebeck Ave., Springfield, MA 01129) was named Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1979 after serving as G.S.R., on P.I., C.P.C., institutions, and area committees, at an intergroup, and as a Panel 22 delegate. Besides belonging to various health and civic societies, Dick does volunteer work for two local non-A.A. alcoholism agencies. A licensed public accountant, he is now an officer in a bank and trust company. He is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board and the Conference Committee and a member of the Nominating and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Kenneth L. Dunphy (115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada), elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1982, has been active in district and area A.A. service and was a Conference delegate in 1976-77. Ken's background is in the electro-mechanical field; he was a draftsman in the mining industry and the Canadian Federal Government, for which he now works as a drafting supervisor. At his present office, he is A.A. contact for the Employee Assistance Program. Ken serves on the Conference, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Literature Committees.

¹**Helen A. Harmon** (Box 391, Melita, Man., Canada R0M 1L0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1983. Helen served her area as G.S.R. and D.C.M. and was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. She is owner and operator of a franchise for income tax preparation and a salesperson for mutual funds and investments. Helen serves on the board of directors of the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba and is active in her A.A. group, as well as area service.

Albert J. Hergott (Box 220, St. Louis, Sask. S0J 2C0, Canada) became Western Canada regional trustee in May 1981, to serve three years (filling out the term of his late predecessor, elected in 1980). On Panel 28, Al chaired the Conference Literature Committee. Formerly in the merchandising field, he is now consultant to an investment company and chief executive officer of a correctional institution. Al is chairperson of the Archives Committee and serves on the Literature and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Joe F. Kraus (P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464) joined the board as Southeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. After a term as a delegate (Panel 26), Joe returned to area activities. He has been in insurance, real estate, and finance, has his own company specializing in the last two fields, and has also taken part in many aspects of community service. Joe is an A.A.W.S. director and a member of the Archives, Employee Retirement, and Nominating Committees.

¹**Wayne Parks** (1120 West Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. Wayne has a background in area service, and after a term as Conference delegate (Panel 29), he returned to other area activities. He has worked in the oil sales, freight, and furniture fields. Wayne serves on his state's Alcohol and Drug Abuse Authority and on its Alcohol and Drug Abuse Advisory Council.

¹**Mary Phelps** (177 Waverly Pl., 5R, New York, NY 10014)

became a general service trustee in April 1983. A member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and Editorial Board, Mary has also been active in group and area service. She has worked as an editor in the general publishing, economics research, and weekly-magazine fields. Mary currently serves on the Archives, Literature, and P.I. Committees.

²**John Ryall** (32 Garden Ave., Carle Place, NY 11514) was elected general service trustee in 1979, after three years as a Grapevine director. John has been a delegate (Panel 21) and was instrumental in founding the Northeast Region's Delegates Association. A marketing specialist for a major communications network, he serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees, as chairperson of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and the General Sharing Session, and as treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Natalie Schwanke (14601 N.E. 35th, Bellevue, WA 98007) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1982. She has served both Seattle Intergroup and her area, which sent her to the Conference as delegate in 1975-76. Outside A.A., Natalie has been active in community affairs, and is a manufacturers' representative in women's clothing and accessories. She serves on the Conference, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Literature Committees.

Jacquelyn (Jackie) Solomon (303 E. 37th St., New York, NY 10016) became a general service trustee in May 1981, having been an A.A.W.S. director since 1976. Jackie has also been involved in group, intergroup, and area service. Her background is in the fashion sales field, but she is now a distributor/supervisor in the field of nutrition. Jackie is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the Conference and Nominating Committees.

¹**Garrett Taylor** (50—55th St. S.E., Washington, DC 20019) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. He was chairperson of Washington Intergroup and of the area committee. After serving as a Panel 27 Conference delegate, Garrett returned to area activities and is currently a member of the committee for the 1983 Northeast Regional Convention. A retired postal manager, Garrett continues to be active in civic affairs.

Joan Ullom (Box 42, Rte. 1, Aurora, SD 57002) was elected in 1982 to serve the remaining two years of the late Bud Grondahl's term as West Central U.S. regional trustee. A Conference delegate in 1976-77, Joan has taken a particular interest in her area's public information and archives work, becoming chairperson of both committees. In 1971, she started a county center for alcohol and drug information and referral, staffed chiefly by volunteers. She serves on the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Literature Committees.

1 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 23, 1983

2 Retiring at close of 1983 Conference meeting

1983 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

John Bragg, <i>chairperson</i>	Louis Kraus
Michael Alexander	Robert Pearson
Richard Driscoll	Sarah Price
Joe Kraus	Jacquelyn Solomon

A.A. Grapevine directors

Donald Daly, <i>chairperson, president</i>	Tom Neary
Stan Cameron	Mary Phelps
Retha Gresham, <i>secretary, vice-president</i>	Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
	John Ryall, <i>treasurer</i>
	Jim Shannon

General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Phyllis Masback
Lyla Bonney	Frank Mauser
Susan Daly	Vincina McCarthy
Lois Fisher	Curtis Monahan
Beth Kuhlmann	Sarah Price
Betty Liddle	June Russell
	Helen Turnquest

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, <i>managing editor</i>	Tom Neary, <i>art editor</i>
	Ann Warner, <i>editor</i>

G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

Maxwell Anderson, *acting supervisor, Mail Department*
 Norman Bradley, *supervisor, Data Control*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller/internal auditor*
 Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
 Dale Fuqua, *GvR secretary*
 Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager, supporting departments*
 Dorothy Graham, *writer, Conference Report*
 Shirley Grant, *personnel manager/interdepartmental coordinator*
 Janet Graves, *editor, Conference Report*
 Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
 John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
 Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
 Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., *trustee emeritus*
 Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
 Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*
 John L. Norris, M.D., *trustee emeritus*
 Tony Osnato, *office manager*
 Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
 Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference coordinator*

Observers (nonvoting) from the following may also attend:

Trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community
 Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
 Trustees' Finance Committee
 Trustees' Literature Committee
 Trustees' Public Information Committee
 Trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities
 Grapevine Editorial Board

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 33rd Conference includes Panel 32 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 33 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	33	Sally F. Roy, 2340 Lakeside Dr., Birmingham, AL 35244
Alaska	2	32	Jim McCourt, P.O. Box 280, Wasilla, AK 99687
Arizona	3	32	Mary DeFer, 4733 W. Mediterranean Dr., Glendale, AZ 85301
Arkansas	4	33	Elsie Murphy, 3302 Ridge Rd., North Little Rock, AR 72116
California	5	33	Southern—Ralph Goers, 972 Calle Brusca, Thousand Oaks, CA 91360
	6	33	Northern Coastal—Wallace B. (Bill) Moore, P.O. Box 4305, Vallejo, CA 94590
	7	32	Northern Interior—Derral G. Campbell, 7720 Robles Dr., Redding, CA 96001
	8	32	San Diego—Don Callahan, 463 E. Bobier, Vista, CA 92083
	9	32	Mid-Southern—Dyanne Gilliam, 202 11th St. #9, Huntington Beach, CA 92648
Colorado	10	33	William (Bill) Factor, 7317 Colonial Dr., Fountain, CO 80817
Connecticut	11	33	Joseph E. Rhoads, 569 Carriage Dr., Orange, CT 06477
Delaware	12	32	*Elke B. Forbes, 1314 Quincy Dr., Wilmington, DE 19803
District of Columbia	13	33	Chad Leyshon, 10414 Huntley Ave., Silver Spring, MD 20902
Florida	14	33	Northern—Evelyn Sale, 440 Diplomat Blvd., Cocoa Beach, FL 32931
	15	33	Southern—Michael D. Cushman, 1002 Paseo Morella, West Palm Beach, FL 33405
Georgia	16	32	John Langston, 2053 Woodberry Ave., East Point, GA 30344
Hawaii	17	33	Jack Hoffman, 1015 Aolua Pl. #439, Kailua, HI 96734

*Alternate

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	32	William T. Dick, 1064 Hillview, Idaho Falls, ID 83402	Mississippi	37	32	Percy Moore, 5107 Maid Marion Dr., Pascagoula, MS 39567
Illinois	19	33	Chicago—Michael Shelly, 502 Ridge Rd., Wilmette, IL 60091	Missouri	38	33	Eastern—Phil Dennis, Knox City, MO 63446
	20	32	Northern—John Goetschel, 3327 W. Elm St., McHenry, IL 60050		39	33	Western—Mel Ditty, 1612 Orleans Cir., North Kansas City, MO 64116
	21	33	Southern—John Paul Jones, 344 W. Imboden Dr., Decatur, IL 62521	Montana	40	32	Ray Vevik, 419 Connell Ave., Missoula, MT 59801
Indiana	22	33	Northern—Herbert Brautzsch, P.O. Box 10566, Fort Wayne, IN 46853	Nebraska	41	32	Derald L. (Cork) Oberg, Rte. 1, Ericson, NE 68637
	23	32	Southern—Jill S. Johnston, 26 Druid Hill Dr., Carmel, IN 46302	Nevada	42	33	M. Manning (Manny) Banks, 2800 Eastern Ave. #1003, Las Vegas, NV 89109
Iowa	24	33	John P. (Jack) McKenna, 102 California St., Waterloo, IA 50703	New Hampshire	43	32	Richard E. (Dick) Darling, 29 Noyes St., Concord, NH 03301
Kansas	25	32	Robert Talkington, 10308 W. 61st St., Shawnee Mission, KS 66203	New Jersey	44	33	Northern—John Sharkey, 9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052
Kentucky	26	32	Billy Moore, Rte. 1, Box 108, Casey Creek, KY 42723		45	32	Southern—Madge Mansfield, 111 Thornhill Rd., Cherry Hill, NJ 08003
Louisiana	27	33	Ben G. Headrick, 307 Dalzell St., Shreveport, LA 71104	New Mexico	46	32	David Leonard, 800 Spruce Ave., Alamogordo, NM 88310
Maine	28	32	Frank Rinaldo, R.F.D. 1, P.O. Box 515, Rumford, ME 04276	New York	47	33	Central—Ralph H. Van Keuren, 3 Perkins Ave., Binghamton, NY 13901
Maryland	29	32	Frank Youell, Bay City 17-21, Stevensville, MD 21666		48	32	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire—John D. Currier, P.O. Box 201, West Winfield, NY 13491
Massachusetts	30	33	Eastern—Francis J. (Frank) Gay, 279 Chandler St., Tewksbury, MA 01876		49	33	Southeastern—Cathie Jeltsch, 73 Grove St., Glenwood Landing, NY 11547
	31	32	Western—Elizabeth M. (Betty) Reed, 206 Merrimac Ave., Springfield, MA 01105		50	32	Western—George Lathrop, R.D. #3, Box 148A, Olean, NY 14760
Michigan	32	33	Central—Lloyd Hosner, 5152 Morrish Rd. #13, Swartz Creek, MI 48473	North Carolina/ Bermuda	51	33	Jack E. Byars, 5304 Wayne Rd., Greensboro, NC 27407
	33	33	Southeastern—Peggy Smith, 35950 E. Jefferson #102, Mt. Clemens, MI 48045	North Dakota	52	32	*Agnes Krueger, Rte. 2, Pick City, Hazen, ND 58545
	34	32	Western—Ronald (Ron) Bush, 511 S. Broas, Belding, MI 48809	Ohio	53	33	Central & Southeastern—Julius E. Wilson Jr., 256 S. Chase Ave., Columbus, OH 43204
Minnesota	35	32	Northern—Tom LeTourneau, Box 510, Biwabik, MN 55708				
	36	33	Southern—Donald J. Bruner, 6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438				

*Served at the Conference in place of the alternate, who was later elected as delegate by the North Dakota Area Assembly: Bertram Hilber, 2301 10th St. S., Fargo, ND 58103.

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Ohio	54	33	Northeastern—Ted Hayes, 15607 Harvard Ave., Cleveland, OH 44128	Wisconsin	74	32	N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan—John Heidemann, Rte. #1, Box 490, Ishpeming, MI 49849
	55	32	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan—Margaret A. (Peggy) Screptock, 2205 Mescher Dr., Monclova, OH 43542		75	33	Southern—Robert Baetz, 8205 48th Ave., Kenosha, WI 53142
	56	32	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky—Ralph L. Huelsman, 241 N. Walnut St., St. Henry, OH 45883	Wyoming	76	32	Dave McHenry, 3528 Duff Ave., Cheyenne, WY 82001
Oklahoma	57	33	C. B. Key, 4241 E. 25th Pl., Tulsa, OK 74114	Puerto Rico	77	32	Luis Raul Hernandez, P.O. Box 6222, Arecibo, PR 00612
Oregon	58	32	Diana M. Salnave, 371 Village Sq. Ave. #20, Gresham, OR 97030	Canada			
Pennsylvania	59	33	Eastern—Dorothy Garvin, 5030 Parrish St., Philadelphia, PA 19139	Province			
	60	33	Western—Carol King, 7 Ferncliff Beach, Erie, PA 16505	Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	32	Ken Treganowan, 11143—77 Ave., Edmonton, Alta. T6G 0L5
Rhode Island	61	32	Gerard (Gerry) Coutu, Rocky Hill Rd., Box 530, North Scituate, RI 02857	British Columbia/Yukon	79	33	Susanna Kim Patrick, c/o Sunshine Cabs, #105—1420 Marine Dr., North Vancouver, B.C. V7P 1T6
South Carolina	62	32	William H. (Bill) Blount, P.O. Box 1041, Beaufort, SC 29902	Manitoba	80	32	Phil Cels, 5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Man. R7A 6E5
South Dakota	63	32	Mabel A. Moebeck, Box 446, Edgemont, SD 57735 0446	New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island	81	32	Myron Snow, P.O. Box 1542, Sackville, N.B. E0A 3C0
Tennessee	64	32	W. Buford (Lew) Lewallen, 405 Eagle Bend La., Clinton, TN 37716	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	33	Robie W. Chipman, Bridge-water R.R. 5, Lunenburg Co., N.S. B4V 2W4
Texas	65	33	Northeastern—Brian L. Camp, 1329 W. Redbud Dr., Hurst, TX 76053	Ontario	83	33	Eastern—Thomas G. (Tommy) Hills, 48 McGregor Rd., Scarborough, Ont. M1P 1C8
	66	32	Northwestern—Doug Riley, Box 743, Snyder, TX 79549		84	33	Northeastern—Conrad E. Cooley, 34 Farley Ave., North Bay, Ont. P1A 2S5
	67	33	Southeastern—Bud Smith, 3219 Missouri, Baytown, TX 77520		85	33	Northwestern—Ray Lavergne, 400 Rabbit Lake Rd., Kenora, Ont. P9N 3W8
	68	32	Southwestern—Clyde Mitchell, 808 Hybiscus, Victoria, TX 77904	Quebec	86	32	Western—Barney John Malik, 74 Glen Castle Dr., Hamilton, Ont. L8K 5Z5
Utah	69	33	Bryce W. Peacock, 3080 Heritage Dr., Salt Lake City, UT 84119		87	32	Southwestern—Stella Lefebvre, Box 26, Lachute, Que. J8H 3X2
Vermont	70	32	Sarah Gunzinger, R.F.D. #1, Perkinsville, VT 05151		88	33	Southeastern—Rosaire Vanesse, 585 Fortin, Sherbrooke, Que. J1E 2Z1
Virginia	71	33	Myron Gowans, Rte. 2, Box 171A, Heathsville, VA 22473		89	33	Northeastern—Gabriel La-Pointe, 1311 Adam, Chicoutimi Nord, Que. G7G 4H8
Washington	72	33	Jan Polek, 2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99203		90	32	Northwestern—Roland (Rolly) Brunet, 2041 Arrowsmith, Apt. 107A, Gloucester, Ont. K1J 7V7
West Virginia	73	33	Harold (Pete) Ellis, 121 River Dr., Logan, WV 25601	Saskatchewan	91	32	Garnet Wipf, 1139 22nd St. E., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 1P2

Literature Distributed—1982

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	462,100
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	237,900
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	49,900
A.A. Comes of Age	21,300
As Bill Sees It	55,300
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	23,400
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish edition	7,200
As Bill Sees It — Spanish edition	1,600
A.A. Comes of Age — Spanish edition	1,000
Total	859,700

Booklets

Living Sober	129,300
Came to Believe . . .	58,300
Living Sober — Spanish edition	3,100
Total	190,700

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs	37,100
A.A. and the Armed Services	22,000
A.A. and the Medical Profession	54,100
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession (new)	15,100
A.A. for the Woman	200,700
The A.A. Group	109,700
A.A. in Your Community	137,800
A.A. in Prisons	34,200
A.A. in Treatment Centers	59,700
The A.A. Member	124,200
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	192,200
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	32,500
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	66,100
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	24,000
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	283,000
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	51,400
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	58,700
Do You Think You're Different?	237,800
44 Questions	435,400
G.S.R.	56,300
How A.A. Members Cooperate	37,600
How It Works	150,700

If You Are a Professional . . .	85,600
Inside A.A.	86,200
Is A.A. for You?	495,900
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	177,300
It Happened to Alice	73,400
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	69,500
The Jack Alexander Article	73,000
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	34,500
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	142,200
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	148,100
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	52,900
A Newcomer Asks . . .	296,100
Problems Other Than Alcohol	129,100
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	244,700
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	37,500
This Is A.A.	458,600
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	38,700
Time to Start Living	120,000
Time to Start Living (large print)	12,800
Too Young?	180,800
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	69,500
Understanding Anonymity	119,500
What Happened to Joe	89,200
Young People and A.A.	242,500
Foreign translations	177,800
Total	6,075,700

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards — two-fold	759,500
Wallet cards — I Am Responsible	107,500
Wallet cards — Anonymity	64,700
Parchment — scrolls	6,100
Placards	900
C.P.C. Workbook	1,100
A.A. Guidelines	116,100
Group Handbook	7,900
Wire racks	2,000
Cassettes	3,200
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	2,300
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,200
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	400
A.A. Public Information Workbooks	1,800
Steps and Traditions window-shade displays	1,900
Fact Files	4,200
Total	1,080,800

Grapevine circulation — geographical breakdown

					Circulation 4/1/82—122,470; 4/1/83—119,586					Increase/decrease: 4/1/81—4/1/82, -1,831; 4/1/82—4/1/83, -2,884					
		In-crease/ de-crease				In-crease/ de-crease				In-crease/ de-crease					
U.S.	No. GvRs	Circulation		U.S.	No. GvRs	Circulation		U.S.	No. GvRs	Circulation		U.S.	No. GvRs	Circulation	
	4/82	4/83	4/82	4/83		4/82	4/83		4/82	4/83			4/82	4/83	
Ala.	43	48	1,105	1,055	- 50	Mont.	86	95	758	784	+ 26	P.R.	4	8	113
Alsk.	18	27	380	377	- 3	Nebr.	161	205	1,724	1,744	+ 20	U.S. Poss.	—	—	14
Ariz.	84	107	1,257	1,291	+ 34	Nev.	12	12	413	415	+ 2		<u>5,717</u>	<u>6,749</u>	<u>105,177</u>
Ark.	92	87	656	640	- 16	N.H.	40	45	805	727	- 78				<u>104,601</u>
Calif.	423	499	10,591	10,671	+ 80	N.J.	84	131	3,104	3,293	+ 189				- 576
Colo.	71	75	1,462	1,413	- 49	N.M.	26	35	642	730	+ 88				
Conn.	126	181	2,343	2,210	- 133	N.Y.	283	328	7,417	7,213	- 204	Canada			
Del.	47	46	330	333	+ 3	N.C.	146	171	2,522	2,559	+ 37	Alta.	73	67	2,021
D.C.	71	28	454	348	- 106	N.D.	198	163	845	840	- 5	B.C./Yukon	72	62	2,436
Fla.	220	289	4,521	4,738	+ 217	Ohio	265	283	3,855	3,633	- 222	Man.	34	35	981
Ga.	205	215	2,059	2,235	+ 176	Okla.	91	100	1,718	1,773	+ 55	N.B./P.E.I.	50	21	594
Haw.	41	53	325	352	+ 27	Oreg.	61	80	1,023	1,034	+ 11	N.S./Nfld./			597
Idaho	36	43	854	567	- 287	Pa.	311	350	3,625	3,502	- 123	Lab.	60	65	1,354
Ill.	119	188	4,708	4,868	+ 160	R.I.	36	76	579	376	- 203	Ont.	413	476	1,065
Ind.	220	170	1,873	1,803	- 70	S.C.	160	125	1,454	1,585	+ 131	Que.	20	37	502
Iowa	63	78	1,755	1,719	- 36	S.D.	29	35	819	708	- 111	Sask.	78	95	1,423
Kans.	58	84	1,626	1,935	+ 309	Tenn.	163	168	1,254	1,875	+ 621		<u>800</u>	<u>858</u>	<u>15,378</u>
Ky.	40	49	976	845	- 131	Tex.	202	157	4,548	4,773	+ 225				<u>13,155</u>
La.	44	55	1,333	1,358	+ 25	Utah	80	80	362	344	- 18				- 2,223
Me.	34	37	765	703	- 62	Vt.	18	23	425	463	+ 38	Foreign	<u>32</u>	<u>31</u>	<u>1,915</u>
Md.	71	134	2,254	2,060	- 194	Va.	171	343	2,811	2,546	- 265				<u>1,830</u>
Mass.	99	128	4,265	4,042	- 223	Wash.	107	135	2,807	2,810	+ 3				- 85
Mich.	159	195	3,633	3,321	- 312	W. Va.	47	46	593	533	- 60				
Minn.	190	298	5,258	5,124	- 134	Wis.	172	204	3,069	2,935	- 134	Total	<u>6,549</u>	<u>7,638</u>	<u>122,470</u>
Miss.	30	34	716	735	+ 19	Wyo.	55	55	359	354	- 5			<u>119,586</u>	<u>-2,884</u>
Mo.	105	148	2,020	2,183	+ 163										